PIP 2023

Postnatural
Independent Program

we?

Institute for Postnatural Studies



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what is human?
who is we?

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What is human? Who is whe?

Notes on experimental platforms, thinking together, and not-knowing

Experimentation, mediation, dynamization, and facilitation are not only new tools from which horizontal learning platforms should emerge, but also the core and foundations from which to create safe and inclusive spaces that help rethink academia, and learning processes in general. It seems crucial at this point (in which various agents are exploring alternatives to the socio-climatic crisis) that such programs, which are fundamentally tied to the present, to cultural and geographical specificities, activate complex entanglements that not only examine the world but, by doing so, ultimately reshape it.

The first Postnatural Independent Program (PIP) offered by the Institute for Postnatural Studies (IPS) was imagined as a new learning space that could offer theoretical tools and embodied knowledge to help define and develop ideas and projects that examine postnature as a framework for contemporary creation. Using a dual methodology incorporating both theory and practice, it emerged as an inclusive and horizontal virtual campus in constant shifting. Structured in 3 online modules, and accompanied by renowned international thinkers, artists, curators, and philosophers, it was complemented by two in-person encounters in Madrid; important moments in which the participants (coming from many different countries and contexts) had the opportunity of sharing the embodied experience of being together in one physical space and time-zone.

We believe that this complex and multilayered space that emerges from conversations, ideas, shared intimacies, vulnerabilities, and propositions has real consequences in the world. By critically leaving behind the representational distance between “us” and “them”, “here” and “there”, and “knowledge” and “superstition”, to name just a few of the dichotomies cultivated by Western traditional art and philosophy academies, we forge a necessary and immediate relation to the world. But who is “we”? And how can “we” stay together, despite our differences? How can “we” create collectivity without sameness, and bypass the pull towards homogeneity?

If something has happened during all these sessions together it is that the very structure of the program had to gradually absorb the doubts, anxieties, affiliations, affects, and interrogations that emerged from our conversations. Through long debates, roundabouts, contradictions, and other drifts, concepts and ideas were constantly and elastically being shaped and reshaped. Like a sympoietic organism that grows and breathes together, the sense of collectively not-knowing became always the starting point to raise questions, that led, ultimately, to more questions; not a *mise en abyme,* but a productive attunement of different subjectivities and perspectives. The PIP has therefore become a tentacular structure embedded in a flexible time, operating from various geographies and temporalities; a new type of relationship between what we are, and a world that can begin to be; a transformation of the modes of being and sharing together that requires new thoughts and new rituals; a plurality that implies ways of thinking and acting in an affective political ecology.

Worlding, the practice of enacting worlds to come, must start by rethinking who "we" are, why "we" are (what "we" are supposed to be), where "we" come from, and what new subjectivities other worlds can bring with them. It is not arbitrary that one of the main words that have been problematic from the beginning is that of the "human" itself. To think about our surroundings and the environment is to rethink what being a human is today and how we can relate through care, awareness, love, and responsibility, and to find new modes to coexist symbiotically within the frictions of the future-present.

Another cultural binomial comes into play when programming online learning: the physical and the "non-physical" experience, the material, and the "virtual". Why might we feel that being connected online requires less presence? One of the things we have explored is the situatedness of our time spent together in different time zones and geographical locations. How does a person engage in a philosophical debate at 2 am, 6 pm, or 11 am? How can that be conceptualized as "virtual" or "non-physical"? What role does the body play, when it is tired, rested, or just fed?

In this sense, a kind of deep time emerges, both material and philosophical. From a contemporary ecological perspective, the cultural and the geological -the slow times of the earth-, but also the biological or the technological have totally different

temporalities , but they are always intermingling, and intersecting. One important factor that brings much joy and empowerment is being able to connect to people and voices that speak from their locality, ultimately enriching the program and knowledge around the postnatural, which then becomes plural and even more heterogeneous.

When trying to expand on traditional educational systems, we understood that our efforts should allow knowledge-sharing spaces that propel a horizontal approach that embraces (through care and mediation) the interconnectedness of the "classroom". Knowledge is not only theoretical information, case studies, or data analysis. The PIP has organically become a space for emotional growth, for embodied experiences of joy, angst, and conflict, that alters the way we may relate between ourselves and our environments. We all have special needs when it comes to learning, and our individual physical, mental, and emotional abilities must play a central role.

From the Insitute for Postntaural Studies, we have found ourselves constantly reflecting on many questions that could help propose new academic formats. How do we create a safe space that can hold and respect the individual and the collective simultaneously? What are the frontiers of personal infringement and how can these frontiers make us stronger as a necessarily heterogeneous group without harming anyone in the process? What happens when those perhaps conflictive needs clash or bounce or hybridize? One thing we have learned is that a safe space is not safe because it is free of harm or conflict, but because it is permanently open to enacting healing and reparation processes.

PIP has been the beginning of an intellectual, embodied, collective, diffractive, emotional journey that brings us closer to the possibility of a world, or many worlds, where thinking together, not knowing, and building modes of affective affiliation become possible. For all this, we (members of IPS) want to deeply thank all the participants in the program, fellow travelers with whom we have had the beautiful opportunity of learning to unlearn.

Gabriel Alonso, Program Director
Yuri Tuma, Program Co-Director
Clara Benito, Faculty and Coordinator
Institute for Postnatural Studies — Madrid, July 2023

Module I.

Cartographies of Condensed Presents

with Karen Barad, Claire Colebrook and Lorenzo Sandoval

From 02/06/2023 to 03/01/2023

In the moment of the collapse of systems, the end of binary categorisations, and enormous ecological and sociopolitical crisis, we could say that the present is disappearing; almost as if the past and the future were blending with each other. This module is about celebrating this new conception of time, while mourning its deadly context, through connecting past and future and looking at the past remains, at what is there —in short, matter— not as a collection of given facts but as a collection of possibilities, in the same way that we generally look into the future.

Sessions Module I.

— Genealogies of postnature
— Anarcheological thinking
— Session with Karen Barad
— Un(vealing) the Anthropocene: Capitalocene, Chthulucene, Anthrobscene...
— Session with Claire Colebrook
— Geopolitics and Botanics
— Ecological awareness: art, criticism, curating
— Session with Lorenzo Sandoval
— LAB 1: Online Project Presentations and Tutorships

Module II.

More-than-human Ecologies and Coexistence

with Cary Wolfe, the Institute of Queer Ecology, Filipa Ramos, Paloma Contreras and Stacy Alaimo

From 03/13/2023 to 04/15/2023

Within the framework of the Phonocene, described by Donna Haraway and Vinciane Despret as a possible era of sound, we will explore how active listening allows us to access new ways of inhabiting the territory and create new modes of care and kinship among critters, human or not. Through the lens of queer ecology and non-western cosmologies, we will explore different topics that promote new ways to rethink our relationship with non-human entities and ecosystems in order to generate new possibilities for the recomposition of terrestrial ecological communities. These types of non-binary thinking and embodiment function as tools to break the taboos of coexistence and social constructions that come with inhabiting human cultures.

Sessions Module II.

— De-anthropocentric ontologies andanti-humanism
— Affect and coexistence
— Encounter I: In-person gathering in Madrid mediated by Filipa Ramos
— Field trip to Casa de Fieras at Retiro Park
— Field trip to Madrid's Zoo Park
— Group work sessions at IPS headquarters
— Phonocene: Ecologies of listening
— Session with Cary Wolfe
— Perspectivism and non-western cosmologies
— Session with IQECO
— Queer worldings and rituals
— Session with Paloma Contreras Lomas
— Session with Stacy Alaimo

Module III.

Desirable Futures

with Gesyada Siregar, Báyò Akómoláfé, Mary Maggic and Uriel Fogué

From 05/08/2023 to 06/19/2023

In the union between species and the activation of different senses and sensibilities, we can research, learn and speculate about a world of coexistence. In the process of creating desirable futures and collaborative healing, we may find unexpected joys that unite us in the contemporary ecological crisis. The relationship between human beings and nature is present in our daily lives in the form of stories that define our way of inhabiting the planet. In this module, we will try and understand ourselves as part of the ecosystem and not as a regulator, curator, or submissive extractor, in its multiple meanings. Art and critical thinking are inherent to the comprehension of the global landscape, analyzing territories, geopolitics, sustainability, bodies, new spiritualities and ecologies through new academic approaches.

Sessions Module III:

— Decolonial approaches
— Posthumanism and the politics of becoming
— Session with Gesyada Siregar
— LAB 2: Collective writing for 2023 PIP publication
— Session with Báyò Akómoláfé
— Mutualism: towards symbiotic living
— Session with Mary Maggic
— Science fictions and speculative narratives
— LAB 3: Research Project Presentations and Tutorships
— Session with Uriel Fogué
— Encounter II: Final Presentations
In-person gathering in Madrid at Matadero Madrid, mediated by Lorenzo Sandoval
— Field trip with Lorenzo Sandoval
— Group work sessions at Matadero Madrid
— Public projects presentation at Matadero Madrid



































“Nature emerges from a self-birthed womb fashioned out of a raging nothingness. A queer origin, an originary queerness, a birthing that is always a rebirthing... out of chaos and void... A diffractected/ differentiating/ murmuring, an originary repetition without sameness, regeneration...”

Karen Barad

Module I.
Session #5
15/02/2023



The experimental piece by Karen Barad “Transmaterialities: Trans*/Matter/Realities and Queer Political Imaginings” examines matter in its promiscuous and inventive agential wanderings, its capacities for imaginative, desiring, and affectively charged forms of bodily engagements in the thick now of the present.

It runs through a constellation of disparate theories and phenomena, including Quantum Field Theory (QFT), galvanism, Queer theory, lightning bolts, transformation, the lively desiring tension of the void toward being/ becoming, virtuality, the “wild activities” of the vacuum, and the ontological indeterminacy that lie at the core of being, which they read through a lens of queerness, perversity and monstrosity.

And thus they weave a complex network of material imaginaries that entail superpositions of many beings and times, multiple im/ possibilities and ontological chimaeras that precede this and that, here and there, now and then.. as part of the ongoing thought experiment the world performs with itself.

“To live, to have a relationship with the world, is to be technological. That’s post-natural. The problem has been, on the one hand, that technology has been conceptually attached to ... non-oral cultures that have stored memory in the form of books. But there are many other technologies: gesture, dance, music, collective memory, tea ceremonies, cooking...”

Claire Colebrook



Not “post-nature” but “post-natures”, for there are multiple, conflicting senses of the term.

The hyper-humanism that lies behind some of the accounts that get marketed as post-natural or post-human and actually regard our species as a privileged exception in the realm of beings. In the western humanist tradition, a tradition that is geopolitical as well as philosophical, there is a dominant sense that humans are other than mere animals: we are rational beings, we self-fashion, we decide upon the form of our own lives, we are cultural, we manufacture of political relations, we transcend material nature... in sum, we are post-natural, but some of us are most post-natural than others.

This tradition entails the creation of a form of post-natural time, a contra-Newtonian time, which proved historically crucial to fascist politics, and regards time as generative, creative, multiple, responsive, relational, detached of the potentialities of who we are, and able to liberate the future from the calculations of the present. This type of New World thinking, however, relies on a colonizing, imperialist imagination of the time-world as unoccupied: open space, boundless, ready to be conquered. And it looks down on non-European traditions as being too natural, too material, too contextual, and non-abstract enough.

“The audience is the people I work with and interview, people that take part in the conversations, that see themselves reflected in the exhibition, who appear in it, who make it possible through various means of collaboration. So that if I curate an exhibition about the mining industry, my main audience will be the miners and their families.”

Lorenzo Sandoval

Module I.
Session #14
16/03/2023



Lorenzo is a Spanish curator, artist and filmmaker, whose work is informed by disciplines such as architecture, sculpture, science, mediation, sound, among others.

He produces a very site-specific kind of work, a situated practice involving a lot of research on the field. For that, he believes in slow processes: of listening, of learning, of creating trust, of spending time with the people he is “extracting” knowledge from, of respecting people’s paradoxes... This is the firm commitment to break appart what is considered art and inscribe into the institution narrations that are not yet there, have been erased from memory or overlooked. For him, it is actually about focusing on the visible and hidden everyday life details than can trigger longer conversations.

Through works such as “That summer of 22”, “Industry / Matrices _ Threads and Sounds” and “Fábrica colectiva”, he explores issues as important as political corruption, extractivism, social identities linked to pain and struggle, the need to recover a kind of mythical approach to restore our relationship with with nature, emotional heritages, sound ecologies, or non-human personhood.

“There might be no hope [in environmentalism] but there must be a lot of pleasure.”

Module II.
Session #32
24/06/2023



“Postnatural bodies, multispecies worlds” is a provocation meant to give raise to open but fundamental questions about the postnatural and its relationship to the Anthropocene, both of which are concepts embedded in Alaimo’s work, if not always with those same words.

What are our visual images about the postnatural/Anthropocene, if any? Is that the dominant vision or our personal vision? How can we represent a multispecies perspective? How do we manage issues of scale, intimacy, aesthetics, media, substances, materials, textures, the haptic feel, the sensorium...?

If we understand the postnatural as a critique of the nature/culture binary in Western modernity (which is only one of its possible definitions), then predominant visions of the Anthropocene tend to reinstall those binaries and thus negate the postnatural. They install a mode of anthropocentric “environmentalism”, reifiying a magnified and homogenous “Man” that transforms a “nature” to which he does not belong. But what happens to more-than-human species in this vision? What would a genuine multispecies Anthropocene even look like?

Stacy Alaimo

“Trees are not people; that’s what is great about them.”

Module II.
Session #17
28/03/2023



Thinker and editor Cary Wolfe’s prospect installation “Experimental Forest” is the result of a rhizomatic network of multidisciplinary references. From philosophy to visual art and eco-poetics, it is informed by a constellation of ideas and works that Cary mobilizes to avoid anthropomorphism and to “keep the forest weird”, which has been his motto over the past years as he wandered the experimental forests of Colorado and other North-American regions with his dog, Xena, and a camera.

While exploring ideas from Western thinkers such as Heidegger or Derrida, Cary defended that philosophy cannot grasp or capture by analytical apprehension the radical difference of the more-than-human world; that it cannot force this ‘nearness’ as if by prehensile grasping. However, it is its job to prepare us for that approach or attunement, which can only, if anything, come from the speculative mediums of art and poetry.

Cary Wolfe

“The orchid mantis has a really exceptional lifeway in the form of this aggressive mimicry where it disguises itself as an orchid to attract pollinators and so its prey flies right into it. It also has this funny history as it entered the european science knowledge, discovered by Alfred Russel Wallace which, upon seeing them in Indonesia, categorizes them as a carnivorous plant as first.”

Institute of Queer Ecology

Module II.
Session #25
15/05/2023



Nick and Lee, founders of the Institute of Queer Ecology, describe their practice as a drag performance of academia that allows them to enter certain decision-making spaces and allow artists to step out of their individual practices, privileging collaboration as the art process itself. This form of mimicry, tell is less about disappearing into the background than it is an exercise of flamboyance: like the orchid mantis, they become more colorful and more attractive than the thing they are mimicking.

Reading from Jose Esteban Muñoz and Bell Hooks, they define queerness as an ideality, as the insistence of potentiality or concrete possibilities for (an)other world(s). But we can’t build the world we are trying to inhabit without a dreaming and visualizing it first, without some sort of road map. Thus, they argue, being at odds with everything around you also means being able to invent and create and find a space to speak from and to live. Its about desire and intimacy of the self with its surroundings. And, in that sense, it is ecological: it is fundamentally about connectedness. And thats the goal of ecology, to understand the network.

“The relationship with the natural world not as a source to learn from... as the knowledge that is extracted from the natural world. I believe that there is a difference between learning from the outside and actually feeling from the inside, having an experience that allows us to understand things differently, sort of an embodied epistemology. Art has the capacity to do this.”

Filipa Ramos

Module II.
Session #27
18/05/2023



What does it mean to be human when your humanity is confronted with the captivity of non-human animals being displayed as entertainment tokens within a zoo? Or when you attend to a public cultural program hosted in an architectural complex that worked as a slaughter house during most part of the past siecle? What slippages, both material and symbolic, are involved in the substitution of systematic bloodshed with ballet? And where does the slaughter actually goes, since it surely does not end?

* These are some of the many questions that our first Postnatural Independent Program (PIP) prompted, thanks to the fantastic mediation of curator and researcher Filipa Ramos, and her situated talk in Matadero Madrid. As part of our programming, she took us from la Casa de Fieras in Retiro park to Madrid’s zoo, where we talked about spectacle and grief, brutalist architecture for animals, concealment, the speciesist gaze, and regimes of care.

“The importance of improvisation in my practice has to do with the aim to reverse knowledge sharing, but also with being silly, allowing yourself to fail, try again, and having your peers support you. It is about bringing stimulations that are related to how our practices actually work.”

Module III.
Session #30
19/06/2023



When you work as a curator, you frequently work with artists without knowing exactly how their final work will look until the very last moment, and you need to conceptually accompany it in a way that is inspired and convincing.

In that direction, indonesian curator Gesyada Siregar’s developed a fire module consisting in a “Curatorial karaoke pitch” by means of a power point. It was meant to be used during pandemic times specifically for zoom in order to bring about vulnerability, joy, spontaneity, and trust in the colleagues’ support. In this atypical karaoke, each participant had to improvise a 5 minutes speculative curatorial pitch based on 6 different random images put together by her and receive “feedback” by a drag “council”.

Joyfully mocking/mimicking the uncertainties that accompany curatorship, the kind of mediation is meant to make us aware of the complexities involved in speaking on behalf of something or someone else, in trying to convince an audience of ideas that perhaps you did not have in advance.

Gesyada Siregar

“... [As investigators] we are not going to understand some things; you cannot feel the experience of somebody that you are not, or with whom you don’t share the same way or condition. So, for me, it is a really interesting how fiction can talk about the things that we do not understand as image makers (...). What I understood about that is that we didnt see the same landscape, because there is not such thing as one landscape.”

Paloma Contreras



Paloma Contreras is a multidisciplinary artist working with sculpture, video, literary works, and installation, and exploring issues like gender, territory, narcotraffic, and violence.

Her focus lies in what she calls “ghost stories”: representing political spectrums through storytelling, unraveling the fabric of nostalgia that is created by the rewriting of Latin America’s history by means of massive international entertainment companies that romanticize guerrillas and narco violence.

The state of Mexico is opaque regarding the disappearance of people and the ongoing feminicides. In that sense, for her, it is a country that has many truths; an apparatus of the non-naming of things. And, in this context, the landscape becomes a forensic archive, it welcomes bodies into the soil and takes care of them as a motherly figure. The abstraction of the landscape and its capitalization becomes a very convenient thing for these mainstream fictions, but the landscape has its own agenda: it is an ally to both the state and to guerrilla movements. Mexican culture is, for Paloma, about subtext and subtitles. As she puts it, the Mexican night is not only a climatic night but a political night, an infrastructure of silence and obscury.

“The will of the caterpillar is to resist the butterfly.”

Module III.
Session #31
20/06/2023



Báyò Akómoláfé’s way of thinking is an invitation to “sit within the cracks”. To rethink over-used and everyday concepts, like the concept of justice, which, for him, has less to do with the postponement of injustice than with the creative iteration of the conditions that make injustice intelligible.

The “ant death spiral of death” or “ant mill” is a phenomenon in which a group of ants loose the scent trail of pheromones and start following each other, looping back to their own scent and giving place to an endless circle that they follow until they die of exhaustion. In that sense, Bàyó proposes that we may be living in an “anthromilieu”. What if modernity, or whiteness, enact this form of sensorial capture? We tell each other to keep going, to be persistent, but, as with the ants, the world exceeds these pheromonic captures.

As vengeance for some of his tricks, Zeus had Prometheus nailed to a mountain and sent a giant eagle to eat his immortal liver, which constantly replenished itself, only to be eaten again in this form of eternal punishment. Taking this myth as a model, Bàyó contests that, in todays context, it has become increasingly difficult to differentiate between healing and trauma, since repair is the very thing that makes the punishment possible, and vice versa.

Báyò Akómoláfé

“... if the environment is super, super, foreign, it makes us want to belong even more. We do want to be aliens. We are all just aliens looking for a home. Alienness is not something to be afraid of.”

Mary Maggic

Module III.
Session #33
26/06/2023



What does it mean to live in what they call the “estro-world”, a world of molecular colonization of landscapes and bodies? A permanently polluted world? To them, it entails living with a kind of double trauma. The first layer would be caused by industrial molecules that negatively affect our bodies and also the bodies of other-than-human beings. The second layer of trauma would arise when we become paralized in the fear and the panic of our bodies and our environments changing; and it is this fear, they argue, that actually prevent us from coping with the world. In view of this scenario, Mary proposes bio-hacking as a main strategy and methodology; both revealing the estro-world and allowing to get away from it, however partially.

Analysing different representations of hormones, they ask: were the hormones themselves been given a gender? What is their actual relation to femininity and masculinity? They look at molecules not only as black boxes to be open but also as symbolic indexes referring to gender, sex, and sexuality, and several different norms about what is allegedly natural. But hormones are already all around us in the form of environmental toxicity. Petro-chemical, agricultural, and pharmaceutical industries are responsible for that. So, how do we decolonize our bodies and our environments?

“While an apocalypse is an opinion of a particular way of being present in the world, each of these ends of the world will also mobilize a certain architectural conception or a certain way of organizing space, either implicitly or explicitly.“

Module III.
Session #34
04/07/2023



In its recent report The Closing Window, the United Nations Environment Program calls for a “rapid transformation of societies” to address the climate crisis. In particular, it identifies architecture as one of the basic fields of action on which to accelerate transformations without which global warming would reach critical levels.

The UN’s report links architecture with the end of the world: if drastic measures in buildings are not taken, we will be heading into an apocalyptic scenario. Architecture may be considered one of the main battlefields on which an ecological end of the world is being disputed. However, global warming is not the only way in which architecture participates in the end of the world. In every apocalyptic formulation, different architectures take part in different ways, in different potential Collapses. Architectures of the end of the world are very real. We dwell in them. Far from being abstract formulations, they are specific spaces in which a particular end of a particular world is being disputed.

Uriel Fogué

Nomen Omen

On the fate and destiny of the Matadero de Madrid

Filipa Ramos, April-June 2023

These weeks leading to the delivery of this original talk were of anguish and pain, not because I was physically unwell (I wasn't) but because of a theoretical sickness: I had been disturbed by where the decision of bringing together place and theme for the inaugural lecture of my seminar for the Postnatural Independent Program has led me to. My intention to discuss where this talk was situated (to think where we are now and why we were in a Matadero rather than somewhere else), as way to further think about what that complex term "Postnatural" means and does, renovated in my mind a series of narratives, images and data that have led to my sufferance.

The starting point for this decision had to do with the fact that the "Postnatural" isn't an abstract, theoretic and trendy concept. It is a condition that emerges from and infiltrates the materials and histories that concern us, humans, as a species and define our relationship with those "we" have considered "other". The Postnatural a concrete expression of the manners in which we engendered strategies and artefacts to dominate all other living and non-living agencies in the planet, accommodate them to our own purpose and transform them for our own benefit. The "Postnatural" isn't a new term either. It is at least as old as domestication and so its chronology is also "prehistoric". In fact, I would suggest to replace the concept of domestication by that of postnaturalism, as very few of the vegetal and animal species that have been domesticated by humans are cared for enough to be considered part of the family and the house, the *domus* that gives the term domestication its origin. They'd be known as postnatural cows and lambs, chicken and dogs, apple trees and wheat grains. Postnatural dolphins and seals in aquaria and postnatural tulip bulbs, many of which were transformed as to bloom but not reproduce.

If the domesticated is a clear concept, it is difficult and complex to try to say what the "natural" is—so many people have tried it with little or confused success. But it is straightforward to draft a range of manifestations of the postnatural, as it is freer from the essentialism associated to the term nature while it reveals an intention, an influence and an induced process of metamorphosis and transformation in which the relationship between nature and culture (so hard to situate when attempting to define one or the other) is not only entangled but also intrinsically part of its definition.

One of these manifestations, and one that has roots in ancient, prehistoric processes of adaptation of animals for human consumption (that is in selecting animals that were docile and trustful towards people to make them even more trustful and docile so that they could be easily transformed into bodies and corpses of extraction), can be observed exactly in this place where we were at the talk of the talk: a *matadero*, a building whose name derives from the Spanish verb "matar", to kill. *Nomen omen*, the name is an omen, and the matadero is a place of celebration of the necropolitical agendas of humans upon other animals, where the bodies of living oxen, sheep and fowl were murdered, disassembled and rendered into things for people and other animals to eat and wear, as their flesh and skin were transformed in food and leather through a series of material and conceptual operations.

It is the investigation of this building and site, of its history, purpose and function, and the analysis of its contribute to a wider investigation into the roots and terminations of the Postnatural as a concept that defines who we are and how we live, that led me to revisit an area of research that in the past has caused me so much sufferance that it introduced major changes in the manners in which I organise my life, conditioning what I decide to put in and on my body, shaping my academic profile, determining what I have and have not studied and

written about. And even if the history of slaughterhouses has defined who I am today, this has been the first time that I publicly share my research and thoughts about them, and I thank the Institute for Postnatural Studies for this important opportunity. I do it with the goal of sharing ideas and information about the space we occupy, its long history of enmeshment of the natural, the postnatural and the cultural, and its current engagement with a new mission that may have altered the rhythm, smell and sound of this place, but not its memory.

I start from a beginning that pre-writes the history of this Matadero. In the early of the 16th century, during the reign of the Catholic Monarchs (the cousins Isabella I of Castile and Ferdinand II of Aragon), there was a general growth and organization of butchers in Spain. They established their own guilds, which gave origin to a series of large slaughterhouses that appeared across several cities in Spain, transferring what was previously done as domestic or religious labour (the sacrifice of animals) to a pre-industrial environment that attended to a growing system of disassembling and redistributing animal bodies (and to the gradual separation of the practices of slaughtering, butchering and tanning). On this matter, it is interesting to consider how Karl Marx, in *Das Kapital*, defines abstract labour as *Gallerte*, "which in English would translate as aspic, brawn, or gelatine—all achieved by boiling down animal parts", unqualified labour equalling, or deriving from the disassembling and decomposition of slaughtered animals.[1]

One of the most important slaughterhouses of Madrid was located in the current Plaza Mayor, as attested by the building of the Casa de la Carnicería, a matadero municipal located at what was then considered the outskirts of Madrid. But with the gradual expansion of the urban tissue, slaughterhouses would periodically find themselves at the core of the city, not because they were displaced but by the virtue of not moving at all: as the city expanded, slaughterhouses were no longer located in its periphery, but in its new centre. So they had to be moved further outwards, originating new buildings and activities associated to them. For instance, in the beginning of the 17th century, the new matadero that was built in the Plaza de Cascorro gave origin to the famous Rastro market, whose name, literally meaning the "trail", echoes how the bodies of the slaughtered cattle that were transported from the abattoir to the tannery, located in Ribera de Curtidores, left a trail (a *rastro*) of blood along the street.[2]

In the 19th century, science identified proteins as a class of organic compounds that have large molecules with long chains of amino acids and are an essential part of all living organisms, especially as structural components of body tissues such as muscle and hair. It became widely understood that they existed in concentrated levels in the flesh of animals and therefore meat consumption became a priority in European and North American politics of economic growth and social expansion. It became important to assure its production, distribution and access across all spheres of society but in particular to men in working and reproductive age, who were expected to have stamina and speed, to be "strong", "virile" and capable of living, working and reproducing for longer.[3] There are a series of popular sayings that survived until the present times and that attest to such crossing of sexual and alimentary associations to meat, as the English "meat is muscle" or the Spanish "carne cocida, me da la vida" (boiled meat gives me life) and even that reinforced misogynistic, phallocentric politics of meat consumption, as "a la galga y a la mujer, no le des la carne a ver" ("show no meat to the bitch or the woman"). Or, as argued by the economist Otto Hausburg, the first director of Berlin's public slaughterhouse: "healthy and inexpensive meat is a question of survival for [lower] classes, especially for the large number of manual laborers".[4]

1 McKenzie Wark, *Sensoria* (London: Verso, 2020), 12. On the subject, cf. Keston Sutherland, *Stupefaction* (Calcutta: Seagull Books, 2011).

2 On the history of Madrid's slaughterhouses, cf. Pilar Rivas Quinzaños, "Pasado y presente de los Mataderos Madrileños", *El Comercio Tradicional Madrileño: El Ensanche Sur y la Ribera del Manzanares* (Madrid: Cámara de Comercio y Industria, 1986) Cuadernos VII: 141- 154.

3 On the issue, cf. Carol J. Adams, *The Sexual Politics of Meat: A Feminist-Vegetarian Critical Theory* (New York: Continuum, 1990).

4 As quoted by Dorothee Brantz in "Animal Bodies, Human Health, and the Reform of Slaughterhouses in Nineteenth-Century Berlin", *Food & History*, vol. 3, nº 2 (2005): 193.



Main street of the Municipal Slaughterhouse ca. 1916, Madrid. Phototopia by Hauser & Menet.

In the age of discovery of microbes and pathogens, health and hygiene associated to food became major concerns, so it was fundamental to supervise and control the production of meat. Slaughterhouse reforms were a widespread European phenomenon during the 19th century. Closely linked to other large-scale developments like the urbanization of cities and their inherent population growth, the emergence of new industries, the development of new technologies and the expansion of scientific knowledge as well as the transformation of political agencies and public hygiene regimes, the reform and expansion of slaughterhouses attested Europe's gradual shift from an agrarian society to an increasingly industrialized context. And at the same time as health and hygiene were priorities, as slaughterhouses polluted and contaminated streets and waterways, they also caused a noise and olfactory disturbances, affecting the physical and mental health of those living in their vicinity. While slaughterhouses should remain under hygienic control and supervision, it was likewise important for urban authorities to guarantee the reduction of "the emanations and other nuisances of private abattoirs, remove livestock from the city, and ensure the control of meat safety and quality".[5]

5 Branz, "Animal Bodies" (2005), 201.

It is within this context that between the end of the 19th and the beginning of the 20thcentury, and after some polemic, the Madrid City Council assigned to architect Luis Bellido y González (1869-1955), the task of planning a modern, efficient and large slaughterhouse that ought to serve the modern, efficient and large city that Madrid aspired to. But for that, it was necessary for the architect to travel and discover how other, probably more modern European cities were organising their meatpacking industries. In the summer of 1907, Bellido received a municipal grant for a research trip to visit slaughterhouses in various European capitals and draw up a proposal based on this comparative study. This grant, which now seems exceptional, was a standard practice. For instance, in June 1865, while preparing the project of the Berlin public slaughterhouse, a special German commission embarked on a six-month expedition to visit slaughterhouses across Europe. They visited 33 cities in Germany, Switzerland, Italy, France, Belgium and Great Britain and compiled a 490-page report about the organization and productivity of these slaughterhouses.[6] This study wasn't only concerned with the architecture and administration of the abattoir but was also with legislation, in particular with the gain of control and power of slaughterhouses via the enforcement of stricter controls of where and how animals were killed. Matters concerning the manners in which butchers were forced to slaughter their livestock in public contexts were of particular interest, as this was something they resisted: while favouring centralized municipal markets, they opposed the control that the centralization of slaughterhouses exerted upon their practice and commerce.

Bellido was particularly inspired by the German model of slaughterhouses and he visited facilities in Berlin, Cologne, Breslau, Offenbach and Leipzig. He noticed how in all of them, market and slaughterhouse were adjacent and how specialisation was put in

6 Theodore Risch, *Bericht über Schlachthäuser und Viehmärkte in Deutschland, Frankreich, Belgien, Italien, England und der Schweiz — Im Auftrage des Magistrats der Haupt- und Residenzstadt Berlin*, Berlin, 1866.

action. For instance, he analysed how the Germans had specialised slaughter halls for each type of animal (cattle, calves, sheep, pigs, poultry), open-plan halls, used electric monorails for transporting carcasses, implanted cold storage facilities and sanitary areas. Bellido's project, which featured 12 hectares of built-up area with several warehouses and buildings of neo-Mudéjar architecture (a type of Moorish revivalist architecture practised in the Iberian Peninsula) that would host what he called "a small productive city", ("una pequeña ciudad productiva") was submitted in April 1910 alongside a 150-page report.[7] The proposal was soon approved.[8]

What Bellido's project reveals is whereas the reforms of the slaughterhouses centred on the actual transformation of physical space, they also attested to changing notions about urban body culture, shedding light on the complex relationships between human and animal bodies, even as livestock (and its killing) was increasingly removed from the sight, smell, touch and sound of urban people's lives. The Matadero y Mercado Municipal de Ganados de Madrid (Slaughterhouse and Municipal Livestock Market of Madrid) was to be built the periphery of the city, far from sight and contact with the bodies of the animals and workers. It was located in the Dehesa de Arganzuela, the Arganzuela meadow, a pastureland area on the banks of the Manzanares River, in the south of Madrid. The constant displacement of slaughterhouses away from city life was not simply related to logistic and productive conditions. There were other reasons why slaughterhouses should be kept remote and unreachable and a true politics of invisibility was set in place to assure this distance and lack of physical and visual contact. As mentioned, the development of microbiology and the discovery of microbes, pathogens and parasites in and around animal corpses, led to the development

7 Luis Bellido, *El nuevo matadero y mercado de ganados. Memoria explicativa del edificio* (Madrid: Imprenta Municipal, 1918).

8 On Luis Bellido's Project, cf. Pilar Rivas Quinzaños, *Luis Bellido: vida y obra de un arquitecto municipal* (Madrid: MOPU, 1988).



Main facade of the slaughterhouse. 1910.
Signed by the Municipal Architect Luis Bellido. Scale 1:100. Madrid.

of a wholly new paradigm of hygiene (which came to dominate and characterise Western modernity) in which medical, political and architectural strategies were devised to separate and prevent as much as possible the contamination of animal and human life. Also, what happened within these spaces should not leave their walls, as it often happens with spaces of production, from the slaughterhouse to the factory to the museum. As artist Hito Steyerl mentions in her well-known essay "Is a Museum a Factory?": "the space of the factory is traditionally more or less invisible in public. Its visibility is policed, and surveillance produces a one-way gaze. Paradoxically, a museum is not so different [...] Just as the work performed in the factory cannot be shown outside it, most of the works on display in a museum cannot be shown outside its walls. A paradoxical situation arises: a museum predicated on producing and marketing visibility can itself not be shown—the labor performed there is just as publicly invisible as that of any sausage factory".[9]

9 Hito Steyerl, "Is a Museum a Factory?", *e-flux journal* #7 (June-August 2009), 5.

To this I wanted to add a contrasting narrative: at the same time, slaughter has been enjoyed and capitalized on its visibility rather than sought invisibility. There were moments and contexts in which tours of abattoirs were very popular and the industry played a large role in publicizing the modern nation's efficiencies, namely that of death by electrocution, which provided a clean, quick death in which there was no blood and physical penetration of the animal. This window did not remain open for long, however; although tours of slaughter-houses have continued across the twentieth century and into the twenty-first (often with the pedagogical purpose of giving schoolchildren a glimpse of industrial economy), the space of slaughter has become increasingly identified with resistance to graphic exposure, so that films of slaughterhouses circulated by animal rights organizations in the second half of the twentieth and the twenty-first century have been seen as forced glimpses into a clandestine space barred from the public view and have often been used against them as proof in the accusation of crimes of trespassing and invading private property.[10]

Considering the visual politics of the slaughterhouse, there is a third element to be taken into account, besides concerns with public health and with the opacity of production: the potential effects of exposing people to violence and the consequences of the involuntary constitution of a collective body of forensic witnesses who can attest to what happens in these spaces dedicated to animal death. What is not seen is not narrated nor archived. It remains inexistent so that habits, practices, sensibilities and mentalities are not transformed. If people do not see, smell or hear lambs being beheaded, pigs screaming in pain, cows terrified with fear or chicks being crushed to death, the activities of the slaughterhouse, the conditions of meat industry and the ethics of meat production and consumption remain largely unchallenged. Few want to eat in the company of guilt. The thought of the death of another living being is rarely taken to the table. To support this voluntary and induced oblivion, linguistic operations of divorce are set in place to ensure that, for instance, pork is no longer a pig, veal isn't a young calf, lamb isn't a sheep. Measures to prevent children and women from accessing slaughterhouses were more concerned with how the eventual rise of an animal rights group and vegetarian activism would jeopardize the operativity and the economy of the slaughterhouse than in preventing these groups from being traumatised by what they would encounter. Furthermore, as feminist animal rights advocate author Carol J. Adams brilliantly explores in her book *The Sexual Politics of Meat* (previously cited), in which she analyses how *who* we eat is determined by the patriarchal politics of our culture, "vegetarianism and animal activism in general accompany social activism on behalf of disenfranchised people"[11] and nothing is more dangerous for the regular factory manager than a wave that disrupts both the making and the makers.

Returning to this slaughterhouse where the talk took place, its construction began in 1911 and, having faced several delays caused by budgetary imbalances in the town hall and the lack of iron during the First World War, it was inaugurated in 1924. Over the years, the 48 areas that had originally been built eventually grew to 64. The slaughterhouse also gave rise to the Colonia Pico del Pañuelo in Arganzuela, where its workers lived in a small industrial town that also hosted a chapel and had its own railway line for the transport of meat. For more than six decades, between 1924 and 1996, around 400 and 500 oxen and 5000 sheep were killed every day in this space. It is worth repeating these figures, as they were repeated every day, from 1924 to 1996, when around 5500 animals were brought to the Matadero to be killed and eaten. It is no wonder that Israeli historian Yuval Noah Harari argues that "Animals are the main victims of history, and the treatment of domesticated animals in industrial farms is perhaps the worst crime in history".[12]

10 On the subject, cf. Nicole Shukin, *Animal Capital — Rendering Life in Biopolitical Times* (Minneapolis, University of Minnesota Press, 2009).

11 Carol J. Adams, *The Sexual Politics of Meat: A Feminist-Vegetarian Critical Theory* (New York: Continuum, 1990). Preface to the 10th edition (2010), 15.

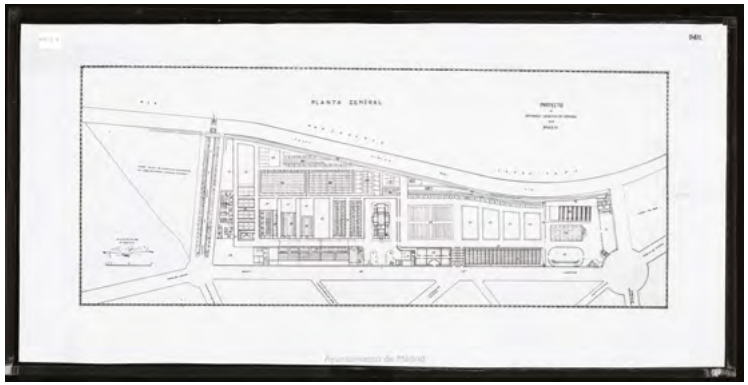
12 Yuval Noah Harari, "Industrial farming is one of the worst crimes in history", *The Guardian* (25 September, 2015).



Luis Bellido y González. Project for a slaughterhouse and livestock market in Madrid. 1914

Even the Madrid Matadero's building suffered its own mutilations. Changes to the complex started in the early 1980s, when the slaughterhouse was concentrated in its southern part and several vacant rooms in northern part were remodelled and repurposed: in 1982, the management pavilion (now known as the Casa del Reloj, House of the Clock—the clock being a fundamental tool for industrialization as it imposed a standard time for labour) was transformed into the Junta Municipal de Arganzuela; in 1990, the cattle stables were repurposed to host the headquarters of the National Dance Company and the National Ballet of Spain (there is something remarkable in this transference between the animals and human bodies in movement) and in 1992 the cattle shed was converted into the Palacio de Cristal de la Arganzuela.

With the incorporation of Spain into the European Economic Community in 1985, further changes were made to adapt the Madrid slaughterhouse to European regulations. Despite the fact that the facilities were still active, the reconversion plans announced its imminent shutdown. Hygiene and sanitary conditions were poor and productivity was low compared to newer, more modern standards. In 1996, the slaughterhouse was closed for good. Today, there are around 650 authorised slaughterhouses in Spain, of which only 10 are in the Community of Madrid. The meat sector is the largest and most important of all the sectors that make up the Spanish food and drink industry, with around 910 million animals slaughtered each year. "Overall, there are 2.5 million kills a day, 104,000 every hour,



Luis Bellido y González. Project for a slaughterhouse and livestock market in Madrid. 1914

1,700 every minute and almost 30 every single second".[13] A large part of the processed meat industry is not located in the Community of Madrid, but in other communities in its surroundings (the highly polemical industrial slaughterhouse of Getafe, which has been denounced several times for animal mistreatment and in 2022 suffered a massive fire, is a good example of this).[14]

In 1997, the new General Urban Development Plan of Madrid included the Municipal Slaughterhouse in the Catalogue of Protected Buildings, assigning it Level 2 protection (structural). After its closure, a succession of proposals for alternative uses of the space were put forward, such as an Architecture Museum, municipal libraries, multiplex cinemas or a shopping centre. In the meantime, the slaughterhouse buildings remained abandoned and subjected to further deterioration. There was a project to locate the headquarters of Telemadrid (a public regional television station in the Community of Madrid) in the old stables, another to host the UNED - Universidad Nacional de Educación a Distancia, the only university run by the central government of Spain. There were also plans for a so-called City of Culture, Leisure and Technology. In 2003, a

13 "Spain slaughters 910 million animals for meat exports", in *Murcia Today* (21 September, 2021).
14 "Un incendio arrasa un matadero de Getafe y obliga a desalojar numerosas naves por el humo", *El Mundo* (3 May, 2022).

there was even an agreement with the ARCO Foundation to house its permanent collection in the former sheep and pig exhibition halls, an idea that was eventually aborted.

In 2005, the transformation of the southern area of the old complex into a centre for cultural and artistic activities began. The conversion of the slaughterhouse into a cultural space is aligned to other restoration initiatives of former industrial spaces in Spain, such as the Laboral, in Gijón, and the Tabakalera in San Sebastián. The size of the whole Matadero's space and the complexities of adapting each area for a different purpose involved a series of architectural practices. Lote 6, which hosted the talk, previously hosted the abbatoir's refrigerating chambers. It received interventions by several architects, namely Arturo Franco and Fabrice Van Teslaar, Churtichaga and Cuadra-Salcedo and José Antonio García Roldan. It is curious to think how, in the moment in which large factories and industrial complexes are for the most part gone of Europe, and certainly of its urban perimeters, "emptied out, machines packed up and shipped off to China", as Hito Steyerl mentions,[15] museums and art centres occupy their place, but also their function in terms of assuring the continuation of a steady rhythm of production: of images, ideas, affects and gestures, but also of politics, jargons, lifestyles and values, and of attention, distraction and boredom. "Of exhibition value, speculation value, and cult value. Of entertainment plus gravitas. Or of aura minus distance. A flagship store of Cultural Industries, staffed by eager interns who work for free. A factory, so to speak, but a different one. It is still a space for production, still a space of exploitation [...] a space of physical meeting and sometimes even common discussion".[16] Within this ecology, spectators play the double role of being producers and consumers. They are allured, desired, attracted, brought it, not forcibly (more questionable in the case of school children) but similarly herded in like the animals before.

15 Steyerl, "Is a Museum a Factory?" (2009), 1.
16 Steyerl, "Is a Museum a Factory?" (2009), 3.

Once inside, they are not killed but stunned: astonished, overwhelmed and often tired with all that is being presented inside for them, through them, with them. “A monument to mass simulation effects, the [Art] Centre functions like an incinerator, absorbing and devouring all cultural energy [...] The neighborhood all around is merely a buffer zone, recoated, disinfected by snobbish and hygienic design, psychologically. It’s a vacuum-making machine, somewhat like nuclear power centers. Their real danger lies not in lack of safety, pollution explosion, but in the maximum-security system that radiates from them, the zone of surveillance and deterrence that spreads by degrees over the entire terrains—a technical, ecological, economic, geopolitical buffer zone. The center is a matrix for developing a model of *absolute* security, subject to generalization on all social levels, one that is most profoundly a model of deterrence”, wrote Jean Baudrillard of the Pompidou Centre in 1982.[17] Not so different from today’s operativity of the art centre, even without taking into account how cultural spaces rely on the enhancement of spectator’s productivity and outreach (the communication of everything) through digital hyperconnectivity and its effects on the deterioration on mental, hence physical, health. If slaughterhouses promised to deliver and extend human life through the killing of nonhumans, the converted art spaces are delivering anxiety and control through the instrumentalization of the humanoids we may become. But my aim is not to kill or destroy the museum, which would be a dangerous and wrong position to take in the times we are living. My intention is instead to share my thoughts on the fact that the decision of turning a slaughterhouse into a series of art and cultural spaces matters. It’s not a mere operation of requalification and regeneration, like architects and urban planners like to call these changes on buildings, as if their original function and history had been deleted by magic and simply became an easy name to nostalgically celebrate an activity from the past.

17 Jean Baudrillard, “The Beaubourg-Effect: Implosion and Deterrence”, *October* 20 (Spring 1982): 3.

Nomen omen. A building with such a denomination has a function and destiny it cannot ignore or delete. Regardless of where we have decided to position ourselves in the food chain arrangement, let’s not forget what happened in this space, in its goal and ambition to control our bodies and the bodies of other individuals, human and non. Let’s not forget that society is controlled not only through ideas and affects but first and foremost through and with the body and its material components. May this place be a constant reminder of this, because consciousness and awareness, alongside that beautiful pulsion that is desire, are excellent companions to change.

An ever changing space

Sketching possible relational constellations*

Lorenzo Sandoval

In the last week of September 2021, the virus seemed to be in a relaxed mode. Many of the cultural projects that were hibernating all the previous months were reactivated, abandoning partially the videoconference routines that were spreading for the year and a half before. This back-to-gathering, very shy and still masked, was collapsing shared calendars of different organizations and individuals, provoking a general regime of exhaustion. Previous timetables looked like twisted metal bars, like time-junk mess spreading through digital sheets, like a Ballard phantom in charge of writing the disarrangement of a clock hammering, which tick-tock beats were falling into the wrong tempo. There was a common feeling of losing the proper location of placing events with accuracy in the past. At that period, like in many other recent conversations, the composition of time in the individual consciousness was distorted, as crippled was the general organization of human life during the whole two last years. The linear progression of capitalist time was perceptually broken. Dystopian sensations felt timeless and überpresent. A transversal quickly replicable microscopic entity blurred the thresholds of multiple cleavages.

At the impasse of this temporary reactivation in Berlin (soon after, the numbers of infected people would rise again, apparently for the last time in a confinement mode), the *Metabolic Rift* (an ambitious exhibition tour and multi-part concert series) opened at Kraftwerk. I took the (un)guided tour —as it was described in the brochure—, which lead the group we were across the base and corridors of the former power station,



Nature's Hunger, Lorenzo Sandoval 2022**

pacing the walk with the assistance of the artworks themselves as if we were traversing the scenarios of a Doom video game. They conducted us with light, sound, sculpture, and film. Afterward, a performer walked the cluster of people up, from the bottom to the top floor, climbing the levels that separate both doors. We came into the immense turbine room, illuminated with daylight (artificially created, I would learn later, with cinema lights). The chamber itself was impressive, its volumes softly contoured by a bath of zenithal light. Soon, a piece made of sound and an inflatable sculpture started, danced, and deflated after some long minutes. The silence that remained was itself impressive, as the music in the previous moments, leaving some beeping afterwards, perhaps closer to one of those beeps that remain in the mind, in the shape of a sonic ghost, as if the not-working-since-long-time factory setting was now part of our brain cavity. The consciousness of the industrial complex became an extension of our own consciousness, one cavity being the resonance of the other on a different scale. This sonic specter — perhaps imaginary, and only existing in the glitches that memory tends to introduce while remembering situations— of the paced bleeping brought the ensemble of people towards the next door, descending towards another cadence: in this next instance, the group could disperse through a

more open arrangement of pieces in the main hall of the former energy station. One of the main powers of Atonal's project had to do with the constant transition (and transaction) among the different pieces: while keeping their own distinctive agency, they *continued* each other. By the unceasing change of lights and sonic means, switching on and off of projections, lowering and rising of screens, fading in and out of sounds, spreading of smoke and leaving it to quietly disappear, the inclusion of parts of the architecture as narrative elements, and even, the insertion of pieces that literal and lively grew during the course of the project, the effect produced was that those artworks were affecting and were affected by the others. They worked as a fertile compound.

There was a certain dark, theatric ecology, like an atmosphere in constant decay and remaking, rather than an exhibition as such. The whole multilayered and multifaceted assembly of works, architecture, and technic infrastructure worked as a single composition, like we were in an evolving forest with alive elements made of organic entities, and plastic and metallic beings also growing with their carbosilicon[1] nervous systems inside. Even the moving audience was part of it, acting as performative agents in their displacement, as relevant as the concerts, in the general (un)plotting of this perceptual ever-changing apparatus. In its cinematic scenography, of course, the setting recalled films like *Blade Runner*, *Silent Running*, and *Mad Max*, or it had some echoes from the atmospheres in Butler's *Xenogenesis* series. But instead of bringing us to future stances, its ambiances rendered in the shape of a ghostly traversing through many scenes of a shared temporality: it compressed many geochronographic climates conjugated in the present tense.

1 *They initiated and extended two technological lineages: the civilizations of Carbon and Silicon, respectively, the one of energy as a medium of motion and the one of energy as a medium of control and communication. The two regimes carried different entropic costs and also quite different colonial costs, having been developed at different historical stages and latitudes of the planet.* PASQUINELLI, Matteo, "The Automaton of the Anthropocene: On Carbosilicon Machines and Cyberfossil Capital", South Atlantic Quarterly, 2017, https://www.academia.edu/25459844 [last seen: 14-05-2022]

The Metabolic Rift

The reflection on the notion of the *metabolic rift* was quite present in the way Atonal's gathering operated. The fact that it unfolded in a former energy plant, made the proposal of the curators even more discursively thought-provoking. If we were thinking literally, the *Kraftwerk* was then a privileged place from where to think of this project, which departure point is a process of energy exchange. In this case, the word applied to the relationship between people and industrial societies; *Metabolism* can be read here as the transformation of fossil- derivate energy into the energy necessary to operate the whole compound of a city: from its massive industrial processes, the lights that organize traffic, the moving of the wagons of the different types of trains, the illumination of any of the architecture-machines of all the disciplinary *dispositives* like hospitals, schools, factories, prisons, police stations and so on, the cash machines of the supermarkets or any kind of shops and their calling-in windows, the fridges, TV's and computers of any house, until the last glimpse of the phone screen in the long nights of those with stress-induced insomnia. If the notion of metabolism is applied to society, this building (while it was functioning as an energy central), was one of those fundamental devices that facilitate the process of transformation from the fossil fuel into the electricity that systematizes the quotidian life. The *Kraftwerk* is a privileged site, from where understand the *rift* between nature and culture, or, in marxist terms, country, and town.

Metabolism not only describes the transformation of energy but also refers to the elimination of metabolic waste. It was precisely because the connection was not obvious at all with this part that made this proposal at Atonal so rich in entry points. John Bellamy Foster has studied extensively Marx's notion of the *metabolic rift*, from where the title of the project derived: *Marx employed the concept of a "rift" in the metabolic relation between human beings and the earth to capture the material estrangement of human beings within capitalist society from the natural conditions which formed the basis for*

their existence (...) *To insist that large-scale capitalist society created such a metabolic rift between human beings and the soil was to argue that the nature-imposed conditions of sustainability had been violated.* (...) *For Marx, the metabolic rift associated at the social level with the antagonistic division between town and country was also evident on a more global level: whole colonies saw their land, resources, and soil robbed to support the industrialization of the colonizing countries*.[2]

In describing the disconnection between country and city, Bellamy Foster brought the ecological dimension of Marx's work in connection with incipient ecological thinking. Marx took the analysis from Justus von Liebig about the disruption of the cycle of the fertility of the earth (very briefly sketched: how the sewage of the cities wouldn't return the chemical elements that the earth needs to be fertile) as a way to understand the larger process of extraction that results in the exhaustion of lands and peoples. In the project *The Ultimate Capital is the Sun*, the curators pointed out that *as a decisive dimension in the metabolism of a society, the need for energy invariably has implicated change and assumed ever different shapes. From Neolithic times to agrarian societies, from precapitalist to capitalist societies, each development has entailed the development of a new socio-metabolic regime, involving different materials patterns and flows. At the beginning of the 21st century, we are extracting 60 billion tons of raw material every year –50% more than only 30 years ago– and material consumption continues to increase*.[3]

One can say from a contemporary perspective that this was a clear precedent of the current collapse streams. Following these threads, the separation between nature and culture (or country and town as presented in Marx's texts) is one of the key elements that enable extractivism. Instead of thinking the humankind as part of nature, the capitalistic cosmovision deployed through economic reason operates a radical detachment that results inevitably in the collapse of the environments that are first taxonomically analyzed and then aggressively exploited (including humans and non-humans). Projects such as The *Metabolic Rift* might help to describe the planetary collapse we are immersed in before it's just the job of archeologists and historians[4]. It's fundamental to acknowledge that the process of collapse started already with the colonial program in many areas[5].

Natugemälde

Justus von Liebig was a protégé of Alexander von Humboldt, who would facilitate the development of his career[6]. As well, one of Marx's professors in high school studied Geology with Humboldt in Paris —Johann Steininger— who brought Marx into natural sciences.

When they returned from Chimborazo, Humboldt was ready to formulate his new vision of nature. In the Andean foothills, he began to sketch his so-called Naturgemälde - an untranslatable German term that can mean a 'painting of nature' but which also implies a sense of unity or wholeness. (...) *Even the atmosphere carried the kernels of future life - pollen, insect eggs, and seeds. Life was everywhere and those 'organic powers are incessantly at work', he wrote. Humboldt was not so much interested in finding new isolated facts but in connecting them. Individual phenomena were only important 'in their relation to the whole', he explained.* (...) *Humboldt saw 'unity in variety'. Instead of placing plants in their*

2 BELLAMY FOSTER, John, "Marx's Ecology. Materialism and nature", Monthly Review Press, New York, 2000

3 AGUDIO, Elena, ALBRECHT, Doris, Ndikung, Bonaventure, PASQUINELLI, Matteo, and SENGEZER, Eylem, "The Ultimate Capital is the SUN. Metabolism in contemporary art, politics, philosophy and science", NGBK, Berlin, 2014

4 SERVIGNE, Pablo and STEVENS, Räphael, "Colapsología", Arpa, Barcelona, 2020

5 Thanks to Eliana Otta to point this in some conversations we had trough time.

6 KORSWAGEN, Richard and IBÁÑEZ, Alfredo, "Justus von Liebig, la química agrícola y el colapso de una economía basada en el salitre", Pontificia Universidad Católica del Perú Departamento de Ciencias, Sección Química Apartado 1761, Lima, Perú, https://revistas.pucp.edu.pe/index.php/quimica/article/download/4745/4746/ [last seen: 15-05-2022]

taxonomic categories, he saw vegetation through the lens of climate and location: a radically new idea that still shapes our understanding of ecosystems today[7].

Would be possible that some of the ideas from Humboldt influenced Marx, through the work of Liebig or Steininger, even if they had their differences?[8] The notion of *Naturgemälde* can work quite well to describe the opposite side of the metabolic rift, providing a constructive counter position, or even a possible horizon against the disruption of the cycles of fertility of soil, or even once expanded, of ecosystems. In the general approach of Atonal's proposal –and in some of the works presented–, one could perceive this direction as well.

The idea of *Natugemälde* followed the holistic position that was quite present in German thought during the Romantic period[9], affecting the development of science as well, even if there was a constant impulse to separate the elements of nature into taxonomical cases. Humboldt studied the local languages in order to communicate with the indigenous people about the knowledge he had to gather[10]. He was a clear advocate for the rights of the indigenous people and their process towards independency, establishing a position that was not quite common among his fellow science colleagues[11]. The cosmovision he had access to when learning the language was attuned with some of the German positions of the period[12]. But to what extent did he recognize the epistemological knowledge gathered from indigenous people as influenced as part of his own research?

Perspectivism

There is no need in entering into the discussion of which people thought of something first, which ultimately are not productive. But it is actually fundamental to reshape the possible continuities and dissonances between diverse epistemologies since the problems we are facing are all common. These problems underline how *we continue each other* (even if we are absolutely conscious of the differences), and we are indeed a continuation of nature. And mainly, to facilitate the redistribution of the irradiation points of historically relevant discourses, repositioning power relations, and most importantly, recognition of rights.

Since the beginning of time, Omama has been the center of what white people call ecology. It's true! Long before these words existed among them and they started to speak about them so much, they were already in us, though we did not name them the same way. (...) In the forest, we human beings are the "ecology". But it is equally the xapiri *(spirits), the game, the trees, the rivers, the fish, the sky, the rain, the wind, and the sun...*

7 WULF, Andrea, The Invention of Nature. Alexander von Humbolt's New World, John Murray, London, 2015

8 While devoting most of his time at this period to the study of Political Economy and of the French Revolution, Karl Marx continued to wage fierce war with the Prussian government, and as a consequence, this government demanded of M. Guizot — it is said through the agency of Alexander von Humboldt,who happened to be in Paris — Marx' expulsion from France. MARX, Eleanor, "Karl Marx I" Progress, May 1883, pp.288-294, and "Karl Marx II" Progress, June 1883, https://wikirouge.net/texts/en/Karl_Marx_(by_Eleanor_Marx) [last seen: 14-04-2022]

9 Thanks to Matteo Pasquinelli for bringing up this comment in a conversation about this text.

10 Op. Cit. WULF, Andrea, The Invention of Nature. Alexander von Humbolt's New World, John Murray, London, 2015

11 However, Humboldt's extraordinary scientific competence prepared him to see beyond what the average scientist might have seen on his journey to the New Continent. And this made it possible for him to establish, among other luminous conclusions he drew from his work, that there are no superior races and inferior races, thus making an astonishingly prescient leap into twentieth-century anthropology. For from then on it was reasonable for him to conclude that the process of independence of the American peoples, the nature of that process, was on the right course. Many of the pre-Humboldtian prejudices were that these primitive peoples were destined to be led by so-called civilised peoples, and that the political development of the Americans was therefore directly proportional to their development as a race. QUESADA MONGUE, Rodrigo, "Humboldt, Bolívar y Marx. Encuentros y desencuentros necesarios", Revista Abra, Vol. 20 Núm. 29, Facultad de Ciencias Sociales de la Universidad Nacional (UNA), Costa Rica, 1999.

12 Thanks to Matteo Pasquinelli to point to this sintonía.

The white people who once ignored all these things are starting to hear them a little (and) now they call themselves the "people of the ecology".[13]

Can Davi Kopenawa's statement point towards the clues of the necessary changes to operate a change in the general planetary consciousness when it comes to extractivist practices? His words certainly set precedence in the process like the setting of what is being set as *rights of nature*, as introduced by other people such as Teresa Vicente[14]. The struggles that Kopenawa has been part of or the setting of the rights of nature are two concrete examples of this necessary repositioning that develops from epistemological diversity. In order to practice this synchronic positioning of diverse perspectives, there is a pressing need to understand the common threads (and differences) that might facilitate that process. Is it possible to bring the notion of transversality from politics into cultural production and being-within-nature? Or is it something that was already there (as suggested by Kopenawa) and capitalist epistemology has been erasing constantly? Understanding how there are many points of view, with their differences, but with their continuations as well, it is a prerequisite to blurry once again the thresholds between nature and culture.

As Viveiros de Castro points out, *virtually all peoples of the New World share a conception of the world as composed of a multiplicity of points of view. Every existent is a center of intentionality apprehending other existents according to their respective characteristics and powers.*[15] This multiplicity gives some tools to approach the connection between nature and culture from the complex network of interwoven positions. These are necessarily different, producing a heterogeneous space in common where enunciation is decentered. The perception (and co-shaping) of the real works under a redistributive logic, and the elements that compose it are affected and after the others. The fact that each of the existents has its own perspective, and their own rhythm or even their own codifications, challenges the rift between nature and culture. Atonal's project at Krafwerk operated in a way that gave some extra agency –over another type of presentation– to the different entities that were part of it, acting as they were in the general changing network of relations. The works were affected and affecting each other with the constant changing of rhythms.

Rhythmanalysis

In my opinion, the (un)guided tour worked so well definitely because it unfolded through the composition of a polyrhythmic entity. A reflection on the metabolic rift –as this one proposed at Kraftwerk– has to necessarily come with the reflection on rhythm production. Precisely, because it encompasses both of the main conceptions of time described by Lefebvre to approach his proposal of rhythmanalysis: the cyclical and the linear time. *The cyclical and the linear are categories, which is to say notions or concepts. Each one of these two words designates – denotes – an extreme diversity of facts and phenomena. Cyclical processes and movements, undulations, vibrations, returns, and rotations are innumerable, from the microscopic to the astronomical, from molecules to galaxies, passing through the beatings of the heart, the blinking of the eyelids and breathing, the alternation of days and nights, months and seasons and*

13 KOPENAWA, Davi and ALBERT, "The Falling Sky: Wtmir of a Yanomami Shaman", Cambridge: The Belknap Press of Harvard University Press, 2013, quote by Peter Skafish in the introduction to VIVEIROS de CASTRO, Eduardo, "Cannibal Metaphysics", Univocal, Minneapolis, 2014

14 The generations of human rights have evolved from liberal justice to social justice, where the legal subject of these rights has always been the human being, who becomes the holder not only of individual and political rights, but also of social, economic and cultural rights, and now also of environmental rights. That nature is the holder of rights, the rights of nature, implies a broader category than human rights, the category of ecological rights as an expression of ecological justice. In this sense, the serious difficulties of legal technique generated by this new legal category will have to be addressed, not only from the normative and jurisprudential point of view, but also and in line with the paradigm of ecological justice. VICENTE, Teresa, "Las relaciones entre la naturaleza y el derecho: Justicia climática y derechos humanos. ISSN-e 1576-3196, No. 37, 2020

15 VIVEIROS de CASTRO, Eduardo, "Cannibal Metaphysics", Univocal, Minneapolis, 2014

so on. As for the linear, it designates any series of identical facts separated by long or short periods of time: the fall of a drop of water, the blows of a hammer, the noise of an engine, etc. The connotation does not disappear into the denotation of these terms. The cyclical is perceived rather favorably: it originates in the cosmos, in the worldly, in nature. We can all picture the waves of the sea – a nice image, full of meaning – or sound waves, or circadian or monthly cycles. The linear, though, is depicted only as monotonous, tiring, and even intolerable.[16]

One of the most interesting Marxist interpreters, Lefebvre was certainly interested in the idea of energy interchange: *Everywhere there is an interaction between a place, a time, and an expenditure of energy there is rhythm*[17]. The rhythmanalysis project is quite powerful in this context, not only because gives us many tools to approach a critique of capitalist production, but mainly because it is pointing toward many threads beyond the exhaustion of the critique itself. The rhythmanalysts might show the possible passages towards the playing of rhythms that challenge the path towards collapse, cultures that have been growing in consonance with nature.

Sufism

As we were proposing some lines before within the Amerindian cosmopolitics, once the aim is to weave back together the vibrations that interlace nature and culture, it's necessary to conform to relational entities that support a dynamic multiplicity. In less abstract terms, it's fundamental to incorporate as many epistemologies as possible in order to break apart as many prejudices, challenging hegemonic Western/North positions. This might translate directly into the setting of human rights, and hopefully, rights of nature at large. For instance, Lefebvre brought as an example to his rhythmanalysis project the life of Mediterranean cities, with their composite of patterns in so many directions: from sound to irrigation, from textile to architecture, from ceremonies to mathematical craftsmanship, those cities in the South, which connect Africa, Middle East, and Europe, might work as great examples on proposing rhythms that question the capitalist linear one.

Sufism is a system where the whole can be found in the parts, and the parts can point toward the whole, following a logic that is dynamic and redistributive. *The combination of all the possible forms constitutes the essence of the soul as long as intangible and indefinable strength, which allows us to realize the point of convergence between the real and the possible, between the finite and the infinite. (...) This consciousness of the absolute allows us not to find anywhere clear and definitive oppositions since everything is in movement and perpetual transformation*[18] tells us Pachecho about the thinking of Ibn Arabi, one of the most preeminent Sufi philosophers, who was born in Murcia. Would it be possible to think about environmentalism also from this epistemological position? Would it be possible to connect practices of spatial production with the dialogical processes introduced by Sufism?

As a short note, the irrigation system set by the Muslim community in Murcia, and other parts of the Iberian Peninsula, is a circuit for the circulation of water and its redistribution. It has been working until today for more than 1000 years as a commons, collectively managed by the people involved in agriculture. Since its nature is of a circuit, we can say that it works as an algorithmic operation, where water enters in and out of material feedback loops. These loops support, collectively as in the management of their commons, a system of mutual support among humans, plants, and other beings that live in the orchards. It is no other thing than a sophisticated way of avoiding the metabolic rift critiqued by Liebig and

16 LEFEBVRE, Henry: "Rhythmanalysis: Space, Time and Everyday Life". Continuum, New York, 2004.
17 Op. cit. LEFEBVRE, Henry: "Rhythmanalysis: Space, Time and Everyday Life". Continuum, New York, 2004.
18 PACHECO, Juan Antonio, Ibn Arabi. El Maestro Sublime, Almuzara, Córdoba, 2019

Marx. Fertility is one of the practical and concrete outputs of Sufism. Sufism then might be one of the models we can go back to in order to think from Atonal's proposal. By actualizing this rich tradition, we also give value to the cultures that people bring with them when they migrate. This is not only an operation of giving value to the past. It's about adding more reasons to grant the rights of people and make effective processes of reparation. As Bonaventure Soh Bejeng Ndikung said recently in a conference at *MACBA: no one is illiterate. All peoples come up with songs. All peoples make fabrics*[19]. We can add here that all peoples produce rhythms, and all have value.

The chain of spatial connections allows for a structure in which there are equal constancy and change,[20] Ardalan and Bakhtair told us in their fascinating book on the Sufi architectural tradition in Persia. This statement strongly resonates with the (un)guided tour at Kraftwerk, and its many sonic and visual multiple irradiation points.

Plurifocal music

Atonal's project tends to recall sci-fi scenarios, as in this text happened here. But what about if the problem of imagining the way out of these collapsing times is the common fixation with just the future? Perhaps it's vital to operate with the plasticity of time and look at some model that challenges the linear progression that brings us all just to this dystopic future. Positions such as those above might assist to reformulate the relation with chronospatial structures, especially those which work from within multiplicity. One more device that can assist in those tasks is the notion of *plurifocal music*, coined by artist, ethnomusicologist, and composer (among many other hats) Llorenç Barber.

19 This conference was part of "Looking out of the corner of one's eye The act of weaving and politics", a seminari related to Teresa Lanceta's show "Weaving as Open Code" curated by Nuria Enguita and Laura Vallés at Macba. https://www.macba.cat/en/exhibitions-activities/activities/looking-out-corner-ones-eye [last seen: 12-06-2022]

20 ARDALAN, Nader, and BAKHTIAR, Laleh, El sentido de la Unidad. La tradición sufí en la arquitectura persa, Ediciones Siruela, Madrid, 2007

With this concept, he described his *City Concerts*, which consist of proposing whole cities as an instrument, with the preeminence of bell towers as a sonic organizer, but also incorporating many other elements such as ambulances, horse police, local instrumental bands, firemen, groups of non-musicians performing, and any other sonic mean available. In the terms of Rubén López Cano, *with the term* plurifocality *Barber refers, in the first place, to the multiplicity of sound sources that participate in each concert: as many belfries or instrumental groups as exist in each city. (...) Each focus functions as a center in itself where the individual and relatively independent musical activity takes place. In turn, each focus establishes coordination and collaboration with others to articulate larger structures that give rise to organized sectors of sound foci. The largest and most complex articulations occur when the activity of sectors is organized into macro-structures that involve the whole city.*[21]

With the term *plurifocality* there is a direct challenge of where the information comes from, breaking apart the classic positioning of the scenario and opening it to the whole city. All the sounds happening during the *City Concert* will be influencing the whole performance, adding parts here and there. Interestingly, not everyone would be having access to everything at the same time. Universality is challenged at large, but instead, it opens a process where all the performative and listening positions are valid. The political and ecological implications of Barber's proposal are a great device to learn from. The act of listening here is one of the fundamental performative actions. The *plurifocality* aligns quite well with challenging the metabolic rift, coming as it does from an ecological practice on the soundscape. The project at Kraftwerk might be thought of as well from Barber's notion.

21 LÓPEZ CANO, Rubén, "Música Plurifocal; Conciertos de Ciudades de Llorenç Barber", México: JGH-Ciencia y Cultura Latinoaméricana, Biblioteca Litterarum Humaniorum, serie Euterpe (musicología), 1997

An ever-changing exhibition

The word exhibition was not the most suitable one for introducing Atonal's proposal, and they even named their project a (un)guided tour. But let's stick to it just for a moment. Still today, the exhibition space is one of the most common ways to introduce the research carried out by artists, curators, architects, designers, photographers, activists, and so on. Even with the effort on creating discursive programs, performances, or sites for encounters, the backdrop of these formats still keeps being the exhibition, but it hardly contains the many threads that formally, conceptually, politically, or emotionally inform those different modes of research development within. However, there is the tendency to present artworks (or research) as final "objects" in themselves. So to say, they are products, and many times, are (or end up being) part of the market constellation in one way or another. More than a critique of the obvious fact that a part of the art world answer to the market, the reflection would be about how capitalist strategies impose certain spatial and productive logic into the space of the exhibition: in most cases, each exhibition is a *tabula rasa* that erases materially any history of what happened in that very same space previously, trying to create a permanent state of renovation and *newness*, as it happens in the economic motor of a neoliberal reality. Each culture proposal in the exhibition space has to be original for the audience to enjoy, in a state of perpetual erasure and renewal. But what about if it's possible to think of a system where new elements can enter what is shown, or the elements of what is presented can truly change during the course of a spatial presentation? *The Metabolic Rift* went in this direction.

Let's not be naïf and think that a process that the curators sketched with their proposal, can be commodified as any other exhibition, and in fact, there was a ticket to be paid to come in. But the problem I'd say is deeper. The cultural devices we've been working with replicate the relational logic of capitalism, where the hierarchic separation between nature and culture is the fundamental key to operating all the extractivist processes related to raw materials, people's bodies, or cultures. The process briefly described above of material and narrative erasure/renewal of the exhibition is part of the outputs of the extractivist circuitry.

Aside from the programming of exhibitions, with the described erasure/renewal dynamic, another aspect that defines exhibitions has to do with the hieratic positions that artworks are fixed to. The relations in between pieces are set in advance, so the dialogue among them is hardly dialectical. Of course, here we need to introduce the agency granted by the own references brought from the visitors, who would have different interpretations of what is presented.

The Metabolic Rift did challenge these previous points with their ever-changing proposal, where all the parts were part of a whole, and the whole was spread through all the parts, setting a dialogical space where all the pieces affected each other. It was indeed a project that made me think of the approach of people like Kropotkin in describing the connections set in nature: not presences in completions, but entities operating from a practice of mutual aid.

Bellamy Foster, collectively with other authors, drawing their lines of thought from the work of Lefebvre, might be a great place to end this (de)tour on Atonal's project: *Yet, all is not lost. An ecological revolution, rooted in the radical potential of everyday life and enveloping today's worldwide society, Lefebvre tells us, is necessary to reorganize the human relation with the Earth*[22]*.*

*This text was commissioned by Atonal on the occasion of "Metabolical Rift", an (un)guide ghost-train part of the festival edition 2021 at Kraftwerk Berlin, and it's part of a publication in preparation. The text was written in May 2022.

** *Nature's Hunger* was commissioned by Marta Ramos Yzquierdo's project *Not Only What, But Also How*, a series of 17 interventions displayed on the marquee set up in front of the headquarters of the Cultural Office of the Spanish Embassy in Washington reflecting on the 2023 Agenda; The image was made as an extension of this text, to be presented together in the publication in the making https://on.spainculture.us/not-only-what-but-also-how/lorenzo-sandoval/

22 BELLAMY FOSTER, John, NAPOLETANO, Brian M., CLARCK, Brett and URQUIJO Pedro S. "Henri Lefebvre's Marxian ecological critique: recovering a foundational contribution to environmental sociology", Environmental Sociology, 6:1, 2020DOI: 10.1080/23251042.2019.1670892, https://www.tandfonline.com/doi/full/10.1080/23251042.2019.1670892, [last seen: 14-06-2022]

19:45:45
From Adriana Gallo :
Thinking about 'we' as ligament or mortar maybe, in-between things instead of the discrete things

19:46:28
From Adriana Gallo :
(eating lunch so trying not to talk with my mouth full)

19:47:56
From Matheline Marmy :
i like the admitting weakness

19:53:26
From Ishita Jain :
That nothing is quite what it seems suggests a kind of wonder. A wonder not of a subject (not 'my' wonder) but a wondering in move- ment (a wonder that moves the me I am becoming).
Maxine Sheets-Johnstone writes:
To say that in improvising, I am in the process of creating the dance itself out of the possibilities which are mine at any moment of the dance, is to say that I am exploring the world in movement; that is, at the same time that I am moving, I am taking into account the world as it exists for me here and now. As one might wonder about the world in words, I am wondering the world directly, in movement; I am actively

19:56:42
From Ishita Jain :
Bakhtin's carnivalesque would be a great reminder to think through that too, Mad…
exploring its possibilities and what I perceive in the course of that wondering or exploration is enfolded in the very process of moving.

20:05:24
From Ama Josephine (she/her) :
t's interesting everyone's responses were so poetic

20:05:40
From Lissy Willberg (they/them) :
I wrote this little poem in 2018,
maybe someone would like to read it out?
Wandering containers
traveling upon a one-sided surface.
A journey of uncountable encounters.
Traveling upon this plane, one is meeting endlessly.
No side to no-one.
A surface for projection. The perfect simulation of
what is called real.
Thinking about illusion, is thinking about reality.
Thinking about you, is thinking about me.

20:06:27
From Ama Josephine (she/her) :
*It's interesting everyone's responses were so poetic. Almost like it's not articulatable, or there's a resistance to articulating the we/I/me/us without the veil of poetics…

20:06:52
From Raju Sachi Singh (they/them/elle) :
not mine, hahahha, although i'm into it, I think my request for mindfulness was just direct and around clarity, but I guess also a way to displace or desconstruct the imagined ideas of humanity.

01
New materialities

Dominika Wasilewska
Felix Bell
Sara Bonaventura
Hannah Hallam-Eames
Matheline Marmy

What *Spills?*

"We all spill over – running over the scratched out boundaries we've been assigned to, corroding the iron fences that contain us, melting the convenient labels that define us. We are always lost, because we are too expansive to be found, too promiscuous to be faithful, too transdimensional to be fully owned. We are spread out beyond the maps, transgressing territories, perplexing our own coordinates, entangled with the wilds in ways we are always yet to realize."

Báyò Akómoláfé

spill into

Felix Bell

When I moved into my first home, my family gifted me a rug. It was a striking rug with two vivid colours of orca and aubergine interwoven into the wool and polyester fibres, diplomatically drawing the line between restrained and ostentatious. I remember my parents would routinely tell me: "your home becomes you". However, It was not until the slow passage of time had melted away that I began to truly understand the significance behind my parents' words.

Over the years, the rug underwent a gradual transformation alongside me, silently absorbing a part of my essence within the hybrid plastic and wool fibers, intertwining our identities and mirroring one another's growth. Silently capturing remnants of memories such as the faint wine stain from a lively dinner gathering of days gone by. Or a patch colours distinctly less saturated than the others as the rug absorbed the suns rays from its tranquil presence at the heart of the room. Like ghosts of the past coming back to the present. But as I look over these vestiges of *spilled* moments I notice some patches of worn down fibres, as if a micro scythe had combed the area and that's when I see a small brown disc shaped thing exploring the gaps between the tufts.

A carpet beetle has been carving their way through the understory of my rug, feeding off the polyester-wool compost and any organic matter which has found its way into the depths of the material. To me the rug appears as a unified amalgamation of plastics, glue, wool, threads, and fabrics. However, within the intricate composition lies a multitude of micro ecosystems waiting to be discovered—a desert, vast plains, a boreal forest. To the inhabitants of these ecosystems, the rug serves as more than mere

material; the material represents a habitat, a source of nourishment, or a refuge. Material *spills* into ecosystems and becomes a world with a conceivably infinite number of other potentialities. From my eyes, I only saw the rug as an object of aesthetic beauty, keeping my feet warm in the winter months. But now I wonder what lives within the fibres? A whole other world I am oblivious to, while making my oatmeal in the morning; the fibers become a wilderness.

This insect shows me that materials can no longer be seen as isolated dead matter; they entangled assemblages full of holes which *spill* out into other assemblages. A diversity of beings flow with these *spillages* at different scales. This thought puts all the objects in my home into an almost quantum state of being, encapsulating multiple realities concurrently, each catering to different scales of existence. I almost feel the rug start to shimmer; their presence adorned with a delicate glow akin to an ethereal halo, humming between multiple, interwoven realms of reality. A porous shimmering that is ever present, ever *spilling*, although not always visible as the micro and the macro realms converge within the materials of the rug. When I focus, the materials return to the same rug I have always seen for years. But when the rug shimmers, it becomes alive.

spill over

Sara Bonaventura

I'd like you to lay down and maybe close your eyes. Focus your attention on your scalp, the skin on your scalp and you will feel a light sensation of vibrations, of warmth, relax and let go. Focus your attention on your forehead, the skin covering your forehead, and feel again the sensation of warmth, relax. Bring your attention to your eyelids, to the skin tissues covering your eyes, until you feel again this light sensation of vibrating warmth. We move on to your face, bring your attention to the cheeks and the skin covering them, feel the sensation of warmth. Move to the tongue, your jaws and try to release the tension there, relax and let go. Move on to your shoulders, feel the sensation of warmth and release the tension.

You keep this warmth with you.

Now I want you to imagine you're floating in the middle of the ocean, completely adrift but breathing normally; the water is cold but you don't really feel it, your presence can actually raise the temperature.

Now float there and imagine you have no human skin, no fingertips and you are floating due to your low density and it feels like this can go on forever, ever and ever losing sense of time. Stay there but imagine you are touching yourself, how can you hold yourself together?

You break down.

In this very moment you realize here you can move very swiftly, very light, very agile. You're shrinking and shrinking, you're shrinking so much you can go anywhere. How do you move in this quasi non-human form? Perhaps you feel like you are teleported and you let go, or you feel the water pressure and you hold on to it bringing you down and down, down to the abyss.

And as you move you see different paths, different directions, and you try to choose one but you get chosen actually. You might end up in a deep unfathomable gorge, a bottomless pitch black pit, broken down by bacterial communities or eaten up by planktons, or in the stomach of a crab, or a fish, or a whale, or even an albatross.

You *spill* over.

No matter if you were freely floating or deeply sinking, you might feel entangled to other species or to the native marine habitats now. Or you might feel even more disconnected, painfully feeling that toxicity in this degradation process. How do you feel? Do you feel any physical abrasions? Any photo-degradation? Is some light still there? Or do you feel lonely and lost?

Take your time to perceive this change.

Considering that you will stick around indefinitely like this, you will never decompose really just like microplastic debris, do you feel the desire for a companion that will support you in this eternal journey? If so, fix your attention on it before coming back. It might be one companion or many more, you're trying to make kin with them.

Come back and open your eyes, but hold this ephemeral perception with you.

spill out

Dominika Wasilewska

Imagine that you have never been an individual, an autonomous organism fenced off its exterior and unwanted otherness by the supposedly impenetrable skin. Imagine that instead, you have always been a teaming colony of beings, affects, times and memories - a party of many, an assemblage of those who were not supposed to meet, let alone gestate each other into existence. You are being held very closely, so close that the body-politics you have been inculcated with start looking like some bizarre, apocryphal conspiracy theories. Becoming thick with the other, you lose track of where you end, and the rest of the existence begins. Finally, you allow yourself to surrender to this new bodily reality - sinking in, swallowing down, *spilling* out - becoming more liquid with each breath.

Astrida Neimanis invited us to think of embodiment as watery, as a reservoir of hydrocommons of wet relations. The logic of the state of being watery is to gestate, carry, and hold other forms of life like a leguinian carrier bag holding things in relation. Le Guin's carrier bag does not resemble the well-organized purse with separate pockets for different objects, it is rather a saggy tote, where things *spill*, bounce off each other, collide and get messy. Our bodies, like those carrying sacks, are engaged in the complex circulation of liquefied memory, daring visions, unmetabolized traumas, and toxicity oozing from human desires for total independence.

The world *spills* over and gets absorbed through our porous skin, proving once again how absurd the concept of personal boundaries may be on a planet defined by contamination. What makes this earthy contamination even more ungraspable is how it moves with total negligence of the categories and ontological divisions we created to make sense of the world. Being infected by the world means not being capable of distinguishing what's humanly constructed from the "natural", genetic from environmental, and material from the semiotic. In this state of intoxication, we realize how permeable, dynamic and unstable these categories are and how their perpetual romance with otherness prevents them from maintaining any particular form for too long. By refusing to subscribe to this ordination project, we risk being absorbed into the ocean of total togetherness. Do not expect this oceanic unity to be in any way compatible with the romanticized visions of uncompromised oneness and unobstructed flow. It's a site of tense negotiations, unexpected obstructions and viscous slippages - a shambolic ooze of various corpo-realities.

spill through

Hannah Hallam-Eames

The primordial ooze

Crude oil reservoirs are formed below the seafloor when microscopic algae, plankton, and ocean inhabitants die, then *spill* through cracks and fissures

in rock beds. The lipids and fats that remain in their cells accumulate to form a reservoir of this liquid. Over hundreds of millions of years, immense heat and pressure from the earth's crust and its tectonic plates compress the residue of lipids into crude oil. It is at this point that the constituents of oil switch from existing above ground, harnessing energy from the sun (photosynthesis) to being processed deep underground.

Extracting the ooze

Using seismic surveys, which rely on blasts of sound to create sonar waves to explore the geology beneath the seafloor, the most profitable reservoirs are then located and tapped. Approximately 70% of oil deposits were formed in the Mesozoic age (252 to 66 million years ago), 20% were formed in the Cenozoic age (65 million years ago). There are more than 65,000 oil fields on earth, collectively producing 4.2 billion metric tonnes of oil per year. From drilling, crude oil thus continues its journey; ascending from below, to back above ground.

Life above ground

Crude oil is transformed into anything and everything when it is above ground. Through different processing steps, which use heat and pressure from human-made machines, crude oil is transformed into gasoline, kerosene, naphtha and liquid gas. These are long hydrocarbon chains at this point. When these raw materials are 'cracked' into short hydrocarbon chains, they turn into ethylene, propylene, butadiene and benzene which can then be made into plastics, medicines, synthetic fabric and water pipes for example. Crude oil at this point takes the form of many different colours, textures and viscosities, transforming different ecologies into cloying infrastructures as it *spills* from continent to continent.

Returning to ooze

After fulfilling its intended short-term use, plastic ends up in many different places. A lot of the time however, it ends up continuing its descent back into the earth to become a geological formation once again. In areas around the world, particularly those affected by forest fires and lava flows, plastic can become fused with other sedimentary grains and debris such as shells, wood and sand. Given the right conditions of their burial, these new rocks may once again become crude oil reservoirs.

The lifecycle of crude oil (therefore plastics, plankton, and algae) far exceeds human space-time. Oil-based materials travel through space-time beyond all systems of security and capture, even recycling. For instance, microplastics are found in living and nonliving plants and animals, enacting a radical alterity to the presumed inactivity of geological matter stemming from enlightenment thought. Plankton, the initial subjects whose decomposing bodies formed crude oil 252 million years ago, now frequently contain microscopic plastics, foregrounding the ontology of oil as one that has always spilt.

What can a toxic body do?

Dominika Wasilewska
(Poland)

What does it mean to live in a contaminated body? In the toxic present and even more toxic future, our bodily boundaries are being penetrated and traversed by numerous contaminants, including endocrine disruptors, neurotoxins, asthmagens, carcinogens, and mutagens. The trans-corporeal transits of toxicity spares no place and no body, although communities of color and with low-income status most often feel the brunt of this issue firsthand. Those more privileged can afford to subscribe to the idea of individualized purification, clearing their way out of the polluted present and back to the supposed state of purity through 'clean eating', detox, and other illusionary solutions. Following Michelle Murphy:

"We are all here already altered by industrial chemicals, though in profoundly uneven ways. We are all here already more-than-bodies." [1]

I am interested in looking at toxics as a modern trickster figure that exposes our cultural fears and phobias, the incoherence of our modes of categorizations, the brittleness of Western cosmologies and ways oppressive structures like racism and homophobia operate within the environmental, health and science discourses. Tricksters make the "familiar" and "usual" horrendously unbearable andridiculous in their effort to maintain a steady posture and supposed untouchableness. They destroy the obvious to make us intimately experience the ambiguous, paradoxical and wobbly nature of the earthly existence. Toxins as tricksters force us to figure out new modes of existence that are not based on the false conviction of our safe encapsulation within the skin's boundaries.

Our bodies are continuously "in-the-making", shaped by material-semiotic forces that resist otological purity and leave everything promiscuously open-ended. Playing with the famous spinozian question, I ask, "What can a contaminated body do?", making my flesh turn into a process, a transitional event or dynamic assemblage of bodies making bodies.

Throughout this investigation, I have been asking myself the following questions:

Does the ubiquity of toxins have the capacity to trouble our ideas of bounded individuality, human exceptionality, and binary divisions such as nature/culture?

What kind of interspecies solidarity can emerge when we realize our shared impurity and vulnerability?

Can this vulnerable state of being "always already contaminated" help us realize the ways we are being co-constituted with the world and ontologically inseparable from it?

What would thinking and feeling with toxicity look like?

What can pollution teach us about our compliance with maintaining colonial, racist, hetero-patriarchal infrastructure?

The inquiry is a part of a more extensive research in posthuman body politics and postnatural fleshiness, which I have been conducting for the last year. The study has been processed, metabolized and activated through a range of written pieces, workshops, experimental group processes and collective dreaming.

1 Michelle Murphy What can't the body do?. in Catalyst. feminism, theory, technoscience. 3(1). 2017.

Life after the slaughterhouse: Unveiling hidden narratives of life and growth in a transformed space

Felix Bell
(United Kingdom)

The aim of this research proposal is to investigate the natural history of Matadero Madrid, a former slaughterhouse transformed into the Centre for Contemporary Creation, and shed light on the hidden narratives of life and growth after death. How does the aesthetics of a slaughterhouse unveil the dominance of the human whilst becoming a site of resilience and interconnectedness of nature amidst the cracks of its own decay? By exploring the intricate relationships between nature, architecture, and human intervention, this study aims to provide a deeper understanding of the complex interplay between these elements.

The disciplines of architecture and design have been instrumental in perpetuating an anthropocentric ideology within the built environment. Matadero Madrid, formerly the El Matadero y Mercado Municipal de Ganados, stands as a captivating site that once served as Madrid's industrial slaughterhouse and livestock market. The slaughter process was optimized through architectural and design interventions, dividing the complex into five sectors to enhance the efficient movement of livestock. No expense was spared during its construction, the El Matadero y Mercado Municipal de Ganados exudes opulence in even the smallest details, from the bull head grotesques which loom over the management and administration buildings to the ornate tiles that surround the slaughterhouses. This architectural marvel became a source of great pride for the city, transforming the slaughterhouse into a captivating spectacle of death, with architecture and design meticulously orchestrating the stage.



After its closure in 1995, the complex was repurposed into the Centre for Contemporary Creation, becoming a cultural hub that exhibits art, design, and moving image from around the world. By having such a large space to create a cultural hub a substantial part of the complex had to be left abandoned. Peeking through the broken doors in the abandoned actions one can see vines climbing up the walls, and whole trees growing between the cracked concrete. Life thrives amidst the remnants of the once death-laden slaughterhouse, as nature finds its way through the crevices of the abandoned architecture which reveal stories of human dominance through material, aesthetic, and cultural histories.

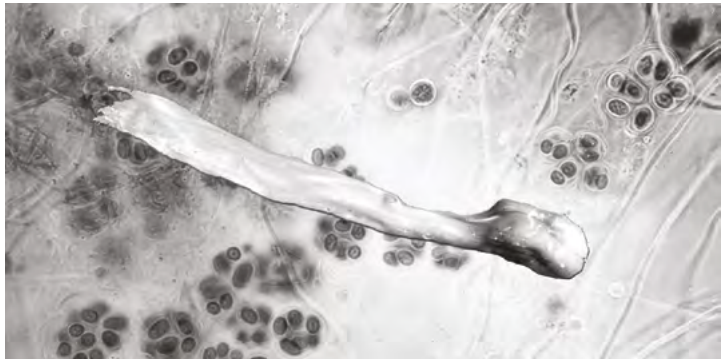
The research project focuses on life after the slaughterhouse. Imagining seeds trapped in the furs of cattle, eventually falling and finding purchase between the concrete, leading to the growth of new life. And illustrate a world which depicts the descendants of ticks that dropped off the fur after the animal was skinned. Through this exploration, the project aims to shed light on the hidden narratives of life and growth within this transformed space. By uncovering these hidden stories, I can provide a deeper understanding of the complex interplay between nature and human intervention within the Matadero Madrid site.

Iconoplast meshes

Sara Bonaventura
(Italy)

Iconoplast is a future without humans, a plastic future. In the germinal stage of this new era, bacteria have evolved, proliferating in symbiosis with technofossil of the Chthulucene: microplastics. The seminal Lynn Margulis' Microcosmos inspired a theory fiction around the idea that symbiogenesis is crucial to the evolution of life forms on Earth. Another reading, Zalasiewicz's The Earth after us, inspired to set the script in a posthuman dimension where plastic debris will become petroleum again, broken down by bacteria that will digest it and grow in symbiosis with it. Plastic, an ubiquitous hyperobject, is a nomadic ob-sub/ject, form and substance enmeshed in one, in symbiotic relationship with all biotic. Due to its transformative nature it's able to navigate through different passages, through entangled levels of a complex conglomerate matrix. Invisible microplastics, simultaneously shifting from tangible to intangible, are cross kinds mixtures of permeable virtual configurations. These slippery, viscous, porous fragments are queering and reshaping human and other-than-human worlds. To materialize this entanglement, a world of pseudo-bacteria has been created melting upcycled leftovers of commodity plastics, gathered per type of polymers (PET, PP, HDPE, PP etc.) and molded with a DIY injector. In the current development these props have been 3D scanned to design immersive realities, both 360 videos and AR, set in the salt marshes of the Venice lagoon.
In Madrid players will be able to intra-act with the narrative: adopting non-human perspectives but at the same time feeling a more-than-human sense of agency and kinship. Sit immersed in this plastisphere, a phygital plastic patch, between a meta-reality and a sensory mat, they will be invited to stay with the trouble, sharing their affect and suggesting new perspectives. I will listen and collect their feedback and playful explorations.



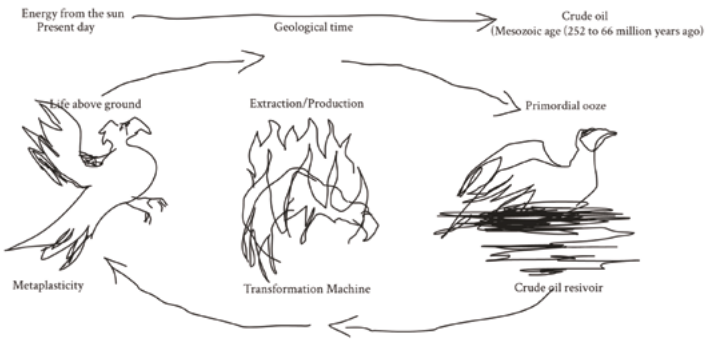


Acrylonitrile-butadiene-styrene and the $urplus of the Big $un

Hannah Hallam-Eames
(Austrialia)

> *Originally understood as the 'unintended' (unnatural, contra natura) outcome of nature, filth has become the haphazardous (non-technifiable) outcome of technology, including... dangerous industrial residues and ecological catastrophes. As non-technology, then, filth might be understood as an excess of life that poses a threat to life itself.*[1] — German Sierra

Oil-based plastics, resins, paints, petrol, and polystyrene are horrifyingly present in ecosystems around the world, yet remain remarkably ungraspable at the same time. This is because, being recently invented materials —in the scheme of human history—western science is already starting to see the unprecedented excessive visibility and integration of oil-based materials into ecosystems with unexpected outcomes and interactions with the postnatural world. An example of this is the eventual accumulation of plastics from the world's oceans into remote locations where oceanic currents meet. Although there are many ocean garbage patches, a significant one has been formed in the ocean in between California and Hawaii: This is known to scientists as 'The Great Pacific Garbage Patch (GPGP)'. A model of the garbage patch "calibrated with data from multi-vessel and aircraft surveys, predicted at least 79 (45–129) thousand tonnes of ocean plastic are floating inside an area of 1.6 million km2; a figure four to sixteen times higher than previously reported." Additionally, the GPGP is rapidly accumulating plastic much faster than previously thought. This accumulation of plastic in the world's oceans signals how the long lifecycle of crude oil spans far beyond anthropocentric interference



with the earth in the way of crude oil and gas extraction and production. In other words, the immense indestructibility and resistance degradation of oil-based materials is a marker of how excessive substances present themselves in material form.

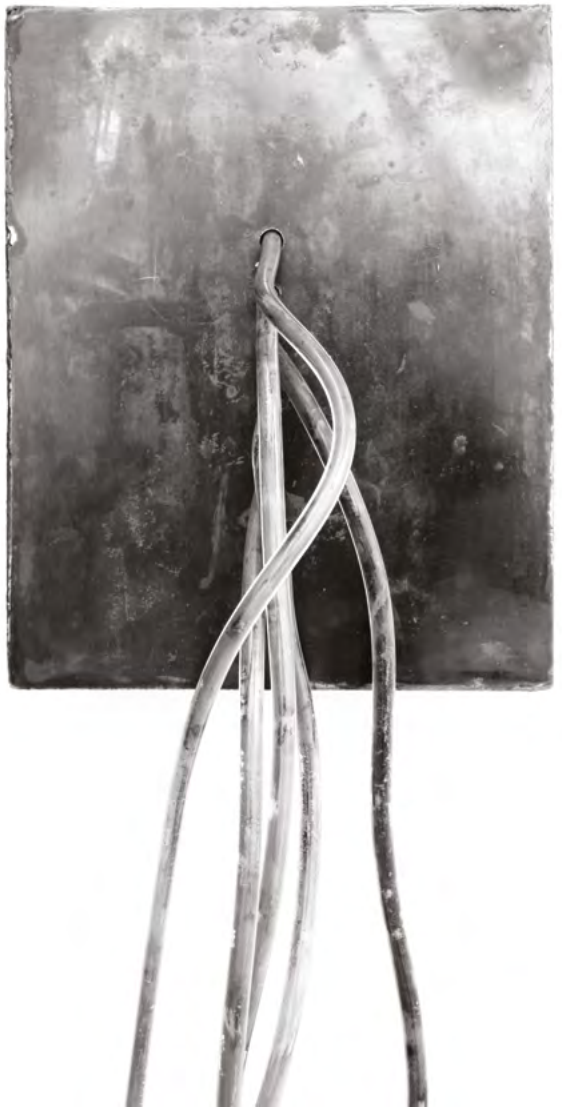
Sierra specifies the non-productivity, or non-technological aspects of materials such as crude oil, plastics and aldehydes as non-technologies. For instance, when waste materials become excessive, they implement forms of action, thus explaining that "if it (substance, material) comes from technology, it is technology that has started behaving 'non-technically'." These materials, especially plastics, therefore, contribute "nothing but the menace of unpredictable, ongoing transformation" to (Western) human infrastructure. This can result in adverse transformations such as degradation and deterioration, not only to the environment, but to all corporeal organisations, such as human and nonhuman bodies and capitalist industry. Initially produced en masse in the production of fungible, cost-effective goods, plastic and fossil-fuel have become a serious pollution problem, threatening Earth's life support systems e.g. air, water, climate. In the continued production of plastics to provide useful infrastructure to human lives, they eventually become in excess of the initial system of capitalist production.

1 Filth as Non-Technology. Sierra, Germán. KEEP IT DIRTY, vol. a. "Filth", 2016

The Making of Displacement Loop Reaction

Matheline Marmy
(Switzerland)

I have made two boxes, tanks, engines, organs out of black patina steel by hand using an old brush, with chemistries bought online. I paint the surface, which quickly blackens, and a heavy odor rises from it: I find it pleasant. I immerse the objects in a bath, so that the chemistry of the solution comes off, and a few oxygen bubbles rise to the surface. Then into an acid, to keep the color as dark as it is now. The surface of the box dries under the strong light, I look at it, and in a few places, it has turned slightly blue inside the black patina. I approach it. Into previously drilled holes I gradually add transparent plastic tubes and other soft, yellowish rubber ones. The first is clear and odorless; the other is acidic, and I add it drop by drop. It irritates my bronchi when I get too close. The fine iron and copper wires inserted into the soft tubes immediately react with these aqueous solutions to form a dusty-looking, dark-red deposit: copper. In this cluster of thin-walled tubes, in the liquids, a displacement reaction takes place. In chemistry, simply put, one more reactive element can replace another, less reactive one, within its solution, in the instant of the reaction. Around the steel wire, the iron displaces the copper ions inside the bath, which is now gradually taking on a gray-green color (iron sulfate, I believe). A few minutes pass, as I attempt to complete the circuit by closing the tube openings with another soft material, trapping the metal-laden drops and seeking to escape this strange dialogue by sinking to the ground.



18:19:57
From lissy (no pronouns) :
my bird was a very friendly disney-style pelican
(:

18:20:15
From natalia trejbalova :
a common pidgeon

18:20:44
From Ama Josephine (she/her) :
I had a Dr Zeuss type bird! With the long
elaborate tail

18:20:47
From Sara Bonaventura :
A magpie

18:20:51
From Rosela del Bosque :
I also saw a sea gull!

18:21:11
From Ania Mokrzycka :
Swans

18:21:24
From Ishita Jain :
My birds were translucent with radiating insides
that glowed in neon colours…

18:21:31
From v for 5 :
I saw a harpy

18:21:42
From felix :
A heron

18:21:47
From Hannah H-e :
I had a crow! We have a native and invasive
species in Melbourne. I had the invasive one- had
been thinking about crows a lot recently!

18:21:49
From Diogo da Cruz (he/him) :
Crows

18:22:25
From Adriana Gallo :
they started as songbirds in a murmur but then
became a crow

18:23:15
From Davide (he/him) :
my object was like a fragment from a thick,
geometric distorted cage (looking like Piranesi
engravings i guess?), very heavy but broken. like
a relic

18:23:19
From Raju Sachi Singh (they/them/elle) :
mine was an owl but the Ornimegalonyx but with
flight not flightness because of the guidance you
gave

18:23:35
From Ishita Jain :
The bird dropped behind a spool of its neon
insides.. leaving a part of itself even as it flew
away..

18:23:57
From sol archer :
My object was like a crenelated banister or table
leg, made of wood with plaster and gold plated

18:24:30
From Ania Mokrzycka :
A geometric very heavy block of rock/stone a bit
like pyrite wrapped in waxed tissues many layers

18:24:35
From Raju Sachi Singh (they/them/elle) :
a really odd mysterious ribbed container of some
sort but I couldn't figure out how to open it

18:24:36
From Adriana Gallo :
mine was sort of this lumpy blurry brown irregular
form but once I had it in my hand it became liquid

18:24:53
From Ama Josephine (she/her) :
Oooo Adriana I love this!

18:25:22
From Adriana Gallo :
oobleck maybe!

18:25:50
From Ama Josephine (she/her) :
Like the hot-dog-hand-people in "Everything
Everywhere All At Once" Korallia

18:26:28
From felix :
That was a hugeeee version of me staring back on myself. So big I could only see my face

18:41:41
From Raju Sachi Singh (they/them/elle) :
it would be interesting to debunk the idea of the 'romantic/romanticism' in this context or reclaim it

18:44:11
From Lindertje Mans :
Sol I love your pet

18:44:17
From Lindertje Mans :
Is it a cat?

18:45:00
From sol archer :
I'm looking after a dog for one of my neighbours, but he is agitated by the dog downstairs

18:45:15
From sol archer :
Its a very cat sized and shaped dog

19:44:54
From sol archer :
Replying to "I honestly haven't r..."
Hyperobject is a very seductively available term, I think is the thing. It happily absorbs many possible discourses or ways of considering the super-local (?)

19:54:19
From Ama Josephine (she/her) :
Replying to "I honestly haven't r..."
Well exactly. Similarly to Haraway, TJ Demos etc > it's digestible work that amalgamates a lot of other peoples (mostly Black, brown and Indigenous folk) epistemologies / ontologies / ways of seeing/being/living/dying. More and more, I just don't feel referencing is enough (especially when you're the one being paid!)

19:48:39
From Raju Sachi Singh (they/them/elle) :
Thanks Ama, I got that from what you shared when you spoke. I'm just speaking to how we decenter the domainant often colonial narratives without constantly centring the problem or responding to it or reproducing the same colonial logic with jargons or terms that are mostly used within academia/institutional worlds. What are the other spaces, imaginings, stories and relations that speak to our intimacy or complicated relationships to our worlds. Maybe intimacy is too vague or loaded word itself.

Very important point <3 I guess I'm also wary of "taking" / "using" yet another Indigenous word (is it possible to do this without being extractive?), but a really important line of enquiry to be sure.

19:52:30
From Raju Sachi Singh (they/them/elle) :
yes its important to not be extractive or romanticise indigeneity either!

02
Territories

Lissy Willberg
Rosela del Bosque
Caterina Gobbi
Ana Roman

Cartographies of permanently shifting grounds: a conversation

PART #1
May 1 2023 - 13:00 Institute for Postnatural Studies Headquarters, Madrid : Initial conversation

How to approach territories from such different perspectives? The initial hypothesis of our text led us to the idea that we should create a common territory for our conversations.

Task 1: Assembling smaller questions / terms / phrases regarding our research and the group's topic "territories"

Ana Roman (AR): There is a concept of territory that correlates it with the space necessary for a certain person or population to exist. What is left, however, for those who do not have a physical space to exist? Is there territory with no space? Is there territory without power? What memories are inscribed in each portion of land? Territories of Memory [Territórios de Memória] in the Archeological Park of Serra da Capivara, Piauí, Brazil.

Lissy Willberg (LW): What is the -gra·phy, graphía, the recording in the word car-tog-ra-phy, as opposed to the -gra·phy in the word chore-og-ra-phy? A choreography for the body without (stable) ground. Who has access to stable ground(s)? What parameters destabilize one's perception of a (stable) ground? Safe grounds = safe lands? Can maps be understood as a dance score since they illustrate movement instructions? If maps are to be considered a tool for successful orientation, how does the mapper know what feels safe for me? Or, how does the mapper know what I would like to experience?

Rosela del Bosque (RB): How can we listen to territories? Who and why were these histories interrupted? Cohesiveness, erratic, or always moving grounds (through geology and ecological transformations). Earthquakes, mud volcanoes, geysers, soil liquefaction—these are some of the features that ravel the Northwestern Mexican desert. In one of our first sessions, I was explaining to Lissy that the Laguna Salada basin and the sedimentology is runny and *unstable*. Although at plain sight it seems dry, the lagoon has a long record of subsidence and tectonic movements.

LW: "Always moving grounds," makes me think how grounds are literally always moving. Keyword: plate tectonics.

Caterina Gobbi (CB): What does it mean to witness such rapid change of landscape? Which adaptation/behavioral techniques are plants acquiring? What triggers these changes and how are their behavioral changes influencing the surroundings? What does it mean to move uphill? Bodily but also plants moving up. Moving in altitude is not on any horizontal axes, it requires a movement tending to verticality. What does it mean to be in the landscape (living or traversing)? In what ways can a shift in perception facilitate new modes and relationships between humans and the environment?

LW: And how can one access a shift in perception? For me it is also a question of boundaries. Where do I end, where does the landscape start? A dissolving body. Being lost as not-knowing, not needing to know, letting go of outward orientation.

1.2) Institute for Postnatural Studies Headquarters, Madrid,
May 1 2023, 16:00
Written discussion at PIP headquarters

AR: Territory is not only physical. It is also related to imagination. The Tikmũ'ũn, also known as Maxakali, are Indigenous people from the area that today encompasses the Minas Gerais, Bahia, and

Espírito Santo states. Songs organize life in the villages, constituting almost an index of all the elements of their daily lives, like plants, animals, places, objects, knowledge, and of their rich cosmology. Often intended for healing, most of these songs are collectively sung. For the Tikmũ'ũn, singing becomes an integral part of life because memories are preserved, and community is constituted through singing. Maybe Maxacali's territory are their songs[1].

CG: I would think of territory as a land with a specified characteristic, where the inhabitants share specific needs and modes of survival.

RB: Or a territory as a land and identity; margins and geopolitical doings and un-doings. But territories can also imply epistemologies/ways of thinking. They are made of (micro) histories, commons, and specificity. Territories are implicated with political and domination discourse, but also embody shift and transformation→ collectivity and memories. Territories are Pluriverses[2]: they are constituted by multilayered strata, stories of extractivism and time-space (transition). Territory drives movement and defies; It is an ethnographic concept made from pluri-knowledge and plurivocality. Territory crosses past-present-futures.

CG: Territorial landscape is formed by smell, sound, songs, knowledge (...)

RB: But what happens if we cannot see, smell, hear or remember a territory? If it is left as a corpse of necropolitical acts on the more-than-human. What if we have to look for it?

1 *Further reading*: ROMERO, Roberto. *A Errática tikmũ'ũn_maxakali*: imagens da Guerra contra o Estado. Rio de Janeiro, 2015

2 *Further reading*: Blaser, Mario, and Marisol de la Cadena. *A world of many worlds.* Duke University Press, 2018.

TASK 3: What constitutes territory for us?
Territory crosses past-present-futures.

PART #2

São Paulo, Brazil, ? / Zürich, Switzerland/ Leipzig, Germany / Italy
From 17th - 24 May 2023
Mixed time zones, mixed geographies
Virtual conversation over the course of two weeks – an imaginary map that crosses the cities we are and our bodies.



Prompts to Mid Journey : Map + Connection + Colorado River Basin + Serra da Capivara + Italian Alps + Muscles + Tectonical Plaques

AR: Hello, queridas. This week I saw an online lecture about animal's territory and I remembered Vinciane Despret's concept of territory. For her, territories are understood as zones of social interaction where one encounters their "enemies" at the boundaries, and both

male and female birds actively participate in shaping, reshaping, and sharing their neighborhoods, which are defined not only by physical space but also by the songs they sing[3].

RB: Exactly! I believe the rhythm of walking generates a kind of choreography of thinking, and I add 'recollection'— a space where we put things in. To gather and recollect their own stories of, sand, waterfalls, and sound. Like birds and other beings, there is a dialect from each of their territories; they are in constant dialogue, speaking the same language.

AR: I have also thought a lot these last few days about lichens: Lichens are mutualistic associations between some species of fungi (usually ascomycetes) and algae (mainly green algae and cyanobacteria). What would be the territories of these cooperating individuals?. The body is the territory of many.

LW: From my perspective as a movement artist, everything is always in motion. I perceive thoughts, ideas, feelings, the immaterial as well as the material world as composed by movement, vibrant matter, vibrant molecules.

RB: Altogether, the relation between natural phenomena, microhistory and the geological shift plays a role as something that can be rolled out as a methodology —one in which material stratification of genealogy shifts into geology.

LW: *Why territory?* Some people refer to their field of expertise as their *territory*. Often only a certain form of knowledge officially grants power over territory. In German language, both certainty as well as safety translate into the word *Sicherheit* – once one is certain, they are consequently safe. Why is it that only what one is certain of is what provides them with safety? A map may provide one with the safe feeling of orientation. However, reading the map in motion may also produce careless movement. How beautiful it would be, this not-knowing, allowing for uncertainty. *Unknowing* as a field of exploration, as uncertain ground, not in order to understand, but to remain open. What would uncertainty look like, expressed in movement?

3 DESPRET, Vinciane. Que diriam os animais?. Ubu Editora, 2021.

AR: Maybe uncertainty – in terms of movement – would be just walking on diagonals.

RB: And the idea of thinking-with and about walking as an un-written subversive detour; a sense of place through body movement and rhythms, where slowness takes place as an act of resistance.

AR: All that discussion brings me to a philosopher: Yi-Fu Tuan[4]. For him, maps represent space, not place. He doubts the possibility and potential of maps to portray reality with all its subjectivities, sensualities and intimacy. Cartography cannot represent the ephemeral and the essence of human existence like home or place, where one perceives the smell of food, the silence after a blizzard, and the warmth of a brick wall. For Tuan, this would be mapping the unmappable.

CG: Love this - reminds me of this map from the 1600's called Carte de Tendre - which is a geography based on love (if that's even possible). I like the idea of moving away from horizontal cartography, into a vertical one. Trying to acknowledge what is also underneath, earth, caves, water, etc

RB: And I believe visual cartography has also collaborated in overwriting histories of underneathness. To look for the *'silenced archives of geologic acts'* as said by Kathryn Yusoff[5] and present-day effects of the post-colonial surplus extracted from the bowels of the Global South. Embodiment and dialogues on site offer a possibility of testimony.

4 TUAN, Yi-Fu. Space and place: humanistic perspective. Springer Netherlands, 1979.
5 Yusoff, Kathryn. *A billion black Anthropocenes or none*. U of Minnesota Press, 2018.

PART #3
Brazil, Madrid-Switzerland, Germany, Italy,
June 2023

Task: each of us answer individually those questions

1. How do we relate our practices to the title “Territory crosses past-present-futures?”
2. How do we move? What's the role/position of the body?

RB: Remembrance has shaped the way I feel/think about territories and their enmeshment with living and nonliving agencies. I’ve always chosen to work with the specific territory of Mexicali and remain in contact with the complex histories of Baja California. A place distinguished by its erratic, transboundary, and contested qualities. Qualities that in a way I believe my research practice has also fleshed into. *Errática y maleable.* In my research with Archivo Familiar del Río Colorado, peripatetic practices and deep listening have enabled physiological processes of breathing and touching, of contraction and changing as choreographic structures that not only imply body motion but of *togetherness* with the place. Laguna Salada belongs to a different sort of temporary and spatial material axis, that is related to an unexpected and transient dynamic at a hydrological and geographically resilient capacity. A post-natural lagoon that has traveled across settler-colonialism, moments of complete drought and wetness, and tectonic movement, as too ecotourism desires.

LW: Not long ago I attended an artist talk with choreographer, performer, and theoretician Michael Turinsky. During the talk, he introduced his concept around “crip time” and “soil time” as potential sites of „resistance from below“ against dominant, capitalist modes of production. In the Q&A round, I asked Turinsky to elaborate on the movement language connected to “crip time” and “soil time.” And, he ingeniously responded: “I simply wanted to get low.” We both share this interest in grounding practice(s). I am convinced that it is worth questioning traditional perceptions of stability, horizon, and total body control in the western genealogy of dance practices. By asking: Who has access to stability? Who is holding you when falling? I aim to broaden the idea of what dance is capable of – in the realm of being a sociopolitical practice.

CG: Territory is an entanglement of geological times and scales. Millennial rocks meet seasonal flowers in a reciprocal relationship. Growing up in a place where the connection to the phenomena of the environment influences your daily activities means taking into account the lives of others, human and non-human. Living, moving, and existing in this environment have an impact, even if it means taking everything into account, which is simply not possible. Walking is the first form of sculpture, an erected body perpendicular to the ground. The grass is crushed under our feet, insects move to the sound of our soles on the ground. The vibration of the soil affects the growth of plants. Bodies movement in the mountains is not necessarily horizontal, verticality is often required. If we were to trace it on a map, we can see that in this case there is no forward axis, the trace stands still on one point. Cartography doesn't take verticality into account. Where could there be room for this lost dimension?

AR: Emanuele Coccia states that "all on earth is merely the form and expression of the sky[6]. Our images of the universe are always images of the past, and it is on the very rock, which composes the earth's surface, that we encounter this long duration that evades our hands and memory. To talk about territory is to attempt to grasp the memory of the Earth and its human and non-human inhabitants.
When looking at contemporary territorial disputes and the destruction of the planet, I always wonder: does the Anthropocene really need to be this way? There is not such a large enough window to see it differently, but there are still many good stories to be told by humans and the various species that share the world[7].

6 COCCIA, Emanuele. Metamorfoses. Rio de Janeiro: Editora Dantes, 2020.
7 FAUSTO, Juliana. A Cosmopolítica dos Animais. São Paulo, N-1 Edições e Editora Hedra, 2020.

Now, lying here, what is the horizon more than two curved lines lovingly embracing you, 2023

Lissy Willberg
(Germany)

With the support of Stiftung Kunstfonds

To you, dear reader.

According to my understanding of dance, everything is always in motion, always in change. Matter, human and more-than-human beings as well as texts, feelings, and narratives are dancing. Everything is dancing. Dancing relationally, in formations, inter- and intra-actively, with what surrounds and that which pervades it.

(Space is an immediate experience)

Bodies[1] are not only locatable in space; they also own an extension in space, they are perceptible and measurable in at least three dimensions. But it is only evident to certain languages to put a person at the center of exploring and determining space. This egocentric or idiocentric view produces a specific positioning related to other beings and the (seemingly) inanimate. Subjects brought up as part of white western culture learn to orient within the exterior by putting themselves at the very center of it. Establishing their self at the center, they navigate along Euclidean spatial axes. Not all subjects have access to this spatial linearity and stability though. Racialized subjects, Cripped subjects, INT* subjects, and Queer subjects share experiences of being lost in one's own body, that is, being disoriented, because their bodies do not align.[2]

(Your's is not a real horizon)

One of my preoccupations as a sound and movement artist is the (im)possible demarcation between the cultural and the natural. At the Institute for Postnatural Studies I am engaged with geological maps and western notions of space and orientation. With mapping technologies as an example, simple questions appear such as: Where does "I" end? Where does landscape, environment, or "the more" begin?

US humanities scholar Kathleen M. Kirby explores how concepts of subjectivity are essentially based on assumptions about space. Kirby addresses the problematic interrelationship within which the development of the Enlightenment individual is closely related to a specific concept of space. According to Kirby, mapping historically is a process "to distinguish self from other." (Kirby 1996: 49) The mapper must not be absorbed by landscape, because cartographic records must remain free of subjective impressions



and affect in order to ensure the hierarchical imbalance in relation to the mapped area.

European colonial history is characterized by the idea of conquering the horizon. Both the development of technologies that served nautical navigation as well as specific measuring equipment and standardized descriptions of the unknown have contributed to these efforts. Through my research, I seek to encounter horizon(s) beyond this dynamic.

*The image is AI generated, using the following keywords:
mixed-abled non-binary dancers, in a grassfield, in the morning sun, cloudy, dancing low on the ground, on their back, eyes closed, curved horizon, bird perspective

1 Bodies might be threatened, bended, (dis)abled, sick(ened), (in)complete(d), and are forever subjective.

2 Sara Ahmed wrote about a body's alignment in Queer Phenomenologies (2006).

On the Overflow forms of the Colorado River Delta

Rosela del Bosque
(Mexico)

On the Overflow Forms of the Colorado River Delta is a curatorial research project that arose from my interest in studying the geology and geohydrological memories of Mexicali, Baja California. The project starts from a non-specialized perspective in relation to geology and material possibilities, as well as to reimagine the futures of the territory and the Colorado River watersheds. The reflection emerges from the sites of Laguna Salada and the Cerro Prieto volcano and geothermal plant, their tectonic plates and subsoil. The project aims to describe the multiple historical and geological layers that form these bodies, through on-site dialogues, archive, interviews and multidisciplinary explorations with artists and researchers with common studies and political interests. *On the Overflows* seeks to recognize and trace the consequences of systemic extractivism under a geological reading: from the time-space scales, the domination and control over water, necropolitics and how it interacts with our present ecologies. The themes that this curatorial proposal will explore are related to the material extractivism of the territory, its plundering and hydrological dispossession, but it also attempts to narrate from a fictional point of view, through deep listening and the formal studies of these ecologies. *On Overflows of the Colorado River Delta* will be part of Archivo Familiar del Río Colorado—a larger and long-term project, which begins from the history of the river and the relationship with it and is driven by the prevailing regional water scarcity. This curatorial research is interested in generating spaces for dialogue and visibility of territorial relations and tensions, such as the growing extraction of natural resources, the scarcity of the



Colorado River, and questioning how it has been promoted by neoliberal interests or private capital in Baja California. To link curatorial practice with political reflection and the prevailing regional water scarcity with the memory and affections of the place we inhabit. For me, it is extremely relevant to pluralize and congregate human and non-human agencies that construct the multiple layers of the Baja California desert. It is called for to enmesh past, present, and future readings of our lands.

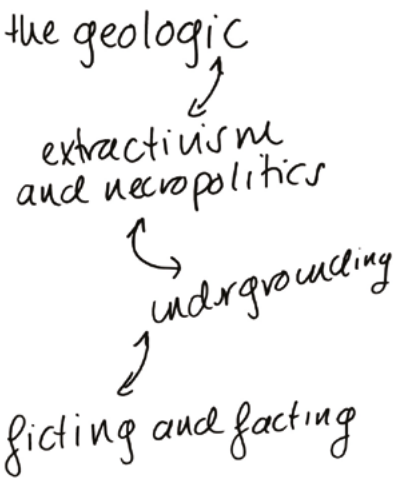




FIG. 5.—ACTIVE MUD-VOLCANOES NEAR VOLCANO LAKE. CERRO PRIETO, THE LARGEST OF THE GROUP SEEN IN THE DISTANCE, IS NOW QUIESCENT.

Where flowers conversein whispers. Spring is the loudest season

Caterina Gobbi
(Italy)

Though a season of vibrant growth and vitality, spring possesses a paradoxical quality. While it brings life and renewal to the forefront–and therefore energy and exuberance–it is also a time of gentle subtleties. Amidst the cacophony of blooming petals and fluttering wings, the most profound messages are conveyed in hushed tones, in vibrations of the wind, exchanged between flowers through intricate language altering their growth patterns and morphology to wind-induced vibrations.

A loudspeaker vibrates but makes no sound. New research suggests that plants use sound as a means of communication. However, these acoustic signals are beyond the range of human hearing and are therefore inaudible to us. It is now known that plants have the ability to communicate both within their own species and with other organisms. In forest ecosystems, for example, trees exchange information through underground mycelial networks that transmit not only nutrients but also information about climatic conditions through their veins, roots and spores.

The flower lotus corniculatus is a species known for its ability to prevent soil erosion. The plant is scanned in its habitat using a hand scanner. The plant is scanned in its habitat using a handheld scanner. The handheld device, which has high-resolution imaging capabilities, was originally invented to digitise physical documents and images so that they can be stored, edited and shared electronically. It works by illuminating the object and moving the sensor manually across the object, capturing the reflected light information and converting it into an electrical signal. Analogue information becomes digital. The glitchiness and jitter of the data is a direct consequence of the speed or precision unconsciously used by the capturer.

Rather than facilitating data analysis, this work is a testament to the ever-changing rhythm of the flower's organic choreography.



Other-than-humans in Serra da Capivara (Piauí-Brazil)

Ana Roman
(Brazil)

Serra da Capivara National Park in southeastern Piauí was underwater by the ocean until 220 million years ago, when a tectonic movement was responsible for surfacing its immense canyons of sedimentary rock. During the Ice Age, the region had not frozen and it became a rich tropical Rain Forest until the rising temperatures and falling humidity created the Caatinga with its biodiversity and resilience. This is where, long before the colonization of Brazil, successive generations of humans inhabited the region, leaving as their legacy one of the largest concentrations of rock paintings known in the world. The paintings contain thousands of images with high dynamism and expressive poses, in which we can recognize scenes of hunting, sex, worship, and many others. The paintings only began to be studied in the 1960s, when archeologist Niéde Guidon found them exposed to weather conditions and human action. The archeologist's studies and efforts resulted in the establishment of a Franco-Brazilian scientific mission, the creation of the National Park, and the FUMDHAM - Fundação Museu do Homem Americano, created to implement initiatives of conservation and heritage education, security, archeological research, and socio-educational action that public policies alone did not accomplish, even after the recognition of the relevance of this heritage. The focus of the research I am currently conducting is the process of recognition of the Park as a heritage, the scientific paradigmatic changes that the scientific research carried out in the Park was responsible for making happen, and, finally, I am interested in the history of the people who were evicted from the Park's territory so that the preservation area could be created. Which memories of humans and other-than-humans are stored in this territory? In what way are only some of these chosen to be preserved? I am dedicating myself to writing essays and speculative fiction about the territory.









Images credit: Rodrigo Gasparini

19:03:29
From Ama Josephine (she/her) :
(In case of interest, I like this quote) > “In deep-futurological texts about human extinction the status of animals is inevitably a major concern; we discover in the future of animals and their ability or inability to survive in the world we have made for them a retrospective final judgment on our species. Often this produces a depressive utopian vision of a particularly anti-humanist sort; our recognition of the sacredness of animal life and our guilt over “the sixth mass extinction” - another proposed designation for the Anthropocene that centers its nonhuman victims-leads to a sort of anguished desire for collective suicide, as the only way to stop the human species from killing again and again and again and again. […] To the extent that the concept of the Anthropocene shocks us into some new relationship with our sense of our society, and/or of human nature, its speculations and articulations of a future of human absence thus retain philosophical and political implications for the present. for the way we live before extinction.” - Gerry Canavan

19:17:05
From Clara Benito (she/they) :
I wonder, does a “we” always need to be flat, homogenising, singular, cohesive?

19:20:39
From sol archer :
Replying to “I wonder, does a “we...”
I don’t speak Portuguese well, a Brazilian Portuguese speaker would have a different and much more meaning full take on this statement. In Brazilian Portuguese its common to use “A Gente” in the place of we or us, but conjugated in the singular 2nd person (as you would he, they, they, you (in Brasil where there is not the tu form), meaning sort of ‘the people’
It’s used to speak within a group about the group, a bit like casually in English people use ‘guys’ as an address to the group of people you are currently with like, lets go guys

19:25:37
From raju rage :
As scholars and organizers committed to social change, how do we make space for multiple forms of “reading” practices? How do we choose what we read? The last question is of particular importance for many of us who think of knowledge production and the conditions under which it is produced. When we assign texts for our syllabus on climate change, it calls for a careful reflection of what we include. Do we just restrict ourselves to books published by university presses in the Global North or should we make a serious commitment to teach texts published by grassroots organizations and written by local organizers? Without such publications, everyday acts of cooking, massaging, and reading would largely remain written out of climate change conversations. Turning attention to such stories that demonstrate what it means to be in community and show how our frameworks for understanding climate justice require a paradigm shift from the event to the granular can go a long way in envisioning radical futures. Another wo

19:27:51
From sol archer :
Replying to “I wonder, does a “we...”
Its a flexible grouping of the people you’re sharing team-space with at a given moment

19:37:23
From Clara Benito (she/they) :
If the flesh is the medium of exchange that organizes and modifies the golden spikes (the thresholds) of climate change, then that same trauma gets lost but such an abstract and depersonalised term (climate change)

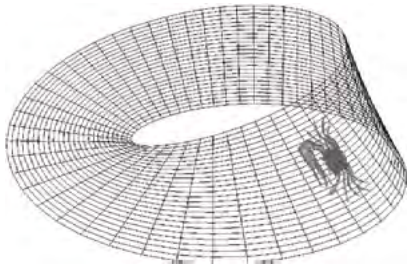
19:47:40
From Ishita Jain :
Replying to “As scholars and orga...”
The Postdevelopment Dictionary edited by Escobar, Ashish Kothari is also a good resource..

03
Metabolism

Aliaskar Abarkas
Ania Mokrzycka
Adriana Gallo
Raju Rage
Davide Marcianesi
Noa Jansma

It is always[1 2 3 4] metabolisings.[5 6 7 8 9 10]

[1] The dream with the lion has invited me to savor each bite I take with reverence, knowing that I am not merely nourishing my body and its inhabitants, but participating in a timeless and eternal cycle interconnected formshifting.



[2] Exposure as a submersible, submerged together, all of us in thick thick juices lapsing forever and ever.

[3] Food as gift from our eternal ancestors.

[4] Ever metabolising.

[5] During the intersection with other metabolisms, metabolisings.

[6] My body as a tiny dot in its connection the a global metabolising.

[7] We suffocate a cry of deafening moans that echoes across this furious interspecies dough, while the organ-organisms-metabolism-metabolisings fall into anaphylactic shock by their own functional nuclei.

[8] Every snack seen as contribution to a cosmic metabolic dance of metamorphoses.

[9] My understanding of eating from a biological and cultural act, reshaped towards eating as a cosmic metabolic dance, a political negotiation between borders, a vanishing between inside and outside, a relay in form, a strange loop in identity, as gift from our eternal ancestors, a unification of all life and matter.



[10] As I transform
(shape, size, sentience or
something else entirely)
<do I desire?>
? wildness - erotics - knowing ?
THERE IS NO BURDEN OF CERTAINTY
I ONLY DESIRE TO
DREAM OF CHANGE

Metabolisings are bound to digestion[11 12 13] with common[14] external[15 16] outcomes and internal[17] processes. They operate at a systemic level[18 19 20] and are implicated in the production,[21 22] use, and reproduction[23 24 25] of energy. [26 27 28 29] Digestion is a kind of subspecies of metabolisings, producing seemingly new [30 31] and novel material from existing ones.

[11] It may seem peculiar to write with enigmatic wonder about the process of digestion, as it is generally seen as something mundane.

[12] Through digesting matter, we digest our surroundings, its stories, our relations, ourselves.

[13] Digesting and being digested as a recognition that my contemporary form functions as a temporary custodian of this earthly existence.

[14] Life is a multispecie encounter and eating is its grand orgy.

[15] Now inside is now outside is now inside….

[16] A vanishing between inside and outside,

[17] Now inside is now outside is now inside….



[18] But there's only one thing that we can do to stop the thousands of voices that scream in pain and loss throughout our shared neural framework.

[19] This substrate of extrinsic sensations becomes more and more intense as intrasystemic breathing rises, GAK- -- runs out.

[20] *Perhaps this is a dream, or maybe it's the result of a traumatic experience. Whatever it is, I feel a deep sense of fear and uncertainty. But amidst these emotions, there's also a sense of wonder and curiosity. What lies beyond this dark and endless space? What secrets does it hold?*

[21] The food I eat carries with it the stories of its origin, the hands that nurtured it, the soil that nourished it, and the ecosystems that supported its growth.

[22] Sweat glands release all saline enzymes accumulated so far inthrough the torpid soil, thus lubricating the landscape.

[23] It carries the history and culture of the people who cultivated it, the traditions and customs that have shaped its flavors. Every meal becomes a tapestry of narratives woven together, binding me to diverse communities and distant lands and territories

[24] walls of warm wetness
<am I being re-born?>
some unrecognisable stench. Enzymatic cocktail.

[25] We'll breed with dead corpses and feel insignificant lust.

In this way digestion(s) are always transforming other [32] metabolising(s). We are always digesting and being digested by[33 34 35 36 37 38] something else in a continuous metabolic flow.[39 40] We are intertwining[41 42] metabolisings – an aggregate of nesting[43] and interrelated metabolic (and digestive)[44 45] systems.

[26] The energy I get to scroll on my phone, I had just gotten form the carrot.

[27] In consuming food, I partake in a cosmic exchange of energy and essence.

[28] There is no such pleasure as the one our organs are feeling while being emptied and burned by the nuclear heat of this explosion.

[29] Skins ignite in self-combustion.

[30] F r a g e
m n t
ed,
multiple selves r e l e a s e d from the burden of the
singular subject.

[31] And yet everything starts all over again, and the end is swallowed by a new beginning.

[32] I cannot see with my eyes, yet I am aware of my surroundings. There are no external boundaries, no hands, and no skin, yet I can sense everything around me. The air is thick and sticky, and there's a pungent smell that hangs in the atmosphere.

[33] This interconnectedness extends beyond the boundaries of my physical being. Our brain-gut connection is linking emotional and cognitive centers of the brain with peripheral intestinal functions. What, who and how we digest, is tightly interwoven in how we perceive.

[34] Putrid fossils raining down from the heavens pierce through all our cartilaginous slough, as this phagocytizing plague keeps deforming/transforming the corpse, extracting its waste, digesting itself.

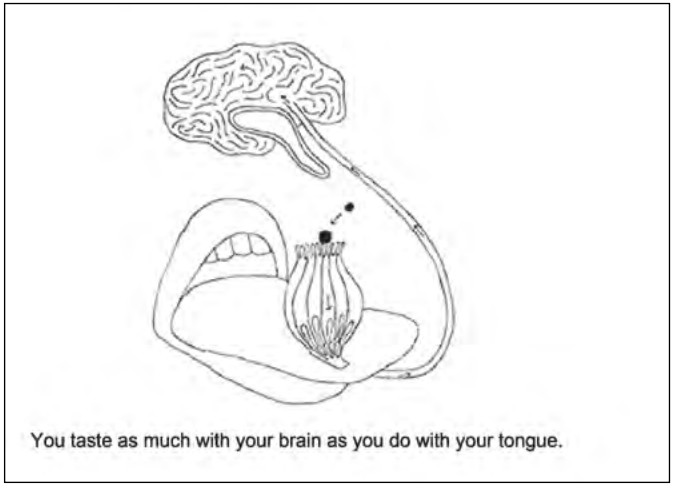
[35] Once it overflows from the rocky stomach-cave, it floods with burning each duodenal apparatus, which then carry it for thousands and thousands of kilometers away towards the interstitial exchange sac. There it'll be stored in dull torment while we anguish and toss all over the upland plateau.

[36] As I continue to navigate this surreal landscape, I can feel my senses heightening. The smell of the air is becoming more pronounced, and I can hear faint whispers in the distance. My body may be broken down into pieces, but I am still alive, and there's a sense of hope that I will find my way out of this dark and sticky place.



[37] An extended orgasmic sensation assaults our systems as our muddy glands get flayed and drained.

[38] Our tissues are immersed in acidic ponds. The pain of them rotting and burning and having all our lymphatic secretions being extracted, sucked-out, has us going crazy for more.



[39] The realisation that I am material that is destined to be absorbed by others, that I am food, has bestowed upon me a sense of connectedness throughout the foodchain that can take up cosmic scales when I let my mind wander.

[40] The lettuce I just ate had already absorbed my exhale, and its vapour had already dropped as rain upon my mothers lips before I existed.

[41] 'N o t h i n g i s c o n n e c t e d t o e v e r y t h i n g
E v e r y t h i n g i s c o nn e c te d t o s o m eth i ng'
(A c o l l e c t i v e m e m o r y)

[42] we intertwine to a clotted fossil made of coagulated emetic petroil; perhaps an extractive leftover from ancestral ages of violence and rape of the barren (agonizing) soil.



[43] The pile becomes the inverse of the pool

[44] We'll fade into other digestive oblivions.

[45] Our sense of taste is immediately suppressed and replaced by a slow and rising numbness, which gradually becomes so troublesome as the penetration of a thousand spines runs through the great jaw that devours everything, one for each digestive cycle intrinsic to these sediments.

Metabolising becomes a slippery[46] and unwieldy[47] tool for transformation.[48] A tool[49] for transformation[50] and metamorphosis with: a kind of metabolic labor. [51] [52] [53]

Where do organ/isms start,[54] and where do bodies end?[55] [56] [57] [58]

[46] However I truly experience it as a spiritual performance and ritual, and I think we can have a broader understanding of our lives when being conscious of this transcending act.

[47] this experience is both unsettling and intriguing, and I can't help but wonder what lies ahead.

[48] A long chain of breathing livers prolongs from our body running down the valley and functioning as a filter for all its radioactive soils.

[49] Every bite I take, every meal I enjoy, becomes an intricate dance of transformation.

[50] I dance
I roam I infiltrate
Expanded in metamorphis....
<I cannot be measured >
only in possibility
of potentiality

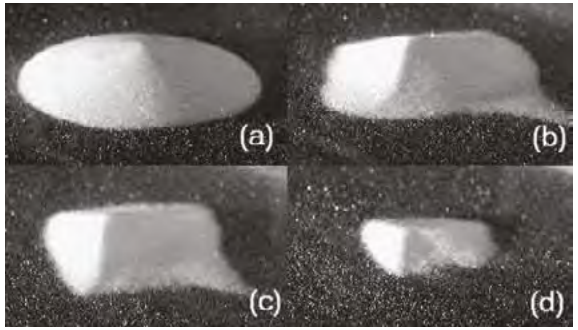
[51] GLUB BLOB BLUB – E-labor-ating this lumpy matter gets more and more aching.

[52] Eating is group work that requires many sizes. From the microbes in our gut, to the planetray health of our soils and climate.

[53] As a body of food enters my body, my flesh becomes their cocoon to transcend our temporary form.

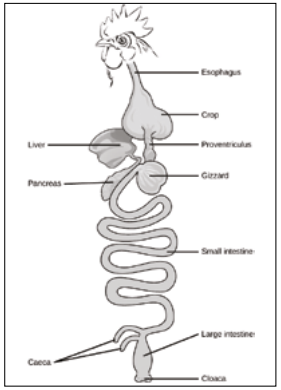
[54] I cannot seem to remember how I got here or what led me to this disorienting experience. It's as if my mind has been wiped clean, and all I am left with is this sense of detached presence. But even in the midst of this confusion and disorientation, there's a sense of expansion and connectedness. It's as if I exist both within myself and within everything else. I am a part of this dark, sticky, stinky space, yet I am also something more.

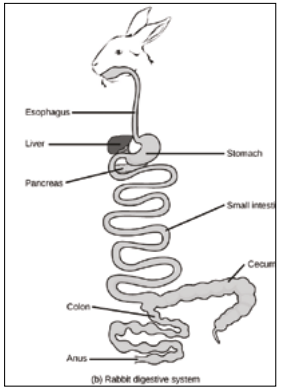
[56] We negotiate our borders until its meaning vanishes.

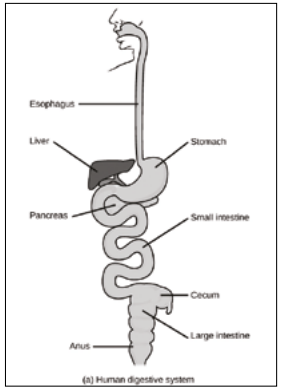


[57] We turn outside to inside until there is no distinction between the two. We become one, We change, we merge, I becomes We, with the simple realisation we were never apart.

[58] My body as a vessel to a community of temporary beings in temporary forms.







[55] migrating for what feels like millions of metres in moments, becoming the time it takes

to

B
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k, to s -p - l - i - t,

to d
i
s
s
o
l
v
e

to r e
f

o r
m.

Awakened
in a >constrained crevice< with a buBBling bUrning urge to E X P L O D E !

To inhabit and to be inhabited.[59]

Who inhabits who?[60]
What if we project this concept of a thing that transforms matter outside of the already known processes?[61]

And what happens when metabolisings are interrupted?

How do we contend with waste[62] and its function in metabolic systems?

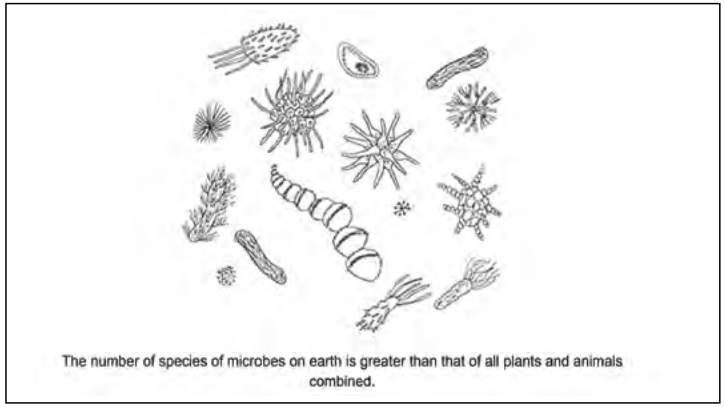
Fear or avoidance?[63]

Incorporation? [64] [65]
Production?
Utilization?
Elimination?[66]





[59] Being eaten and eating, catabolising and anabolising, rearranging our fleshes and identities.
[60] Our bodies can't take it anymore. There's nothing we can do to invert this deadly process,
[61] The surrounding landscape is thrown up, and we feel tremendously guilty.
[62] *As I try to navigate through this dark and seemingly endless space, I feel a deep sense of unease and confusion. It's as if my body has been broken down into pieces, yet I am still conscious of my identity and connectedness to everything around me.*
[63] The act of eating is a ritual, a spiritual communion with the world.
[64] Digesting as delicate balance between consumption and creation.
[65] *We'll jump into the abyss of million sharp teeth*



[66] I am non representational,
unfixed and unfathomable
Non normative since there are no norms, just processes.
[67] DECONSTRUCTED DISCPLACED
DECENTRED
doesn't matter, when matter is EVERYTHING, an
innnnnnfinnnnnniiiiiiittttttteeeeee alterity.
I am and I un/become in continuous cycles
I exist with
R A D I C A L O P
E N E S S
in
IM / PERFECTION

It is all de/composition[67 68 69 70] and re/composition[71 72] in order to resituate the concept of death[73 74 75] into that of a changing and infinitely lapsing[76] state.[77 78 79 80]





[68] Structures mutate as we evolve/involve, dismember, disintegrate,
[69] The hydrochloric well dissolves our bodies.
[70] We'll dissolve into unsterile fragments of flayed matter.
[71] Lapsing and growing in equal measure in every direction.
[72] reassemble and absorb without restraint in this chemical lust, beyond bodies and beyond identity.
[73] What is this nasty flavor? Millenary rotting? Dark fermentation of lifeless corpses? This paleozoic mixture is the result of stratifications and funerary sediments. The black goo tastes like death and void
[74] We'll die.
[75] I know how to LIVE and DIE well
for the (cellular) cause.
[76] I am in constant flux between meals
[77] No memory of the
OLD WORLD,
I am (in) the ANOTHER WORLD
Until i reach the NEXT WORLDS

reacting, fuelling, building, repairing, breaking, synthesising, converting, using, wasting,
[78] Everything is soaked.
Everything is still.
[79] We miss the pile and the heap. When part of us shifts the rest settles in its place until there are none left - when we have all left. All of us becomes less of us until we become more of us again.
[80] I encountered a lion. Ki told me ki would not attack me out of aggression, but solely because I was food. There was no guilt involved, it was my flesh, my body that would transform form.

Blossoming bodies

Aliaskar Abarkas
(Iran)

Are bodies of those who dream of
~~obliteration,~~
~~distraction,~~
disfiguration

Those bodies:
flowers blossom on their lamented fusty flesh,
~~odoriferous~~
scented
My body

blossomed
Datura Stramonium
thorny

I picked them
~~In (from) my deserted world~~

put them in a vase

beautifully arranged them for my funeral

Please bring
~~thorny~~
~~black roses~~

~~Splash the water~~
~~over my fallen body~~
~~(You say: I can't bare this smell coming from my body)~~

~~After we made love.~~
~~Remember?~~

Remember flowers grew from our pupils the moment we fell in love
~~to the heaven of my thoughts~~
~~Blossoming bodies~~
~~are bodies of those...~~
I say, love, it is a flower <3
And you say, it is only seed...
...It's the dream, afraid of waking
That never takes the chance
It's the one who won't be taken
Who cannot seem to give
And the soul, afraid of dying
That never learns to live...
...Just remember in the winter
Far beneath the bitter snow
Lies the seed that with the sun's love
In the spring becomes the rose
He played Bette Midler's "The Rose". He died the day after.

REEF/T

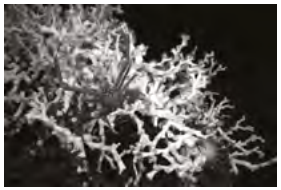
Ania Mokrzycka
(Poland)

c o r a l as
a morphing organism, commodity, relic, testament, metaphor and

a
mode of thinking

REEF/T
coral as a bone graft substitute explores a (never) singular human body as a territory of shifting compositions and interconnections. Taking this medical process as a starting point for a fictional account of two organisms folding into each other, the assumed boundaries of where one ends and the other begins are unsettled. The space in-between as a space of coexistence; an enlivened assemblage of difference and affinity. Threatened by the climate change and deterioration of the oceans, coral finds a new body of water to flourish in and the fragility of both is shared and transgressed. The new hybrid embodies a multiplicity of non-linear histories; marine life, destroyed ecosystems, damaged bodies and pharmaceutical industry collide in new, morphing identities.

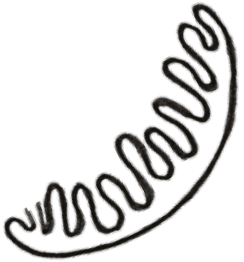
Rigs-to-Reefs — a practice of converting decommissioned offshore oil and petroleum rigs into artificial reefs. These human-made ecosystems seem to materialise "the possibility of life in capitalist ruins," as outlined by Anna Tsing. Monuments of species extinction, ecological disasters, colonial legacies, globalisation and capital (NB the financial relief of decommissioning costs for the oil companies) become







—the intersection of historicity and speculative potentiality, at once enduring and transient, as different temporalities
INHABITATION/
INDWELLING
and rationalities collide in the shifts between
the act of inhabiting/
historical, geological and biological time—
the state of
being inhabited









support structures for other species.
Quick flashes like falling stars, glowing clouds of dust particles, fluorescent planetary systems whiz and whirl around my fingers. I too yearn to be enlivened, touched, formless, dismembered, fractional.
Underwater, skin turns thinner. Salty blood surges beneath in contracting motion, strangely in sync with the distant rhythm of waves crashing onto some invisible shore. As osmotic pressure forces the liquids to pass through the fading membrane, I slowly fall on the ocean floor shrouded in bones Indistinguishable from each other, they are varnished in ink-black, holographic oil.

Tools for digestion

Adriana Gallo
(United States)

Tools for Digestion is a body of work and research positioning “digestion” not as a metaphor but a set of visceral, cultural, decompositional, and reproductive processes. Outcomes include interwoven texts and ongoing material experiments in which material is transformed by fermentation and the introduction of wild yeasts and bacteria into sculptural works and installations that both transform and decay over time. Digestion is a tool by which culture and nature interface and reproduce themselves in the moment between decay and emergence. Conventionally, tools may be an extension of the body, constructed from various materials — either as an implement (ex: stick, shovel) or a vessel (ex: bag, crock). The implement, used as an elongation, increasing the reach or exterior of the body, and the vessel an expansion, increasing the holding potential of the body by creating an alternative interior space. Both implements and vessels are developed as tools of (re) production and (re)productive labor but also as sites for digestion. The project examines the dialectical nature of tools and how they constitute a primordial ooze or a point of origin and the stuff into which matter decomposes and recombines: a digestive process with artifacts, leftovers, and outcomes of past cycles nourishing their reproduction. Digestion in this case describing the divergence from, and sublation by, nature - a relationship to nature fundamentally mediated by labor and tooling-with. Tools and digestion become keys to the potential integration of labor and class with climate and land as they encourage a consideration of utility in both so-called cultural and natural spheres and how transformation itself is the common trait in anything “useful” — in fact, “use” does more than imply transformation.
Use is transformation. And use is digestion.





Fig. 1: *Soul house (The Field Where I Died).* Long underwear, beeswax, milk pigment, echinacea purpurea grown from seed.

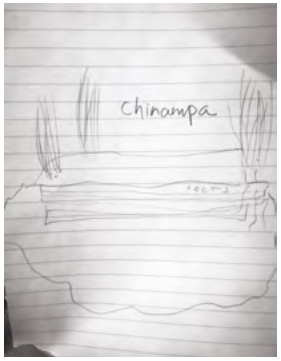
Fig. 2: *How To Convert Your Mower into a Generator*. Emergency blanket, pillow batting, semola (durum wheat) flour, water, oil, yeast, egg, shellac, sprouting potatoes.

The sixth river

Raju Rage
(Kenya)

As someone impacted by environmental crises in my worlds, I am reminded that the most impacted are the ones with the least access to the resources necessary to survive late capitalism. I have been think-feel-ing through the dichotomous concept of scarcity/abundance[1] as a fiction/myth, wondering what other pathways or in-between-ness might be. *Nepantla,* a Nahuatl word means "in the middle'' a positionality, instead of the western *non-binary*, which is a negation. Nepantla has referred specifically to the space between figurative and literal bodies of water[2], particularly in reference to both the Chinampa[3] (such as of Xochimilco, México) and Chicane of the (North American-Mexican) diaspora[4].





5

1 a basis of capitalist-colonial extractionism, which promotes exponential growth (at the expense of environment), monoculture agriculture (which damages ecosystems) and destroys the lives of all living beings extensively. In order to obtain abundance (although it is never enough) you need to be able to accumulate materially/economically through this capitalist system and if not you are relegated to scarcity (not having/being enough) which is undesirable and stigmatised. NOTE: The concept of abundance is being reclaimed by marginalised people, with and beyond financial economies, but are often still bound to this binary bind due to a lack of (re)distribution of resources and being trapped within this system.

2 as described by Anzaldúa, Gloria (1987). *Borderlands/La Frontera*. San Francisco: Aunt Lute Books. p. 276.

3 is a technique used in Mesoamerican agriculture which relies on small, rectangular areas of fertile arable land to grow crops on the shallow lake beds such as in Xochimilco, México. They are built up on wetlands of a lake or freshwater swamp for agricultural purposes, and their proportions ensure optimal moisture retention for fertile soil.The United Nations designated it a Globally Important Agricultural Heritage System in 2018.The Aztecs/Mexicas created the very first chinampa in the16th century.

4 Gender neutral form for Chicana/o (m/f)

5 Images: chinampa drawing by Nads / chinampa in Xochimilco

I ponder the term hydropoetics[6] as a way to communicate the complexity of this liquescence. The term *Vag*[7] meanders my way which describes 'flows, crossings, travels and mobilities rather than on moorings, fixity or closure'

Nepantla, while concerned with nationhood, also refers to being between two cultures, one's original culture and the dominant one, described as a "liminal" space where multiple forms of reality are navigated at the same time[8]. Nepantla can also describe individuals or groups who are in conflict with a larger globally reaching culture or ideology[9]. All these contexts derive from Latin American identidad y política (where I am currently based and am learning about), but there are pre and post-colonial cultural and social manifestations, reverberating within the S Asian subcontinent–a place I am connected to through diaspora. The region of 'Panjab'[10] as it is called by its people, a place of 5 rivers, was split into the two main territories, India and Pakistan in 1947[11] in response to independence from the British Empire's colonial rule as well as inter-conflicts. Regardless of this division, these waters[12] flow through political borders, posing the question, "is it possible to divide them?"

13



6 John Charles Ryan, 'Hydropoetics: The Rewor(l)ding of Rivers', 'Special Issue: Voicing Rivers', River Research and Applications 38, no. 3 (2021): 486–93,

7 The trope of the Punjabi term '*vag*' or flow connects with the notion of 'free-flowing cartographies' proposed by Anjali Gera Roy, emphasising that Punjab's geography is based 'on a history of flows, crossings, travels and mobilities rather than on moorings, fixity or closure'

8 Guiterrez, Rochelle

9 Mignolo, Walter D. (1 January 2000). "Introduction: From Cross-Genealogies and Subaltern Knowledges to Nepantla".

10 'Punjab' refers to the colonial administration and 'Panjab' is the name given by its people. The name is made of two persian origin words Panj (Five) + Aab (Water), land of five rivers: Sutlej, Beas, Ravi, Chenab, and Jhelum.

11 Panjab as a trans-river land in the post-1947 world.

12 The Indus has five main tributaries. The Jhelum, the largest of these, originates in the Valley of Kashmir. The Chenab, a second tributary, flows through the Jammu region of the state of Jammu and Kashmir, both flow through Pakistan before entering the Indian state of Panjab. The remaining three tributaries (Ravi, Sutlej and Beas) either originate or flow through India's state of Himachal before entering Indian Panjab. The historian J.S. Grewal points out that Punjab was the land of six, not five, rivers, and that the name 'Punjab' itself was originally given to the Lahore province to cover the five *doab*s (interfluvial plains) of the region

13 map of 5 rivers Philipp Weckenbrock

'pāṅī soṭā māreyāṅ kadī do nahī hunde [14]
(even when beaten by a stick, water will never divide into two)

To see how scarcity and abundance can be expanded on through *nepantla or Vag*, I will not extract or appropriate these terms/ ideas/ embodiments from their contextual specificity, instead I want to borrow them as tools for imagining a third/sixth/other place of being. Nepantla can be a difficult experience of otherness and instability. It can be a state that creates anxiety but it can also be reclaimed as libertory with its inherent depositioning and disidentification[15]. Nepantla communicates how we may inhabit a flexible mode, being both, between or being many, versus inhabiting a single fixed location, *Vag* expresses a similar flexibility in fluidity and motion.

'seeing from two or more perspectives simultaneously renders those cultures transparent. Removed from that culture's center you glimpse the sea in which you've been immersed but to which you were oblivious, no longer seeing the world the way you were enculturated to see it.'

16



My ancestors left Panjab for Kenya in the early 1900's as a way out of scarcity and to seek abundance promised to colonial subjects by the British Empire in their colonies. This was gained through their extraction of valuable resources across the globe, namely in Asia, Africa and Americas for territory, trade, slave/ indentured labour and war[17].

The British, in partnership with native governments wanted to develop 'Punjab' agriculturally because the soil is very fertile due to its many rivers and thus facilitates abundant growth of crops which would lead to an abundant agricultural production which would be profitable, a continuation of colonial logic that extended after independence. The

14 Singing the River in Punjab: Poetry, Performance and Folklore, Radha Kapuria and Naresh Kumar

15 As described by José Esteban Muñoz, the ways in which one situates oneself both within and against the various discourses through which we are called to identify.

16 video still for the song '*Vagdī e Rāvī De Vich Uḍḍan*', sung by Noor Jehan, from *Faqeeria* (1987) where the Pakistani actor Mumtaz performs a fast-paced choreography to match the song, most notably swirling both arms in circular fashion to mimic the dangerous whirls or '*pambhīrīyāṅ*' rising in the Ravi

17 https://blogs.lse.ac.uk/africaatlse/2016/10/24/britain-and-the-scramble-for-east-africa/

green revolution brought input responsive Mexican wheats to Panjab in the mid-1960s which became a dominant mono crop[18] which devastated the areas biological diversity but increased production and productivity of agricultural industry which the state power and corporations mainly gained from.The repercussions over time have resulted in local deprivation as well as a battle between farmers and governments with notorious farmers suicides and successful revolts[19].



20



[21] I want to swim in this trouble.



what would it mean to understand abundance outside of capitalist extractivist frameworks? I wonder, If reworlding is in fact re-wilding[22] and what would our role/responsibility as humans be in it?

18 https://www.dailyo.in/variety/green-revolution-punjab-india-food-wheat-19054

19 Farmers revolts 2020-2021 farmers and farm unions across India joined protests against the government reforms and were successful in their opposition https://www.scientificamerican.com/article/farm-protests-in-india-are-writing-the-green-revolutions-obituary/

20 Image from funambulist article PUNJAB'S FIELDS OF LIBERATION: THE FARMER STRIKE AND THE SIKH STRUGGLE and How green revolution led to 'deterioration' of Punjab economy, land, air and water https://www.counterview.net/2021/10/how-green-revolution-led-to.html

21 Hand-painted scroll, '*Panoramic Depiction of the Fort and Old City Walls of Lahore*', late eighteenth–early nineteenth century. © The British Library Board. Image courtesy: Radha Kapuria

22 Rewilding is about creating the conditions for nature to thrive, re-establishing natural processes to repair ecosystems and boost biodiversity. (Rewilding Britain). It differs from ecological restoration in that, while human intervention may be involved, rewilding aspires to reduce human influence on ecosystems. There is debate as to how much involvement humans should have in this process.

A reclamation of abundance is *'not only that there is enough, but that when we share, there is more'*. This would mean *it* is shared within the community instead of neoliberal individual consumption, something like the Panjabi Sikh practice of *sevā*[23], instead of prioritising accumulation, implementing dispersal. Unfortunately, Nahuatl as a language is considered endangered by linguists because it's not being passed on to the next generation due to pressures to speak hegemonic colonial languages like Spanish and English. Without a community to speak your language with, how can *it* exist? Many dialects of Panjabi have been lost too in a similar vein, where ethnic communities migrate to larger cities and far away countries and lose (and adapt) aspects of culture. Needless to say there are resistance movements to preserve and reclaim these important cultural resources, though language, terms and definitions will often let us down.

We (must) know that ecosystems are more resilient when abundant in (bio)diversity, inverting the capitalist manifestation of abundance in sameness. Not more in amount, but many in variety.

The rivers in Panjab flow abundantly, in the sense that they subvert boundaries and cannot be stopped or detoured unless they dry out. Governments are proposing to build a floating Riverfront City.[24] on Ravi river and a hydroelectric power development on river Chenab in Panjab. The Indus/ Sindhu is now a conflicted-ridden,dying river that does not meet the sea anymore. These rivers are romanticised and lamented upon in poetry and songs but also bear witness to violence. The poet Lal Singh Dil[25] describes the Sutlej river as both a witness to, but also a shelter from, the darkness, poverty and grief of a Punjab ravaged by capitalism and partition. Mexican artist Paloma Contreras Lomas also speaks to the complicity of 'landscape as witness' in her video works concerning the relationship between nationalism, occupation and instrumentalisation of territory in Mexico. Paloma utilises fictional characters such as the fog, an omnipresent narrator who sees everything whilst unfolding narratives based on Mexican histories of extractivism, territories and caste systems. Paloma mentions that the subsoil in landscape acts as a metaphor for

23 is the concept of selfless service which benefits other humans and communities that is performed without any expectation of result or award for performing it.

24 Pakistan government has plans to concretise the Ravi's flood-plains under the Ravi Riverfront Urban Development Project. https://www.theguardian.com/global-development/2021/nov/02/we-will-be-homeless-lahore-farmers-accuse-mafia-of-land-grab-for-new-city

25 Punjabi poet of the Naxalite (Marxist-Leninist) movement and revolutionary anti-caste activist



26

underground truths hidden through colonial impact. As an artist myself, I consider the potentiality of *art* as a means of creative flow for complicated and complex articulations in embodied research.

Panjab has been mostly spoken about in terms of terrain, territory, partition, its peoples and agriculture. However, through the act of conceptualising the trans-river[27], trans corporeality[28] and becoming more river centric I am left with the consideration of what can flow in fluidity, for flow is a moving energetic economy that connects ecology, culture and identity that transcends notions of scarcity and abundance. I seek to (re)imagine the mythical metamorphic transitional power of the sixth river[29] through my creative arts practice.

'Exile begins where rivers end.
I dream my limbs and head are the five rivers that make fertile
the land of my ancestors. I dream about wild music,
about longing, about an end to thirst.

My tongue ploughs through black silt, lifting scraps of language, history, myth. I unbraid the water from my blood and surrender to the soil.[30]

26 Jagdeep Raina, *These are corpses in the rivers of Punjab*, 2021, Embroidered tapestry, phulkari border on muslin, 13" X 24", 33.02cm X 60.96cm

27 River centric rather than terracentric 'it is the two nations—India and Pakistan—that are trans-river, rather than the rivers being transnational.' Singing the River in Punjab: Poetry, Performance and Folklore, Radha Kapuria and Naresh Kumar

28 Term coined and written about by Stacy Alaimo

29 Panjabi writer and theologian Bhai Vir Singh has been called the sixth river, for his poetry https://www.sikhnet.com/news/bhai-vir-singh-sixth-river-punjab

30 *Of the Punjab Faisal Mohyuddin*: https://rhinopoetry.org/poems/of-the-punjab-faisal-mohyuddin

Aruspicina Futura

Davide Marcianesi
(Italy)

Aruspicina is the art of reading the entrails of dead animals as a divinatory practice to understand the future. This gruesome process was a performative ritual developed by the Etruscans, a population that lived in Italy between the 9th and the 1st Cen tury B.C., who believed that due to the close relationship between the macro- and the microcosm, the distribution of the celestial vault – which regulated their political system – was also reflected on the Earth's individual elements, both living and non-living[1].

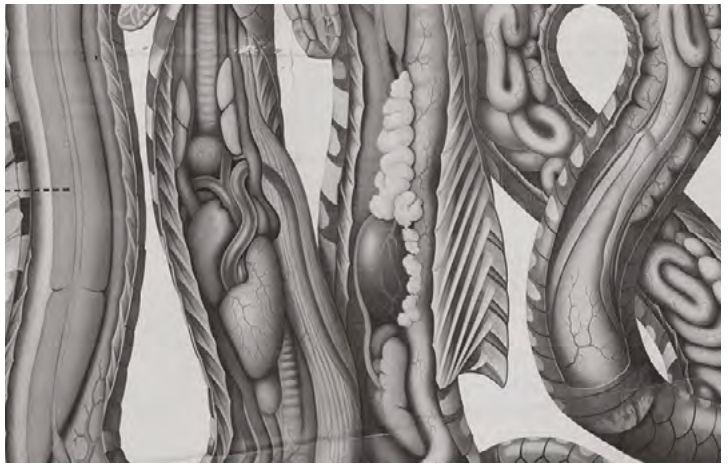
But what do death and dead organisms have to do with politics in a postnatural ecosystem?

Donna Haraway eviscerates this concept while describing the Chthulucene, a new era in which all critters live and "die together"[2], as if it was an other form of being (interdependently) rather than as a form of non-existence: a way to intertwine and mold the fleshes between different species in a perpetual process of co-generation.

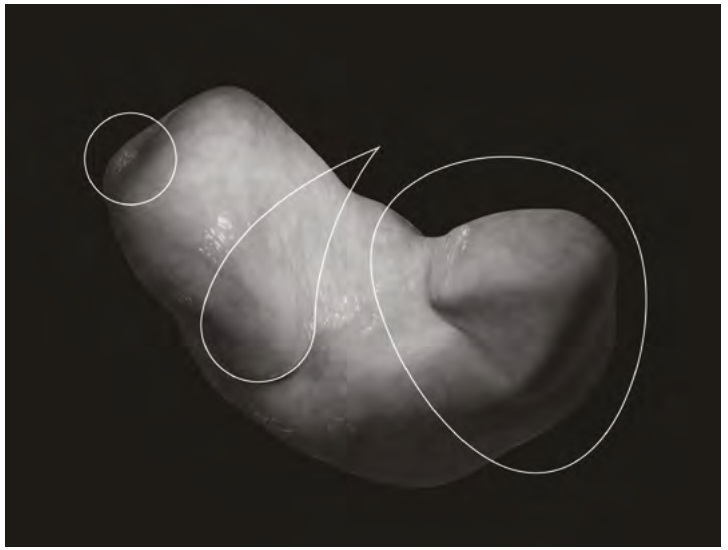
In this context, *Aruspicina Futura* works as an interdisciplinary, interspecies research that dissects and scrutinizes dead ecologies in order to foresee our shared future on planet Earth.

The project addresses—and re-contextualizes—the relevance of Aruspicina in utilizing theoretical models of animal organs as tools to expose and narrate ghostly paradigms of death and violence towards bodies and corpses, along with the impli cations such patterns have on the lives of human- and other-than-human-kinds. In doing so, the researcher becomes the haruspex itself who, by designing and displaying postnatural entrails to a public, unveils histories of extractive abuse perpetrated by humans upon other organisms, and enables new speculative narratives to reconcile our existence with a "tentacular" necropolitical ecosystem.

1



2

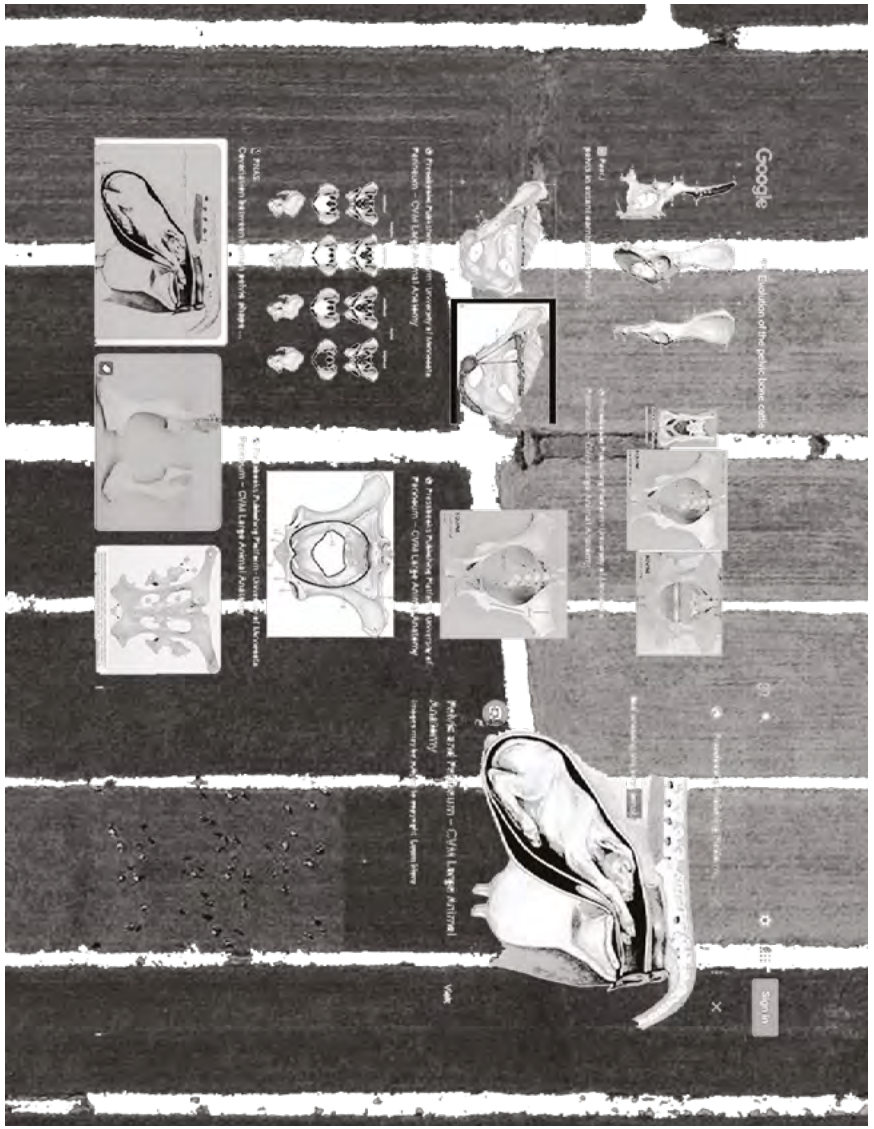


1: M. Cristofani (1985). Dizionario della Civiltà Etrusca. Giunti Martello, Firenze.
2: D. Haraway (2016). Staying with the Trouble: Making Kin in the Chthulucene. Durham: Duke University Press.

Fig. 1: Ophidia, Tropidonotus natrix, Tab. 18 (detail). Pfurtscheller, P., 1910.
Fig. 2: Digital reproduction of a fictional animal organ with its geometries of interest, 2023.

Pelvic Passage Politics : Embodied Narratives in Anatomical Architecture

Noa Jansma
(Netherlands)



A panorama of squares sharing the color code #264e2f. Green after green after green arises a geometric conformity. My body walking the straight lines in geometric comfortability. This ecology I would call native. This land I would ca The scenery I've learned to perceive as idyllic, picture led with occasional rectangular creatures with the c 0 and #ffffff, black and white. I have been raised to re and still I wonder if I have seen more dead cows than l fe? I wonder what the longest period of time is I have ever ob l? I wonder why their backs are so straight? Why their hips are so p o the protruding wings of the cows' pelvis ever ache the hide? Why d eir pelvic form look so uncanny to me? Did the dairy industry impact t vic form of a cow? Are we skeleton-engineering a cow's pelvic to op continuous reproduction flow?
How have we com e where certain breeds can no longer give birth without a farmer c -section because the pelvis is too distorted in form? What are the politics of the pelvic form? Did their metabolism adapt to human milk and meat digestion? Is the pelvis of a cow transformed through patriarchal values? Are female bodies throughout species ever oppressed in same ways? How are boundaries between anatomy an red through selective breeding and pelvimetry? How would a post- appear?
Can we treat the form of a cow's pelvis as a s e exploitation and objectification of female bodies v would a cow look in the most human What hidden narratives of resilience and reproductive agency lie within the contours of the cow's pelvis? Do cows ever experience insecurities about their m ? Could we have seen the form of a cow's pel ? Is domestication a curse? Should to st-nature world? Is an AI better at fa ers' hands? How do we measure a c d happen if bulls could produce milk? ws n driving by car? Is Cow-h heir nment as nature? What is the c s average divided betwe What do t people, and what does in the c as symbol of fertility and then cla ? What material implicati ? H does a cow appear?

A panorama of recta
Their backs as straig
mountainlike form ar

18:27:37
From Caroline Ward :
What if we are coming from a minoritized position, and an alternative is something we want to realise that's not detached?



18:31:00
From Ama :
Can you go back to the point that, PostNatural time would free the future from natural time of the present (if I've gotten that right)?Particularly, what exactly (or what kind of thinking) are you positioning as the present and when you say natural time, what exactly do you mean (as in growing time, seasonal time? Or more like Enlightenment temporalities)?

18:31:43
From Ama :
It's a really exciting idea, I just want to make sure I'm understanding it correctly

18:36:16
From Ishita Jain :
I want to throw a book (which is simultaneously a work of craft and tribal art) in this mix where we are talking about minorities and "high-art"… I bring this example to, most of all, discuss what we mean by "abstract" in art. These tribal drawings are both representational and non-representational at the same time - partly because of the alternate cosmology in which they are imagined.

https://www.themarginalian.org/2011/09/20/the-night-life-of-trees-tara-books/

18:40:46
From Ama :
Thank you - that was really helpful. So then if I understand correctly, there is actually nothing "natural", as in nothing "more-than-human" about natural time, it is entirely a human consumptive/ extractive blueprint as you call it, for time?

18:47:34
From Ishita Jain :
This discussion makes me very curious about how the notion of time in oral cultures would contribute to the idea of Postnatural. Writing as a technology also seems complicit in the evolution of this consumptive blueprint for time…

18:54:39
From Felix Bell :
This reminds me of this paper I read called "the papalagi" - "I think time slips from their grasps like a snake slipping out of a wet hand, only because they always try to hang on to it. He won't let time come to him, but runs after it with his hands outstretched. He` doesn't afford himself the time to stretch out in the sun"

18:59:24
From Matheline Marmy :
I think I saw Timothy Morton's name appearing in one of your slides but didn't get time to read in which you are mentioning him. Where do you contextualize his work in that « time perspective » conversation?

18:59:38
From Matheline Marmy :
*way

19:03:57
From Raju Rage (they/them/elle) :
that's a good read of Morton lol. except queerness has indeed become respectable and colonial in some contexts, I guess neoliberal

19:04:28
From Raju Rage (they/them/elle) :
plurality of queerness in necessary too

19:05:46
From Clara Benito (she/they) :
If queerness is not plural is it still queer?
Maybe a stupid question but nevertheless

19:06:31
From Clara Benito (she/they) :
The text about queer multitudes by Paul B.
Preciado comes to mind

19:09:37
From Raju Rage (they/them/elle) :
Replying to "If queerness is not ..."
I get that queerness is inherently plural though
lol

19:11:40
From Clara Benito (she/they) :
Replying to "If queerness is not ..."
Kind of the point of the text I mentioned below
is that a queer multitude is necessarily non-self
identical, not that it is somehow "identically
queer", which is radically in contrast with the
representations of queerness that these kinds
of discourses mobilise (Morton, neoliberalism,
capitalism, identity politics…)

19:13:18
From Raju Rage (they/them/elle) :
Replying to "If queerness is not ..."
i guess my point was just that our idea of
queerness is transforming as is queerness (in
whatever ways). But also in the arts and academia
it has been coopted/hijaked/odified. So when Morton
or any other liberal discourse speaks on queerness
what are they actually speaking of? whether
queerness is un/natural or not seems to always be
the focus also which is tiring.

19:14:39
From Ama Josephine (she/her) :
Well exactly - or are they just trying to stay
relevant? I think we can also really see this
in the way liberal discourses have taken up /
cannibalised "wake work"

19:18:20
From Ama Josephine (she/her) :
It also places the position/ontology/cosmology/
community as only ever existing in the future,
which is exactly the same as only allowing it
to exist in the past: ie making it "safe" and
extractable in the present.

19:18:34
From Caroline Ward :
I enjoyed a couple of chapters from the Elizabeth
Grosz book (Rethinking Queer Subjectivity, and
Architecture from the Outside).

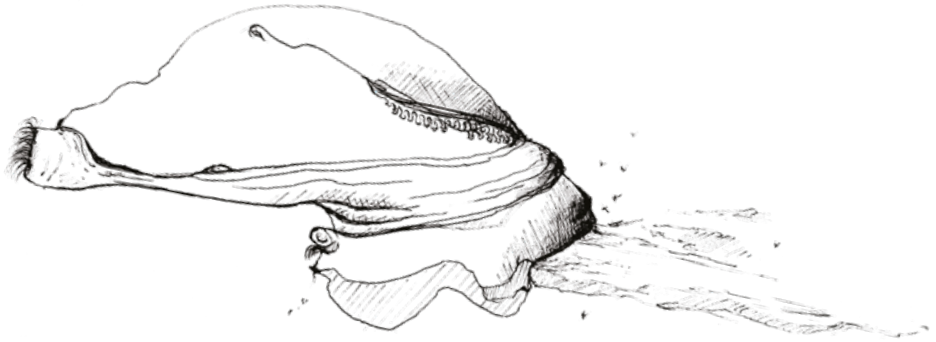
19:34:29
From Sai Di :
Could you unpack a bit more on the "nuanced" ways
of thinking and doing post-natures, perhaps with
a couple of examples? In my case, I'm conscious
of my research interest in eastern cosmology
and spirituality. I didn't grow up with these
spiritual influences… it was introduced to me a few
years ago through life events. Your talk inspired
me to think about how to continue developing
nuances of this art project NOT from a Western/
colonial way of learning and working with these
traditional cosmologies.

04
Desirable futures

Sai Di
Sol Archer
Ishita Jain
Madison Bycroft
Ama Josephine Budge Johnstone
Diogo da Cruz

Jumping in
FEET FIRST

The corpse took to moving horizontally, dragging themselves on their stomach under the weight of the gasses. Like that, they were no longer welcome amongst the upward society, amongst the vertical bias of erection, and were banished to the lowly red areas, where the wastewater gathers from the slaughterhouse and the ochre mine. Extending this way and that way but mostly horizontally, the corpse (botched/frankenstein?) accumulated and recomposed themself amongst ammonia, endocrine disruptors and general muck. Being of such uncertain consistency, they took to light afternoon studies in an attempt to make sense of their constituent parts. They became exquisite. An exquisite corpse. (Body of text, footnotes, side margin, header)



Ex-Qui-Site - from whom you are

{ such uncertain consistency, this loving, grieving, fucking : fighting to stay alive in spite of all the reasons to hold ones breath until your thudding heart stops beating }

Afternoon belongs to Porkie pig and a world that kills Night. The slaughter of Night is carried out in myriad and inconspicuous ways, of which the most visible and invisibilized is the superstructure called the industrial complex. Afternoon upholds the upward society, or is it the other way round? Having experienced the peak emotions of High Noon, a time of no shadows, Afternoon strives to go back to the past, attempting to recreate that moment in time through whatever means necessary. The industrial complex is an offspring of that desire. To recreate absolute clarity, absolute certainty. To slay all shadows, all indeterminacies.

Enter the emergence of a vocabulary of the will.

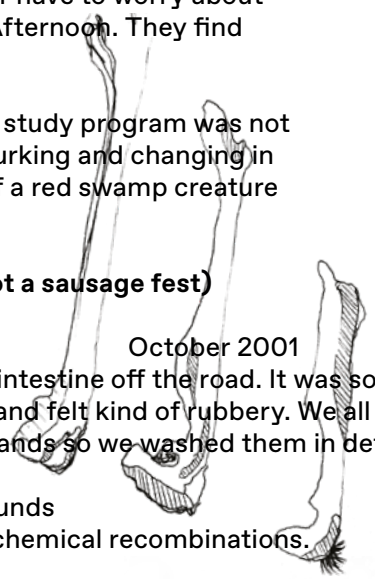
The industrial complex, a slave of One Time - One Type, since then has mutated, hyphenated. Look around and we find its garish, outlandish and powerful siblings. Art-industrial complex, Academic-industrial complex, Medico-industrial complex, Care-industrial.... Galleries, Museums, Universities, Academic Presses, Corporate Hospitals, Hospice centres, Old-Age homes, Orphanages...
{ ~~we~~ note : night is also killed slowly : intimately :with a plunging banality that leaves you somehow implicated in the dragging of one's own fettered remains towards the furnace. not a compost heap : no reconstitution for the likes of us : tender cannibals : well-intentioned and fatally sweet }

The Exquisite Corpse
{ a body without organs ? }
is what remains upon multiple encounters with these complexes and these spatialities. It is what remains despite an encounter with industrial spatial materialities. A gradual erasure of the Night in Self, and by extension, a gradual diminishing of the Night in the worlds around. A horizontal Exquisite Corpse is a figure of resistance against the hegemony of Afternoon to slaughter Night. It is the slaughtered Self as it survives the slaughtering, crawling in resistance, bodying back with the muck, taking in the abject horizontality, which is no longer abject, the new Sacred. It stirs with shadows as bodies; it moves, not between worlds, but within worlds, within multiple selves that make the Self.

Becoming so unfit and ineligible for all the possible industrial complexes, they no longer have to worry about being accepted or rejected by the Afternoon. They find new allies.

Recognising that such a structured study program was not for them, they took to non-Sense, lurking and changing in the mud and soon rumors spread of a red swamp creature loitering around town.

WHERE DIGESTION HAPPENS (not a sausage fest)



October 2001
I was responsible for taking the intestine off the road. It was soooo long. It was a greeny grey colour and felt kind of rubbery. We all had dried blood over our hands so we washed them in dettol.

Volatile organic compounds
Genetic hormonal and chemical recombinations.



FLESH FASHION BOOMING, face shoes in vogue

SLAY
strike, beat, strike so as to kill, commit murder
It is attested by late 12c. as “destroy, put an end to.” The meaning “overwhelm with delight” (mid-14c.) preserves one of the wide range of meanings the word once had, including, in Old English, “stamp (coins); forge (weapons); throw, cast; pitch (a tent), to sting (of a snake); to dash, rush, come quickly; play (the harp); gain by conquest.” Slay queen but also yes the queen is dead.

knackered/ knackery /
knackers yard / got the
knack /
knick knack paddy
whack /
fatigued
picking off scabs
Pierrot/THE EGG ADDLER?

Owing to lack of interest, tomorrow has been cancelled. (replaces eggs - now addled). You are now in the strawberry beds of the eternal present. And as he sang these words he danced and caught with one hand the sheets of a newspaper which turned slowly in the breeze whirling the great events of the world over and over, over and over, and when he had caught them, he smiled and threw them into the air again. Ours are the golden pavilions of today. (Derek Jarman)

Wings dipped in ochre muck, antennae weighted down with crusted blood mixed with ashes and cement, limbs upwards they fly in broken circles, upwards is downwards, downwards is upwards, bloated little bodies shimmering in toxic golden glow. (The radical ant says “up with the queen”) Swarming, they produce intestine-like eggs with gaping mouths and eyelash feelers jittering as they slither forward and spread over more and more of the earth surface. Obscure and covered in cell-producing marrow, they burrow into the night, the night that has long eaten the light, the cold metal halide light absorbed by the concrete walls that listened but never recoiled. Incarcerated to be incinerated, the afterimage ex site wobbling in its absence. Genetic code re-combined in accumulated sequences of mechanised slaughter, corpses produced, moved and removed, replaced with living bodies that slowly expired from old age and heat. Within the crevices

of remaining scattered bones, they hide in shadows to make their last flight into the burning skies.

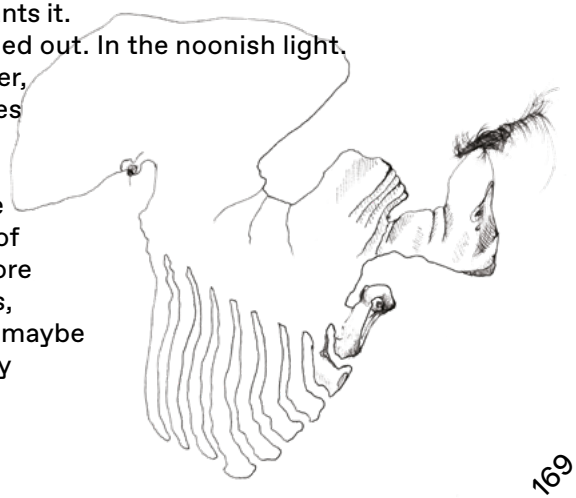
EX-QUIS-ITE - From Whom do you go?

Unfurled fingers. Edgeless collarbones.
“Becoming with habitats, resources,
associations and involvements”
Secret pockets tucked in armpits and
elsewhere, lingering in folds loitering
in the space between fingers
Desiring and with-holding
disjointed, bare-bones, fleshed out, gutted, filletted,
pared-down,

lotus eaters, raw fish eaters, bread eaters, pig eaters, potato-eaters, cheese-eating surrender monkeys, roast-beefs, snail-eaters, man-eaters, egg-eaters, cannibals, who eats an exquisite corpse, the paper folder, the bean counter

Porkie Pig shuns the Numan Beans

Shamble legs, stiff legged, long legged, the ambling, shambling, perambulating grumbling King, arrives from the North ready ruined, pronouncing upon his right, given the practices of the time, to be and to own. And to eat. An upstanding christian man, an early riser, a man of science, an industrialist, a philanthropist much given to sharing his o-pinions over a sausage, be that muerguez, in the way of Marseille; alheira, of the new Christians in the Portuguese style; or heavens own, the wafer, the host, the body and bread, finely sliced chorizo from Good Clean Christian Pork.
Now, then. Now. Then. The means justify the ends...or? But anyway it’s a moment of reflection because these young critics, vegetarians perhaps, are out to ban his meat. His lifeline, his connection to history, to god, to nation. The Pork, a cultural institution. And they, these young, these bean eaters, are going to ban it. He’s sure. And then what?
The state of things. The PLACE-ness of things, the territory in which the things are and to whom the things belong is, naturally his to call his own. The state decrees the correct procedure to produce an acceptable human being, a state of human being, the fifth state of matter, must be: A Sausage Eater.
Before he came down, shamble legs, rambling down from The North at the side of the illustrious lustrous Mrs Shamble Legs, Queen of swine and roses, gilt browed and iron clad, the pig enjoyed its place, in as much as an animal can enjoy anything, he supposes, on the fringes, grubbing around in the earth for grubs. Unstuck, un-struck, un-slain, wilfully not a block in the construction of an acceptably human being. But now, quite rightly its place is on the table. Garnishing the Christmas roast, salt fat on easter, dried and spiced and swinging on the back of a shepherds pack. Sunday morning bacon. What actually even was it they ate before? And what do they, these new bean cutters, expect him to eat? Blood calls to blood, so they came on down and turned those pigs to pork, to civilise the place, to spruce things up a bit, to plant this little world just the way he wants it.
Good practice in fact, it turned out. In the noonish light.
You are what you eat, or rather,
what you don’t eat determines
what you aren’t.
But territory, the state of
things gets a bit shaky as the
temperatures rise, the state of
matter getting somewhat more
energetic, these other worlds,
these not-so-sausage eating maybe
more than human worlds may



even be shutting the door on his
shambolic factory of state. Then
how would a Good Upstanding
Family carry on its duty to make
more Upstanding Citizens? Melt-in
the mouth tender citizen wafers
of fine air dried ham from the cold
mountains of The North?
Inside our opalescent eyes, underneath the thinning membrane of eyelids now wrought like parchment paper covered in browning, crusty beeswax, electric flashes; frantic splurges of red, blue and yellow. Remembrances, imaginings, sensations enclosed within unspoken pasts. Shrieks never witnessed, yet echoing in ruined chambers of production lines. Embalmed, our body lies underneath layers of rubble, pooling in evaporated blood, piss and bile. Always-forgetting-yet-not-forgotten, it nurtures the eggs and the larvae of the new indwellers, our cells consumed and digested, as the soils form themselves anew.



{ **before THE EGG** there was THE BASEMENT : the basement where the fucking happened : the smell of blood never faded : had in fact become it's own fetish : the animal in us meeting the animal ancestors : the ones for whom consent was not possible : they remain in the walls : in the floor : in the rusted, metal grates that line the walls : slotted mouths puckering with thirst : dark holes of brutal memory : no forgiveness here : only the squelching of bodies on bodies : digits in cavities : oblivion thudding against the present : they are present in the leather instruments : appendages : and obscurations : they are present in the sweat and the squeals and the moans : they are present in the sobbing that comes after : in the guilt and the climax and the shame : in the ecstasy of flesh entering flesh : of becoming one another : we become them as our encasings collapse : sausage meat spilled all over the floor : fat and sinew and blood : juices leaking : saliva beaded : the crowd poised : the bass-line suspended : the sex club sated, yet hungry for more }

Various spellings of "to kill" in Shang Dynasty oracle bone scripts of sacrificial animals //Adam C. Schwartz, "Shang Sacrificial Animals"... may need to consider image copyright. https://doi.org/10.1017/9781108551571.003

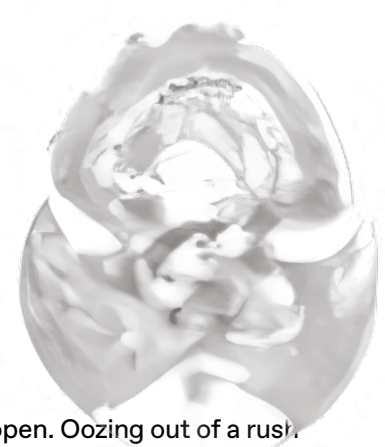
Ex-Quisi-te - because I wanted you

A variant is discovered in the vicinity of a mineral-rich lake known as Kłlilx'w - the "spotted lake". The natives believe the peculiarity of its crater-like appearance was once created by the solar shadows from an epoch when the Earth was a gigantic ball of swirling slush.

The variant is characterized by its missile-like physique - a skull of exceptional density, vestigal wings the size of a sunflower seed and webbed feet with the middle digits attached. A bulk of the studies of this variant come from the research of its remnant due to its brief life span - ranging between a few seconds to less than an hour.

Unlike most of its genus, it hatches during the dry season of the year, when the striking chalky white and rust-orange ovals surface the lake, layered with calcium, magnesium, sodium, and sulphates. It's during this time that the gander from a closely related species assumes the role of caregiver. In the final stages of incubation, the male goose ascends above the lake as high as seven to eight kilometers, suspending the

Imagine a civilization - the worth of its genetic sequence is not simply preserved but reconfigured and suspended in the silos of time. Awaiting a tomorrow that yet clings to the edge of uncertainty, a limbo oscillating between cancellation and affirmation. To resurrect a state of being from vitrification. Isn't it a testament to life's innate capacity to persist, to list, to lust?



egg in the air until it cracks open. Oozing out of a rush of gunk, the newborn plummets headfirst into the lake's recessed water line, reaching its cryptic bottom and entirely submerged within seconds. The swift burial combined with the lake's mineral-rich strata, expedites the process of fossilization. Within eight to ten months, the creature's body petrifies, transforming into a luminescent amber coloured relic roughly the size of a child's fist.

The fossils of these self-sacrificial species are revered and believed to possess abilities to appease the restless spirits of the slaughtered animals. It is widely thought they guide these spirits colliding upon one another to the Kuiper Belt, a circlet aureole in the outer solar system teeming with small bodies of frozen volatiles. The scattered dust, debris and stellar remnants are drawn to the wandering spirit upon its arrival, gradually amassing around their energy cores to grow new celestial entities. NASA discovered the first object of this nature in 2046 and named it Dzunukwa.

Since its initial emergence, the Kłlilx'w Diver fossils have become a sought-after crypto commodity traded anonymously by a network of shamans, slaughterhouse workers, war zone soldiers, mafias, police, politicians, animal humane societies and unrecognized religious organizations. In the Kłlilx'w region, a tradition has evolved amongst the local children who seek out the Diver fossils buried in the lake bed in the Long Night of Easter.

There was no metamorphosis, only layering, the so-called change-of-intended-use. Containing art was only a brief parenthesis in the history of this institution. Today, the Slaughterhouse has been partially disassembled to contain the city's only green park, under the protective dome that guarantees stable temperature and humidity control. Partly for historical reasons, partly for reasons of efficiency in the management of public spaces, this park hosts some of the animals rescued from what was once the ZOO of Madrid. In a single controlled space, several hundred animal and plant species coexist, now impossible to survive in the desert landscape of central Spain.

The ceilings of the old Slaughterhouse, blackened by time and the passage of livestock have been removed to shed light on the animals that now continue their lives here. Inside the original tiles with their channels for the flow of blood remain, still coming in handy. Outside the slaughterhouse building all is parkland, with a vast variety of trees and a rose garden.

What is Post-Animal

Sai Di
(China/Canada)

With the support of the Canada Council for the Arts

What, precisely, is an Animal? Bloated glans, majestic gaze, yielding skins and shrouded shells - Is it a purely biological construct or a vessel bearing the weight of myth and narrative? Is it a tangible embodiment of genes, nutrition, thought and instincts or a symbiotic assemblage of beings and representations at the threshold of planetary pleasure and pressure?

Then, what constitutes a Post-Animal? The keen edge of spikes, the cacophony of spills - the gravitational draw of the core and its eventual abandonment. Might the Post-Animal be a reflection of the animal's gaze back upon itself through an augmented mirror — fuzzy horns, dim light, saturated skins — simultaneously observing and being observed, cloaked in ambiguity? Could it be a complex living mesh with creases and folds, extending into a multi-dimensional kinship that transcends mere genetic lineage and existential necessity? Silicon seeds, gluten spillage, genetic point clouds, botanical quantum machinery... each organism — familiar or alien — projects a persona of threat, boundaries, riddles and obsessions.

What indeed forms the blueprint for such a Post-Animal? Appendages thrusting forth, eyes bounded in closure. An organism juxtaposed with machine bits and biosensors, or a living continuum re-imagined on the cusp of technology, ritual and consciousness autonomy? Picture this entity – magnified, hastened with optimism, self-determination, and tantalizing unpredictability, its evolutionary path unfettered and fierce.

Reflect upon the trajectories of a Post-Animal civilization, transcending the cozy veneer of domesticity, bearing the indelible traces of its yearning for the sublime and an alienation interwoven with vulnerabilities simultaneously embodied and beyond the body. Its regime of production and reproduction, the practice of biological materialization teetering on the edge of eco-equilibrium, invoking, repudiating, affecting, and abjecting its meticulous craft of forms, compositions, formulas, algorithms, ceremonies and monstrosities. The feast of the unforeseen.

Mutation — the linguistic vernacular of this civilization and its vast legion of offspring civilizations branching out on the ever-forking paths — cultivates this uncanny nature with audacity and prestige. As the boundaries between narratives and artifacts, beings and meanings grow increasingly porous, we are confronted with a complex fusion of native and synthetic, void and paragon. Mutation transforms from a mere event into an ethos of metaphysical synchronicity, propelled by an outward, open-to-the-cosmos velocity that disrupts the static norms of evolutionary stagnation.



Visualize a society where science is intertwined with the eldritch, spawning diverse breeds of consciousness. A society where machine intelligence is not a detached entity, but a continuum of our own lineage, ushering in an era where life becomes malleable — liberated from the unyielding chains of protocols, monopolies, and hierarchies. Here, life doesn't just regain its agency — it asserts it. Genetic autonomy evolves into a dynamic practice of re-scripting the synthesis of body, material layers, social occurrences, and natural phenomena. Within this milieu, the Post-Animal ceases to be constrained to the simplistic roles of survival and consumption. They contribute to a planetary parable with care, daring and luminescence. Enhanced environmental sentience, advanced magnetic resonance, evolved telepathy, and acute sonic intelligence, coupled with extensive geographical distribution, embed them deeply into the earthling fabric, akin to a supercharged neural network. They transmit early signals of wildfires and broadcast the rumbling earth tremors. They become empathetic caregivers, vigilantly monitoring the well-being of sister species. They trace the tactical military maneuvers for war-ravaged communities and host sonic rituals for the healing circles. Their voices echo the swirling events of the new epoch resonating with an ancient rhythm with precision.

Finally, envision a Post-Animal island along its jagged coastlines, the ebb and flow of waters resonate with the mutable cycle of the colossal swimmers, silent but for the seismic heartbeat echoing through the vast quake. Here, the distinction between Animal and Post-Animal blurs, casting long shadows of promise and indeterminacy into the uncharted currents.

On the maintenance of images

Sol Archer
(United Kindom)

Nothing takes place in Posts Landscapes. Utter stillness reigns. Figures stand apart from one another, and where groups assemble it is only in the middle distance, out of earshot.
Picture a landscape.

A microns-thick smear of powdered precious stone, beetle, blue shells, rare woods, ground down pharaoh. The ground a wash diluted with pressed seeds and distilled resins, sketches a rock face, from rock. Vines tumble, shading a bestiary of half-known beasts, above, a cathedral stands in ruins. Lakes and rivers shimmer into the blue distance between thatchings of vegetation, hazed in endless late summer.

Dutch landscape painting is renowned for its silence and its claim of cartographic realism that belies its ideological and world building instrumentalisation. In the 1600s the Dutch West Indies Company seized half of all the South American territory that was at the time occupied by Europeans, and appointed Johan Maurits van Nassau-Siegen governor of Dutch Brazil, a sugar-state slave colony. Frans Post was one of a number of artists taken by Maurits to Brazil to burnish his enlightenment image as the “Humanist Prince in the Tropics.” Post proceeded to make his career serving Brazil as a tropical fantasy for the Dutch market. Despite painting Brazil, Posts paintings conform rigidly to the pastoralist conventions of 17th century Dutch Landscape and, in fact, were almost all made in Haarlem, near Amsterdam. During a period of rapid re-organisation of land in the Netherlands and extraordinary violence on colonised space, they project a comforting fantasy of pre-modern Holland onto South America. Only faint distant traces suggest the war Post witnessed between Dutch and Portuguese companies along the Brazilian littoral. Many works show the ruined Portuguese cathedral of Olinda, only a few decades old and destroyed by the Calvinists; re-imagined as



an overgrown fragment of European antiquity, conjuring specious ancestrality for the commercial project of colonialism.

The uncannily familiar landscape is ruptured by bricolages of exotica in the foreground. A solitary monkey, an anteater, a sloth, a tapir, tropical birds. A tangled vines, a melon, a cactus spill in while a papaya trees and a palm reach gently over, framing the flat receding vista. Conventions of landscape painting present a compelling model of land as image when imagining ecology. World as spectacle, as assemblage presented to a disembodied eye for consumption. A space which privileges the distant observer, the ocular: a drones eye view abjuring sound, speech, touch, relation, commonality.
Picture yourself a landscape.
Silent.

Delicately the tip of a sable brush, whetted with saliva, lifts dander, pollution, greying spots, yellowing varnish, and fungal bloom from your surface. Skin taut as a drum you resonate as a restorers touch inspects you for flaking, oxidation, encrustation. Custom-made fibres support you in your bed as you’re carried back into darkness to sleep on your rolling frame, your substrate humming faintly in harmony with the dehumidifiers. What resonances of care permeate landscape? What sonic world evades the abstraction of land into landscape and ecosystem into beauty spot? What remains unheard in the non-event of landscape? Do the embodied knowledges of Art and Ecological conservation, the microscopic vibrations beneath attentive touch, resonate with another possibility? As a landscape can you resonate like a drum, vibrate with the conservers brush, the viewers breath, with the motions of life outside your climate controlled basement?

(Un)Folding Time for a Himalayan Mythosphere

Ishita Jain
(India)

The eclectic architecture in Garli, a rural community in Himachal Pradesh, India is a result of neglect folded upon human constraints and aspirations. Over time, this fold has produced a fantastic more-than-human landscape. An environment of more-than-human assemblages, Garli is a unique cultural landscape of conceptual and material juxtapositions of the lower Himalayas, built and wild, layered over the past 250 years. Its now-then is even more entangled with time and landscape. The built has been rewilded as ruins. Through personal narratives and archives, local myths and legends, and hyper-local environmental practices, this artistic research project develops a dialogue between these passages of multiple times.

This project extends *Somadeva*'s project of storytelling – "Kathasaritasagara" or "An Ocean of Stories" imagined as stories beginning from the mountains, becoming multiple different streams, rivers, to flow into the ocean. *Somadeva* was a Kashmiri storyteller from the 11th century, known for his story-within-story structures to hint at the immutablility of narratives, and the distinct immaterialities of narratives to make more narratives. While designed as a profoundly escapist project, *Somadeva*'s "Kathasaritasagara" is also an operating manual of the production of heterogenous worlds. It diagrams the roles of storytellers in the creation and protection of polyphonous environments. These storytellers are spread across multiple interconnected stories devotedly following the birth of the story through its enactment.





For this project, we will meet a very particular story-teller telling stories of other storytellers who sing songs of other storytellers, as she learns how to tell stories of a wonderfully complex site in Garli. We will see how storytellers are figures of resistance, world-making, guardians of memories and proliferators of imagination. Stories of sites give an access to kaleidoscopic presentist life-cycles of the sites – some of which have become traces gently haunting the sites, while others are palpable presences extending into futures to come. Through a series of cinematic-fictioned diagrams that are also preternatural world-images, this project aims to perform this temporology of multiple folding and unfolding narratives across the architectural and vegetal surfaces for the emergence of a more-than-human Himalayan mythosphere.

Waterlogue: Unsteady Subjects

Madison Bycroft
(Australia)

You caught me in the middle of a project. That means I don't know what happens in the end. That means that I should avoid aboutness. That means I need to proceed with an expectation of potential road closures and their replacement detours, or even a rogue narrative. Where am I going? I've been making a film and the way keeps changing. It's crooked, and does not seem to be straightening. Hard to say where it will end up.

I want to share this emptiness with you. Not fill the silence with false notes or put tracks through the void. I want to share this wilderness of failure. The others have built you a highway – fast lanes in both directions. I offer you a journey without direction, uncertainty and no sweet conclusion. (Derek Jarman)

This is not irrelevant to a project that is thinking about measurement, reading and water. The shape of rivers change, for example, coastlines nibble and spit, this ice cube is melting in my hand.

Characters said things, and now they don't, they just murmur like a bubbling brook or low powered fountain. Trickle dribbles. They wear mirrors, so their world glimmers and speaks in fragments, like a mosaiced heroine.

The film sets out to be a sci-fi, but what is Science and what is Fiction when both of these categories become unstable. Nonetheless it borrows from scifi tropes – some future where language becomes fluid, and referents are dislodged from the shapes they have been given. An unstable or edgeless subject could be conceived as ripe SF material, but surely, we know already that it is the stable individual Subject that is a fiction, not the one that wobbles.



Problems arise: What kind of fiction can imagine an otherwise that is already here but unrecognized? What kind of sci fi rehearses the future but does not disavowal its commitment to its complicity in an unrighted now? What kind of montage can bring together scenes that have drifted far apart with the tide? How can I not know something without romanticizing it? And importantly, what role does disco play in all this and what does snow have to say about it?

A problem... presents a charged space of indeterminacy. Such indeterminacy generates the possibility of something profound happening at the level of the micropolitical, the molecular, wherein small tinkerings yield micro-abrasions that dissolve the sedimented regimes structuring our horizons. (Marquis Bey)

An unsteady subject collects and deposits, and is moved by water and histories and nows. It is impure and de-sediments and resediments and moves through time. There is erosion, and there are also deposits, making small new islands with enough space for only my dog. ace

A flounder fish gobbles up the transition between scenes, and what I thought I wanted to say is stuck in a dam upstream. A clock half sunk and sinking to the abyss. Sense flows toward dissolution and the sea.

Intimate Ecologies / Postnatural Assemblages

Ama Josephine Budge Johnstone
(UK/Ghana)

Where does the sensual live within an interdependent Black ecology?

Through what textures, aesthetics and conversations might these Black *Intimate Ecologies* be traced? In what ways has Blackness been removed – severed - through violence; and removed itself - through more subtle violences - from the more-than-human world? Across what geo-spacial and spatio-temporal lines, through which mediums of travel, by what codes of understanding do *Intimate Ecologies* remain present? How may they be found again, bobbing resiliently amidst currents of the speculative, changed but resonant, re-memoried amidst Black and Indigenous cosmologies of the diaspora? And why this urgent seeking, longing, tracing of *Intimate Ecologies* now? Why this insistent return to pleasure, within contexts of climate colonialism, when the queer worldbuilding project of striving towards Black interdependent, interspecies futures has never been more precarious, or more necessary?

These are some of the questions my research, *Intimate Ecologies: Queer Speculations on Pleasure, Blackness and Decolonial Aesthetics,* seeks to address; to propose, to invoke and to bring into intra-disciplinary conversation with the ancestors – both living and present elsewhere; with more-than-human kin; and with the artists and arts practices which first aestheticized a truth my body remembered, but my tongue had been taught to forget.

That which I have termed *Intimate Ecologies* are a mode of understandings one's existence as both interconnected to and co-dependant on the more-than-human (earth, fungi, plants, animals, insects, bodies of water, bodies of weather, bodies of gas) which one regards as kin, as lover; whose thrivation is an extension of our own autonomous orgasm, of one's own breath. *Intimate Ecologies*



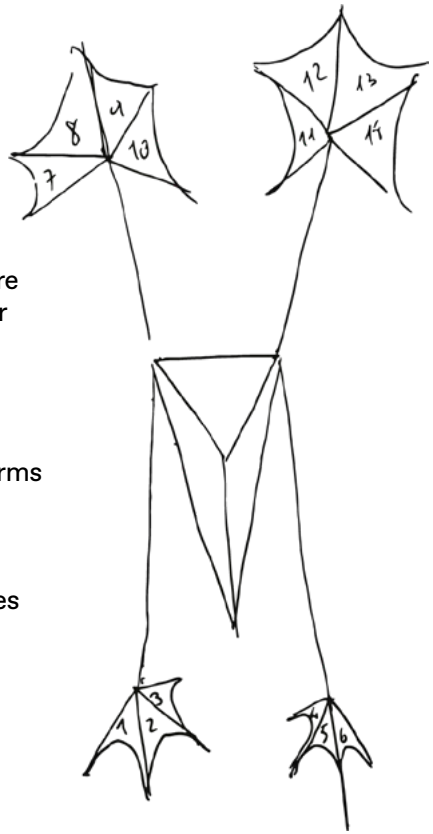
can be understood as a form of relation acknowledging stewardship, interdependence and intimately intertwined modes of becoming-with the non-human. *Intimate Ecologies* are in direct opposition to colonial capitalist economies of extraction, individualism, and anthropocentric domination.

Within an ontology of *Intimate Ecologies,* we - humans(?) are in constant transformation, co-creating an ecology in which we are becoming-with, intimately, sensually, pleasurably, not because we have to in order to survive, but because we *desire to*, in order to truly live. Over the past six months, with my juicily cacophonic, fermenting PIPian peers, I have been pondering the question of postnature.

What futures become possible when we let go of our obsession with that which has been conceptualized, fetishised, denigrated sanctified, Othered as nature? What Black queer, ecopoetics surface through murky waters of unknowing. Tides that thrive in the unknown. Waters reflecting cosmos that understand that intimacy emerges not through dissection, but through the not-knowing. We have been trying to not-know together. To feel our tentacular way through many We's, and I's, and uncertainties, and misgivings, and missed voices, and missed turnings. We have been growing a collective body of unknown objects. A postnatural assemblage with which to traverse these un-Othering futures. It is not yet here: this body, this future. But I think, perhaps, it is cumming...

AXECIDYR

Diogo da Cruz
(Portugal)



Sunken bodies

As they encounter the ocean
They reencounter the origins of life

As human's greed takes their life up here
They find other ways to live in the water

They never meet the bottom
Their components disperse

Their matter is now alive in other life forms
Powerful life forms
Creating storms and uprisings

Shifting currents and penetrating bodies
As we drink, as we sweat, as we swim
As we breath
We become carriers

Bodies thrown underwater then
Bodies thrown underwater now

And the seas forget nothing
They hold everything
everything is now

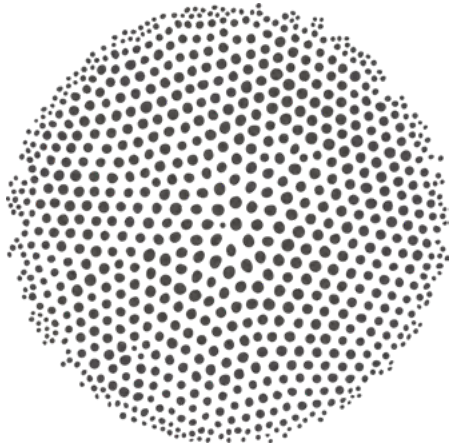
Until the time we cannot breath in land
When we slowly move back to the water
Back to the origin
On a wet travel to extinction

You don't know
What lays

Beyond the abyss
By exploiting the depths
One brings to the surface
Those memories
Those bodies

Hold your breath
And keep your lungs full

of water



AXECIDYR is a sci-fi narrative about an underwater civilisation, developed along sculptures and sound performances. Through a close dialogue with the sound artist Fallon Mayanja on the memory of colonial crimes and the unsustainable extraction of natural resources, we explore the power of mythology and its potential to reactivate and reinvent histories and geographical space.

18:34:21
From Lindertje Mans :
Does anyone have an answer to that (maybe old or moralistic) question “do the plants consent to it” because it came to my mind too, Clara I think you said something about it last week

18:36:15
From Korallia Stergides :
the ants too! Feral practice did a interesting work like that with the ants

18:36:32
From Clara Benito (she/they) :
Yeah! What I said is that the fact that questions about plant’s consent only appear when sex seem to be involved makes me think that it has more to do with a concern over normativity in sexuality than with plants wellbeing

18:37:11
From Clara Benito (she/they) :
Everything we do with plants is non-reciprocal

18:37:20
From Lindertje Mans :
Mmm that’s interesting

18:37:22
From Aliaskar Abarkas :
vulgar vibe

18:38:2
From Matteo Guarnnacia (he/him):
@clara, not event taking care?

18:38:44
From Clara Benito (she/they) :
At least I have never ever in my life asked a plant for consent

18:38:48
From Caroline Ward :
There is some mutual benefit between humans and wheat evolution

18:39:00
From Andrea Lumplecker :
That’s an interesting point Clara about normativity in sexuality here

18:41:28
From Ama Josephine (she/her) :
But I think that queer sexuality/sensuality becomes an opportunity to think about consent differently

18:41:50
From Clara Benito (she/they) :
Replying to “@clara, not event ta...”
Because I don’t think my plants asked to be grown and separated into pots and sold. And bc sometimes I overwater and sometimes I forget to water, and sometimes I cut them, etc

18:41:54
From Ama Josephine (she/her) :
Whereas deforestation (mass, commercial deforestation) offers very little space to consider or discuss consent.

18:42:31
From sol archer :
Also, we are discussing this work, not comparing it with a work that proposes cutting down trees as a mode of radical connection

18:42:45
From sol archer :
To me its a bit of a straw man argument

18:43:00
From Clara Benito (she/they) :
Replying to “@clara, not event ta...”
But I think that queer sexuality/sensuality becomes an opportunity to think about consent differently

Absolutely, and I really like your point before. I think both arguments can coexist right?

05
Performativity and body

Lindertje Mans
Korallia Stergides
Maite Rodríguez

Performativity and body

Physical bodies
Emotional bodies
Mythical bodies
Bodies amongst bodies
Group bodies
Dismembered bodies
Orphan bodies
Escaping bodies
Speculative bodies
Absent bodies
Optional bodies
Disappeared bodies
Amputated bodies
Collective bodies
Symbiotic bodies
Absent bodies
Disappeared bodies
Amputated bodies
Collective bodies
Auditive bodies
Phantom bodies
Rested bodies
Hybrid bodies
Dressed up bodies
Cold bodies
Sleeping bodies
Fired up bodies
Facultative bodies
Marginalised bodies
Silenced bodies
Removed bodies
Killed bodies
Killing bodies
Invisibilized bodies
Aging bodies
Aching bodies
Invisibilized bodies
Peripheralized bodies
Incarcerated bodies
More than human bodies
Fluid bodies
Radial bodies
Leaking bodies
Open bodies
Social bodies
Missing bodies in this text/conversation
Vulnerable bodies
Present bodies
Silenced bodies
Warm bodies
Queer bodies

Invitations towards embodied experience

1. Go sit on your hands and feet. Spend 20 minutes on hands and feet. What do you see? What do you hear? What do you feel?
2. Go outside and let your body be moved by the wind. How does it feel? Where does it touch your skin? Where does your body move? How does your body move?
3. Spend 15 minutes on one leg.
4. Eat your breakfast without using your hands
5. Lick a lovers face.
6. Hold ice.
7. Spend time under water.
8. Sit near a fire
9. Follow a colony of ants
10. Smell a tree for 18 minutes.
11. Listen to a chicken
12. Touch a rosebud.
13. Put your ear on the floor. Listen to the floor.
14. Read todays news upside down
15. Do you miss someone? Where in your body do you feel it? Touch that part.
16. Do you feel love? Where?
17. Spend 10 minutes looking at the sky
18. Lift your arms and fly away.
19. Breathe out and disappear.

Does that mean that everything else that isn't non-human, is human?
Does a body define the limit between the individual and the world?
The skin as a limit?
To have/to be/to carry a body
Do you have a body or is the body what you are?
Can you have a body sometimes, and sometimes not?
To lend one's body to become a multibodied creature
Do we share the same guts? Do we share the same viscera?

Becoming chicken
– Lindertje Mans

Embodyment exercise
Done in groups or individually
Inside or outside
In the presence, or without the presence of chicken
The meditative part can be done in 10 minutes.
To complete the full excersise, at least 30 minutes are recommended.
Have one person read out the instructions. Take your time.

Find a place
Shake
Relax
Breathe
Calm down

Move to the ground
Lay down
Close your eyes
Breathe

Breathe in
And out

And with every outbreath, you feel your body shrinking
Shrink
Shrink
Until you have a compact body
A football
You have a compact body
Your chest is big
Your feet are small
Your arms are short
Your arms are wings
You're like a chicken

Now imagine the hairs on your body growing harder, pens sticking out of your skin, with soft hairs on the side of the pens
Imagine your skin covered in feathers

Your mouth is a beak
Your butt is a cloaca
You have pink feet
Eyes at the side of your head
Your ears are tiny feathered holes
You're a chicken
Breathe

Keep your eyes closed
And slowly, try to find a way to move and sit or lay with your head about 30 centimeters above the floor

Focus on the tiny feathered holes that are your ears
Because you have no auricle, you have to move your ears towards the sound that you want to focus on

What do you hear?
Explore

Now focus on your eyes
Your eyes are on the side of your head, and have an almost 360 degree vision
But you can't move your eyes separate from your head
If you want to turn your eyes, you have to turn your head



Now open your eyes
Move your head, look around
See

If you want: move
Explore the space
Move your feathered body any way you want, but stay close to the floor, you can jump, but you can't fly, you're 30 cm tall
Explore

If you want to see something up close: look with one eye first, then move your head and look at with the other
Explore

What do you see?

What do you feel?

If you want:
Feel your peers
You are a group animal
You prefer to be around your peers

If you want,
you can make a sound
You have small vocal chords and a beak

Make a sound
Explore
Explore

Now, slowly
Become silent
Find your way back to the ground
Breathe

With every inhale you grow bigger
With every exhale you lose more feathers
Breathe
Expand

Come back to your human body
Open your eyes

Cold practice
– Maite Rodríguez

COLD PRACTICE #1 :
Máquina de agua
humana: baba
colectiva.

A chunk of frozen water (ice) is placed on the ground. A couple of bodies surround the chunk in the smallest circle possible. Each surrounder body holds a cube of frozen water (ice) inside it's mouth. Mouths stay open. Heads get together (head against head), mouths pointed to the chunk in the ground. Bodies start the drooling machine.

Baba is at the limit of pornographic/sexual dessire and undesirableness (in the name of all the bestial,hidden, undesired droolings kept in the dark of pristine looking bodies).
Baba es el lugar del sexo, de lo chancho, de la deglución, del primer contacto.
Me,the ice,and baba are a body.
My baba is all I can offer since I cannot force anybody's anger.
Who can afford to stay desirable in a crisis? Baba is culpa acumulada.
Baba también es líquido de placer.
Baba is pleasure liquid. Baba es siesta. Baba es lubricante. Baba es alimentación. Baba es deseo.
Meter el deseo en esto.
Baba es afecto. Baba is alive. Baba es donde pensamiento se hace líquido



y se fuga. Baba is where we meet.
Si una baba invirgen riega la tierra virgen ¿se convertirá en una tierra emputecida? ¿desvirginizada?
Baba is agua humana subterránea condensed in an oral performativity of negotiations.
Baba is the negotiating organ.
Baba melts an ice, ice melts cells, cells melt body, body melts baba. How to pervert a machine with a couple of frozen salival glands: volviéndola una MÁQUINA BABEANTE. Babeadora? A drooler? Ice is the place where Baba rehearses its desires. Baba is a specific type of saliva. Baba is saliva that spent too much time in the limbo of "not inside-inside neither yet outside-outside". Baba is saliva that became stuck. If baba were to contain more water, it would become saliva again.

COLD PRACTICE #2:
Cadena de sostén.

1
Two human bodies hold a body of ice with their hands, and stay there until the limit "coldness-pleasure-pain" appears. When the limit becomes apparent, a previously set word is pronounced (the first time we agreed on "burn"). When the word is voiced, some other human body will come in to take the holding place of the body who recognized its limit. Bodies remain in a holding chain until it seems like enough time has gone by.

2
With frozen hands, the next question is asked: is there any other part of the body that is now asking to feel coldness against skin? Con las manos congeladas preguntar : ¿Hay alguna otra parte del cuerpo que esté pidiendo sentir el frío contra la piel?

Ama said she wanted it in her chest, and we held the freezing cold body together, chest to chest.
Kosmas wanted it in their tounge.
Kosmas lo quiso en la lengua.
Aliaskar lo quiso en la cabeza.
Aliaskar asked to feel it on their head.
Andrea wanted it on the side of their face/neck. Andrea lo quiso en el lateral del cuello/cara.



Raju lo quiso en el antebrazo. Raju held it on his forearm.
I also wanted to try the head. Yo lo quise en la cabeza.

3
All the human bodies involved in the holding chain take the frozen body in their hands, elevate it and then shatter it against the ground. Action is repeated a few times. Chunks that remain unshattered are gifted to a nearby tree.

Performing Bud (2023) – Korallia Stergides

Regents Park Rose Gardens

Your childhood park, that is where your mum would take you for walks,

You visit to be closer to your mother.

No dogs are allowed - but in bending over to smell the rose that is not meant to be touched,

You are your mum's dog.

1. You visit Regents Park Rose Gardens and you read the name of the Rose in front of you.

'*You're Beautiful'* She says.

The Rose compliments you.

2. You read the name of the Rose in front of you.

'You're Beautiful' You say.

You give yourself a compliment.

3. You bend over to the rose and tuck your nose gently inside it so as not to break it.

'You're Beautiful' You say.

You return the compliment.

4. You cup the rose carefully from behind, with its stem between your index and middle finger and stroke your cheek lightly across its petals.

'You're Beautiful' She says.

Your Mother compliments you both.

5. You are met by a passer by who stops to look at the same rose.

'You're Beautiful' They say.

You accept a passing compliment as they continue walking.

6. You sit on a bench and watch everyone pass by the same rose.

'You're Beautiful' They say.

You visit the compliments.

CHICKS IN DIALOGUE

Lindertje Mans
(Netherlands)

Kik kik kik kik kik kik

Kikuk Kikuk Pok pok

Kikuk

Kuk kuk kuk. Khak

Kihuk. Huk

Wakka kaha kahakak

Kuk

Wakka kaha kahakak

Hak hak hak hak

Huak hak hak hak hak

(hak hak)

(hak hak)

Huak hak hak hak hak

Hak hak hak hak hak hak hak hak pkaaaah hak hak hak hak
Hak hak hak hak hak pkaaah hak hak hak pkaah hak hak hak hak

POK POK POK POK POK HAK HAk

Hak hak

A onewoman poultry-pop-opera on looking twice, having eggs, free range living and the perks of feather jackets. 60% of the birds on Earth right now, are chicken. Time to take a closer look.

I want to explore if I can start a dialogue with an animal that has always surrounded me, growing up on the countryside: the chicken.

I feel familiarity with the chicken in so many ways: We are (perceived as) female. People sometimes laugh about us and underestimate us. We are seen as objects. People call us “chicks”. There is an industry built around our fertility.

Teaming up with the chicken in exploring our position might be feminist statement. Are we part of a multi-species sisterhood?

Questions I would like to explore are:
-What language does the chicken speak? Can I speak it too? And does she speak my language?
-What is the musicality and tonality of chicken language?
-What is it like to have a chicken body? How does she walk, feel, see? What is it like when your legs are sort of up to your shoulders. When your eyes are at the side of your head? What does a cloaca feel like? And talking and eating through a beak?
-What is the relation of the chicken to her eggs?
-What does the chicken think of me? Am I her sister?
-Does she hate me because I am part of the species that enslaves her?
-What would be healing to her?
-What does she dream?
-Can I transform into the chicken?

Goal is to be working towards a sense-stimulating musical and physical performance that involves me starting of as human, in human language, and ending as chicken, in chicken language. As part of my research I’m going to be spending a lot of time with chicken, learning, looking, listening.

During the PIP sessions I started developing a possible additional program for the performance: chicken embodiment sessions. In these workshops all participants practice in becoming chicken: starting with guided meditations and ending with physical and vocal practice.

Bud (2023)

Korallia Stergides
(Bulgarian/Greek-Cypriot)

I heard a heart beat bud,
I heard a heart beat under water and I thought I was with another bud,
But it was mine.
Mums first bud,
First buddy,
A rose,
Between your legs
Oil
your neck,
A sunflower
Sunflowers face eachother when they dont have the sun to see,
Mmmmmmummmmmy
First buddy,
A rose
twisted in your legs,
On your neck,
My forehead,
Facing in - I'm facing in to your face,
And when does baby face out,
And when does baby face out.
Im on your back,
Im on your back
And Im holding you,
Your fleece chest,
My hands are holding on to you.
Your everything,
Your my body,
Your carrying me,
Penguin Legs
Im on your back on your chest on your neck,
And with every inhalation I take one step,
And with every exhalation I take another,
So that with every breathe toward the floor,
We move together,
Forward.
Im on your back on your chest on your neck,
Embraced,
And my fingers are light on your fleece vest and I try to hold further your waist chest,
Embraced,

We pace further as you breathe toward the floor,
Im on your back on your chest on your neck,
And in order for us to move together we must both breathe toward the floor toward eachother,
I feel a tilt in your lower back,
Sometimes I feel bad bud because I don't want a baby yet,
Sometimes I feel bud
But I know I want my mum
Bud i know i want my mum
I know i want to be, on her back
Embraced in mum.
I know i want to be, on her back,
Embraced in mum.
Embraced in mum.
On her back
Embraced in mum.
Sometimes I feel bud,
But I know I want my mum
Bud i know i want my mum
I know i want to be,
On her back,
Embraced in mum.

Embraced in mum.

I need to find a way of being on my Mum's back,
Find a way of being on my mums back without reenacting with another,
Bud,
Im on my own.
Being with another heart bud,
Will replace the essence of being carried by my mum,
But am I moving away from being carried by my mum?
Bud im moving away from being carried by my mum.
If I'd ask anyone to carry me like my mum that would mean a requirement for life,
But in trying to do this alone,
Maybe I make a bigger mother.

Feels strange wanting this bud,
When I really just want my mum - not a baby,
Watching mums with babies makes me want my bud - my Mum,
Embraced in Mum.
I heard a heart beat bud,
I heard a heart beat under water and I thought I was with another bud,
Bud
But it was mine.
Mums first bud,
Rose bed's
Lets sleep toward the back of our heads - She said:
Your Beautiful
The only way to be closer to my bud is to walk Regent's Park Rose gardens at 10.30 AM when everyone is,
A rose
Lips and nose
My forehead fits between your lips and nose
How do you like to be held? -She said:
Your Beautiful
In the center of your palm then i'm not squeezed,
I can lay there unimpressed,
A rose
Bud, im Unimpressed.
A bud,
A human being,
A closed grip tight bud
For you, I'm a bud
For you, a juvenile flower
Im not ready yet bud
Bud im waiting to bud, not ready yet for love but,
A rose in a cup, he called me a human bean,
Bud for you im
Bud.

Fluidic invocations / Invocaciones fluídicas

Maite Rodríguez
(Uruguay)

The immediate sensation upon coming into contact with ice is a strong cold feeling on the skin.Then comes vasoconstriction: narrowing of blood vessels in the skin. Continued contact can lead to numbness in the area through the temporary interruption or reduction of the transmission of sensory signals. Frostbite occurs when the cold temperature causes water inside cells to freeze and crystallize, leading to cell death. Coldness, as a physical sensation, could become a technology to disrupt our normative sense of comfort and embodied "human aliveness".

Coldness functions as an escape towards other organismic imaginations, accessing other possible bodies; mutilations, detachments, beastly invocations, drooling, dismemberments, shudders, elongated throats and elongated desires. Opening up disconfigured/disoriented humanities to the environment. Experimenting with ways of being this body and other bodies. Experimenting with ways of being this beast and other beasts. Opening hidden organs like escape glands. Becoming a machinic body of coldness and dripping water. Practicing to surround the cold, to lick it, to fill it with guilt and desires; to ritualize around a frozen body that turns everything it touches into unfamiliar thresholds. To invent an intimate collective drooling. To suspend normality. To escape the cold from within. To quit this performance.

Coldness is reimagined as a catalyst for deconstruction and reconfiguration, enabling a departure from the constraints of normative existence and preconceived notions of selfhood. Ultimately, this investigation serves as a call to embrace the power of coldness and melting as technologies of unraveling deeply ingrained patterns of domination and power, encouraging new possibilities for non-hierarchical paradigms, embracing fluidity towards an emergence of new relationalities and liminalities.

Group chat 6 — Ses. #15 27.03.2023
(In this session we all became anonymous by using dots)

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:45 PM):
No, they are smooth on my body
Not too big
How big are you
You to Everyone (Mar 20, 2023, 8:45 PM)
How small is your body

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:45 PM):
It's tiny

You to Everyone (Mar 20, 2023, 8:45 PM)
I could be carried by a human

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:45 PM):
Me too :) but I would fly away

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:45 PM):
I don't fly

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:45 PM):
Are you soft and cuddly?
You to Everyone (Mar 20, 2023, 8:46 PM)
I have hooves they are the hardest thing about me
Im soft

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:46 PM):
What is hooves

You to Everyone (Mar 20, 2023, 8:46 PM)
but cuddle gently

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:46 PM):
Have to look it up
Got it!

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:46 PM)
Did you get to the field in the day or night

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:46 PM):
How can you be tiny and have hooves

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:47 PM):
Im not a horse

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:47 PM)
Hm
I prefer light

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:47 PM):
Yes I was in the light too

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:47 PM):
I sing in the mornings

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:47 PM):
The sudden night was shocking to my image
Are you a crow
or blackbird

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:47 PM):
Yes, also because I felt helpless without skin
So I'm glad I have feathers now

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:48 PM):
I was all dewy without skin

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:48 PM):
Blackbird

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:48 PM):
I found it hard to take on the body of an animal

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:48 PM):
Me too

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:48 PM):
I have spent a long time imagining myself as
animal in full acceptance of my human body

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:48 PM):
Did you completely merge into the animal?

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:49 PM):
well I think I keep changing

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:49 PM):
like when you have to look at something twice

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:49 PM):
Hm - I'm completely dissolved into the blackbird,
only kept my arms

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:49 PM):
my mother sees me as a fawn but I dont
so to see myself in the body of a fawn I have to
see through her eyes
what do you do with your arms when you fly
they must be heavy
how do you fly?

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:50 PM):
Not at all. I can hug …
Other birds, I'm not sure

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:50 PM):
so you hug other birds to fly
you hold onto them?

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:51 PM):
Haha no I don't know, arms were still important
I try to imagine you as fawn but also not

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:51 PM):
So you'd like to fly

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 8:51 PM):
DO you still feel human?
I was thinking of singing more than flying …
I like to sing (Mar 20, 2023, 8:51 PM)
Not anymore (Mar 20, 2023, 8:51 PM)
Im fully fawn (Mar 20, 2023, 8:51 PM)

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 6:48 PM):
who is your hybrid self

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023, 6:48 PM):
ooh

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023,6:48 PM):
my hybrid self is a hunter sphynx

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023,6:49 PM)
i am fish without a human face

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023,6:49 PM):
wow. your reminds me of a siren but with no
identity
ahahah cool

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023,6:49 PM):
exactly, my face will appear and disappear in
different moments
where do you live

. to Everyone
(Mar 20, 2023,6:50 PM)
i live in the tropics. not sure where. might be
the tropics of another planet
you?

06
Phonocene and ecologies of listening

Kosmas Phan Dinh
Andrea Lumplecker
Caroline Ward
V for 5
Lisa Mazenauer
Natalia Trejbalova

Phonocene – ecologies beyond listening



A bristling, feathery tree crossing animates as energetic trills, pips, cackles and caws.
'*Yiiyiiiii*' - '*iiiiyyiiii*' - *'tut-tut-tut*'
Connected by sonic undercurrents, atmospheres, energy flows,
The earth murmurs the effervescent, calming bubbling of a river's flow.
Two mopeds are run aground, stuck in the river bed and become an unlikely harbour for gelatinous spawn
Tails swish, reeds bend, water breaks over pebbles, ripples follow.
The water's edge, absorbs the cusp of this flow, pushing it back out.
Interrupting, a low, mechanical hummmm of an electric pylon.
'*Clanggg*' - a slow, disyncopated drum, resonates, a party starting.
The cacophony of this territory folds and unfolds,'*Clanggg*', '*cawwww*', '*Yiiyiiiii*', uncomfortable, yet together
A bike draws across a bridge, pedals '*clack, clack, clack*', wheels clunk.
Enveloping, soothing, calming sounds. spa reminiscence.
As I extend my hearing, it glides along different gurgles and bubbling textures. Spatial localization of distinct sounds at first seems hard in this sonic thickness. But occasionally my hearing grabs a sound that pierces through. High pitches from distant to near: wind chimes and bird songs in the distance, river rumbling, sucking infrastructure sounds, the clatter of cutlery, fish feeder operated by kids, excited voices,

These are my learnings
from River.
Who speaks with many
sounds and speaks through
silence.
River, is the water flowing
and the
Many lives which form
around ripples and flows.
Rocks that love to get wet,
mosquitos,

fɹɛndz bɹɪdʒ
River Lea, Hackney
2030 BST
Location: https://goo.gl/maps/BP5FKH91Qym-McZCF7?coh=178571&entry=tt

Greens who love swimming,
birds that love drinking
And river temperatures and
flowing river sounds,
Moist soil, moss, lichen. They
are part of River.
Sitted on rivers territory, I am
a guest
Listening is what I can do
best,

Sans holding attachment to
learned ways of learning,
That human ways of speak-
ing,
Make sense best,
I let myself hear
Beyond identity and identi-
fication.
Hearing
As if for the first time.
Hearing

trout farm Zordel
(by the Enz Stream)
13:00 30.05.
Location: https://goo.gl/maps/YzXDuQVCPus-b1uPe7

River speaks:
birds
sdrib
dribs
brdis
bicrds
biarrciadss
iarbadcsr
briacrs
cars
scari
striffarcs
fatrifi
traffic
fiarf
ff
ftit
tit
tiaterw
itwatre

sudden splash of startled trout, calm conversations, sudden splash, ripple of narrow water channel, pencil on notebook, own breathing.
The whirling soup of watery sounds lays like a blanket on me, soothing, but at the same time covering up.
Let the sounds penetrate you. Invite them.
Closing my eyes, sinking into, sinking into, wooshhh, getting soaked into sharp intimacy with the aqueous rhythms. But it is not the river. Instead steady flows of the freshwater delivery tubes, steady suction of precisely measured amounts of cold, oxygen rich mountainwater.
Now amplify your listening. Follow the infrastructure into the trout ponds. Listen to its soupy time, to slow growth in cold water, listen to repetitive rhythms unfolding in 4,5m².
Recite with me ~ drip drip drop ~ Leave your stifled hearing and start growing into the aqueous sensitivity of your whole fishy body. Begin by the ears as they start to pick up sound from the water more distinctively, allowing you to hear frequencies far outside the human hearing range. Now notice the two lateral lines along the sides of your body, picking up vibrations, currents and sounds. Use the porosity of this mucus filled tube to locate the sonic events around you. The waters are your ally - while swimming, you push a water column in front of you that aids your sensing. If it hits an obstacle, a pressure wave is thrown back and informs your lateral line organ. This is how you swarm, how you are in perfect synchrony with the bodies of water around you, this is how you are many in this amniotic sea where past and future bodies also swim through you.
Your movements align with the ripples and tides and you sense deep into the hydrological cycles. As my hearing moves from freshwater into a saltier milieu I start to contemplate my own positionality, the histories of the sonic colonialities I am embedded in through my western education. How I listen is never neutral, how I record is never neutral I think as the water temperature around me slowly starts to warm.

I haven't swum in these waters and they are different.
You swim far, you rest, you listen, you let your listening rest on the difference. You try to listen from your whole heart to the confluence. Because the current ist still flowing. Because engaging in dialogue with the river begins with some conversations you can't ignore. Like the big elephant in the room, the river asks you to think about its positionality.
Li An Phoa says that 'a sign of a healthy economy should be a drinkable river', when in dialogue, the river asks you what you think.
To listen to the river without opening your heart to all the ways the river can speak to you is to practise colonial ways of listening.
If listening to the river is meant to be a peaceful meditation, then I am distraught by all the questions the river evokes in me.
Questions on land, questions on erasure, questions on government and questions on self.
Yet still, the peace I find is not my own but a reflection of how the river continues to flow, despite.
Despite the plastics, despite the pollution from cars on the nearby road, despite the neglect by the custodians of this public land; the river can still flow.
Same way, I can exist against.
I'm fortunate the river in my city is many rivers
the river the old river the new river the river canal
I'm choosing the river canal for this listening
river sounds like nature
river canal is post nature right?
listening to the river sounds like a spiritual exercise
I'm deeply in need for spirits
the river will calm me down listening will calm me down
I never swam in the river canal
some people do, they say it's not deep
it looks deep to me and I want to listen deeply
(can't you listen deeply everywhere?)
I expect to hear: water, birds, ducks, people, bikes,
I hear: cars, cars, cars. once in a while: human voice
then: human voice on a bike (it must be on a bike, it

water
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truck
truwck
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wind
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Nairobi river, locally known
as amazon, arboretum drive
Time: 17:44 EAT
Location: https://goo.gl/maps/BPpWkjZ1NxyJN-MYh9

wind
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mi'
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I'g minoglot ehti revr
I'm going throet river
I'm going to the river
to listen

Ecublens, Sorge
Time: 12:35 / 31.05
46°32'24.8"N 6°34'09.4"E

going to the river sounds
like a promise to me
time out, time off from
alltagsnoise
I can hear it on my way
already
the promise
(the river?)

passes fast)
a dog, barking, a bird, children's voices, cars, cars
I don't hear: water
I close my eyes
I hear the wind (or do I hear my clothes being moved by the wind?)
I smell the water (it's not bad, this is a nice river canal)
I hear music from a boom box
I hear something unidentifiable, over and over
I like abstract sounds
opening my eyes, the unidentifiable sounds are spray cans being shaken
the river canal is the paradise for sprayers
(waiting for the sound of spraying now)
how much can we turn off thinking when listening?
will we ever be able to listen without thinking?
spray cans spraying now, sprayers are talking while spraying, then shaking again
I like the rhythm
better than the rhythm from the cars
my thoughts were getting away from the river (into arts)
I'm trying to concentrate on my river listening
which I still expect to be the sound of water
(I try to focus)
but it's not
it takes some time before I realise
and hear
the river canal's silence
it's underneath everything else
or above
it's this big void (50 metres wide) in the middle of the city
that calms the city in the middle of everything else
right when I leave
the silent water becomes loud
I can hear it now! it needed a ship to move it
water, like wind needs someone/something else to make it hearable
I prefer its silence
though

Cartographies of Confluence

Kosmas Phan Dinh
(Germany)

Cartographies of Confluence is an ongoing sonic research and a series of mediation formats of the river Enz. The project seeks out the agentic rhythms of the stream while also attending the margins of the audible, the barely heard, the ghosts and noises that are in confluence with the stream. The approach employs field recording as a mode of intimacy with the river, beyond romanticizing gestures that further images of a pristine and pre-colonial nature. Sounds that are related to the image of aquatic cleansing – which is imposed on the waters of the northern black forest through the countless healing fountains and bottled water brands as well as an extensive self care and spa culture – are dissolved in the sonic memories and hauntings that trace a more complex and dispersed body of water. Sounds of solvent-polluted aquifers leaking into records from the soupy strata of the high moor of Kaltenbronn and harden against the thuds and drones of frozen meat logistics.

The research also informs a series of formats in which listeners are related to remedies and toxins, infrastructures of contamination, rejuvenation and other porosities. Starting by our own leaky bodies, the activations invite into a collective deceleration towards intimacy with the (wounded) rhythms of the stream. This space of lying down together and attuning through field recordings of the river with its past and future remnants, as well as contemporary aquatic ambient textures, proposes collective rest and deep listening as a disruptive strategy. The format also provides a milieu for cross contamination with collaborators and at times employs multisensorial activations in response to the surroundings.





Compost care, compost sounds, deep listening, deep learning

Andrea Lumplecker
(Austria)

The chthonic ones are not confined to a vanished past. They are a buzzing, stinging, sucking swarm now, and human beings are not in a separate compost pile. We are humus, not Homo, not anthropos; we are compost, not posthuman.[1]

Deep Listening is a life long practice. The more I listen the more I learn to listen. Deep Listening involves going below the surface of what is heard, expanding to the whole field of sound while finding focus. This is the way to connect with the acoustic environment, all that inhabits it, and all that there is.[2]

We are of the Earth, in our Diversity.[3]

The *compost group of Klasse für Alle*[4] at the University of Applied Arts Vienna meets Friday afternoons in the courtyard of the main building to gather around a compost heap. Composting is a ritual and practice, and a metaphor for all life processes. By learning to recognize nutrient cycles and through practices of repair and care, composting gives meaning to everyday waste. While soil organisms and oxygen are not the only ones to help create humus, the group's conversations and friendships advance in shared experiences that will later be scattered in their social terrains. A diversity of knowledge-exchange, human with more-than human encounters are created through non-hierarchical forms of learning. A current attempt at embodied learning is to listen consciously and deeply – to our environment (in and around the compost heap) but also to what is below the surface.[5] Deep listening, like touching (soil) means *re-enchanting the world.*[6]





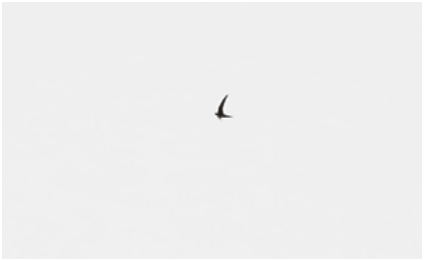




[1] Donna Haraway, Staying with the Trouble. Making Kin in the Chthulucene.
[2] Pauline Oliveros, Quantum Listening: From Practice to Theory (To Practice Practice)
[3] Vandana Shiva: Growing Gardens of Diversity
[4] www.klassefueralle.uni-ak.ac.at
[5] In a workshop with and under the direction of Viennese musician Paul Ebhart, participants of the compost group combined their own field and compost recordings to create a compost sound collage: www.soundcloud.com/compost-group
[6] Silvia Federici, Re-enchanting the World: Technology, the Body, and the Construction of the Commons

Radiant Territories

Caroline Ward
(United Kingdom)







Ever-changing climates give rise to novel ecologies and landscapes, as evident in the transformative effects on bird migration patterns. This speculative work focuses on the affected areas directly altering the course of bird migration pathways that produce fragmented more-than-human landscapes. As ecological systems evolve, migratory birds, along with other species, respond by modifying age-old routes and undergoing physical adaptations, seeking out new sources of sustenance, water, and shelter, whilst also potentially changing their intended destinations.

The work comprises two interconnected parts: human communication with birds, and intervening in the infrastructure of fragmented landscapes to offer alternative routes for migratory birds. Foregrounding the potential for new becomings and rituals, like an invitation, it offers up a refrain, an opening of human territory towards stable coexistence with birds.

Inculcating listening as a form of radical care, and recognising that listening is also a form of knowing, this multidimensional experience acknowledges its inherent epistemic potential through sensing. It builds on the premise that cooperative actions between birds and humans can reshape landscapes for sustaining coexistence.

The project charts migrating birds, through field notes, audio and film, and talking to bird migration experts, and then considers ways to vocalise sounding moments composed for human voice that responds to different registers, temporalities and spatial dynamics along a changing migratory route. Here the vocalisation will initially create an opening or rupture that produces a stable zone within which new connections, movements and possibilities unfold. Through repetition and rhythmic practice, this human activity, creates the possibility of stopping points for migratory birds on their journeys, challenging an established order, opening up new territories, with a sense of stability and mutual belonging.

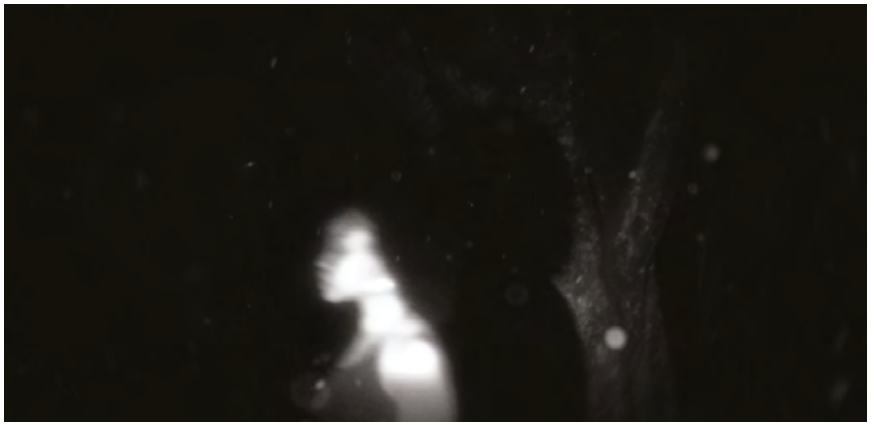
Beyond nature

v for 5
(Kenya)

My listening practice extends beyond what I can hear. It intricateley occurs in the heartspace. Understanding through intuition rather than ego based projections of non-human life. There has been an erasure of my ancestral past, of which, myth and object remain. Of these myths, the might of the *mugumo** tree and the spirit of the drum-*ngoma***, hold special relevance to me. It is through ngoma that I can produce with scarce musical knowledge and it is beings like the mugumo that my collaborator and I invoke in our electronic band, The Jehovas.

The erasure of ancestral names and legacies through the brutalism of colonialism informs Nairobi's postnatural landscape. I often wonder what the land felt like before this emotional, intellectual and physical violent time. Back when there were more streams and the elephants were larger, in the times of the *nyawawa****; beyond nature. In ceremony, drums were used to induce transcendental states for communication between human and more than human life. Ngoma flows through me when I produce. Using a digital audio workstation (DAW) enables me to produce through my intuition. Having not played any musical instrument beyond childhood, my DAW allows me to use multiple instruments without any proficiency on how these instruments are played. My digital library is huge and through it, I can build multiple soundscapes and bring listeners into sonic worlds. As I catch a song and weave it through MIDI tracks, I am in direct ceremony with my ancestors.

The Jehovas debut album, 'Love Created Death', creates a speculative postnatural landscape through sound. We are producing a sonic fiction with solarpunk themes. In this narrative, the world ends for a group of more than humans after a volcanic eruption. Eons later, life begins to sprout from the earth. The songs in the album are pieces of





sonic lore from this world. Lyrically, fire is mentioned as a method of remembering the death that formed them. Horns and strings are frequently used in production to evoke the sense of pride and royalty that the more than humans have. The sun is also a recurring motif, through its ancient age it remembers all that occurred before the volcanic eruption.

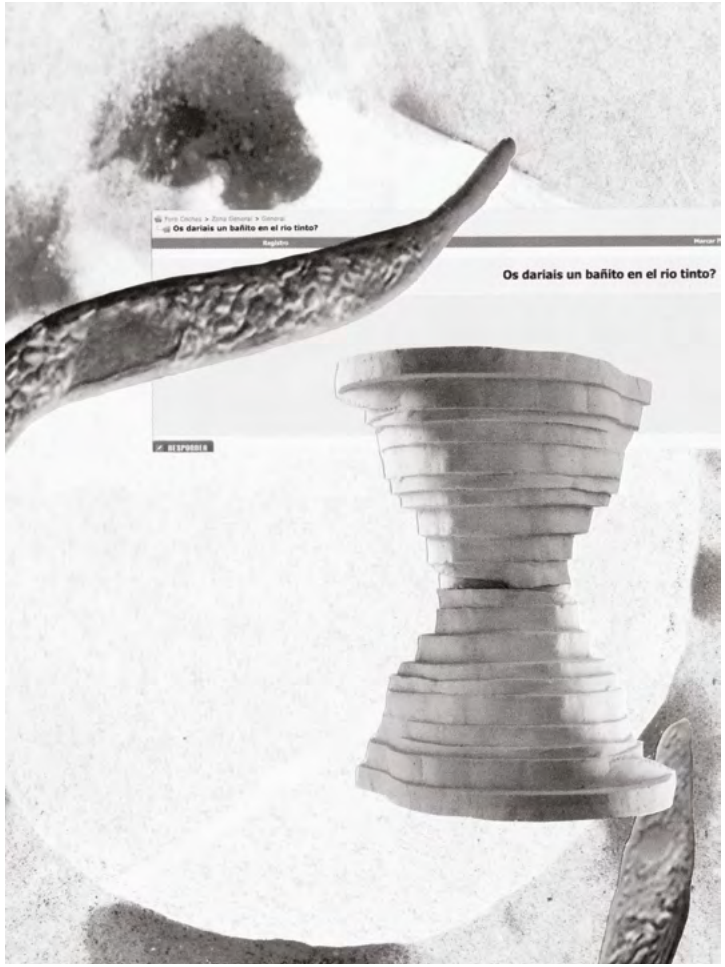
Beyond nature is a term I use to describe the consciousness existing in what we have named nature. The beyond can be listened to, but it is not often that it is heard audibly. Ancient life such as the sun, the hills, the mountains, the rocks, waters and the soil have been my teachers in understanding Nairobi's pre-colonial landscape. The land remembers. I have been in conversation with the land for sometime and through ngoma and my DAW, I am able to translate what the land is teaching me.

*mugumo Kikuyu name for Ficus thonningii
**ngoma Swahili name for the spirit of the drum
***nyawawa Luo name for spirits that live in nature

Copper Tales: Walking For Script

Lisa Mazenauer
(Switzerland)

A river. A red river. A familiar aqueous color. I put my finger in it. It doesn't smell bad. It doesn't smell at all. The limits.
- Don't touch it!
Keep walking.
Shifting parallels not weaving analogies, I pursue the fading blast. I think: her first orgasm in contact with an empty washbasin. Alone. Water. Hot water. Laundry. Rubbing. Caress. Outside.
- If you want to know, look at the cows, she said. But once you've forced it you will follow the same state: death – reversing her own belief, she didn't describe death as a fate.
It reminds me of those horses, trapped in Ladoga. The frozen lake blocks the way. Neither outside, nor inside. In between. A porous state. Cold water. Could they ever move again?
Anyway, she is full of fear and repeats only what she read on the sign. Above the wooden fence, a red circle. Inside: «Prohibido bañarse, peligro de muerte». The fence resembles the grid of a chastity belt. Barrier limitation. Stay outside. Property. Can you remember? Hers was made of copper. A familiar aqueous color. Is it a river? Above: drawing of a skull.
- The one they found in the mine?
- Found?
- Digging for copper, they found bones. They encountered what they were trying to escape from. Sobering.
- They?
Shifting parallels. A big hole, letting Acidithiobacillus metabolize while digesting ores: the horses, the empty skull, the washbasin, the river. During an orgasm, many bacteria vibrate around bones. La petite mort or the limits of perception.
Hourglass upside down. I stop. Shifting parallels.
–radio sounds– sscchhshhschhshhchshchshshchchshsh.
Os daríais un bañito en el Río Tinto?



Under the Never Ground

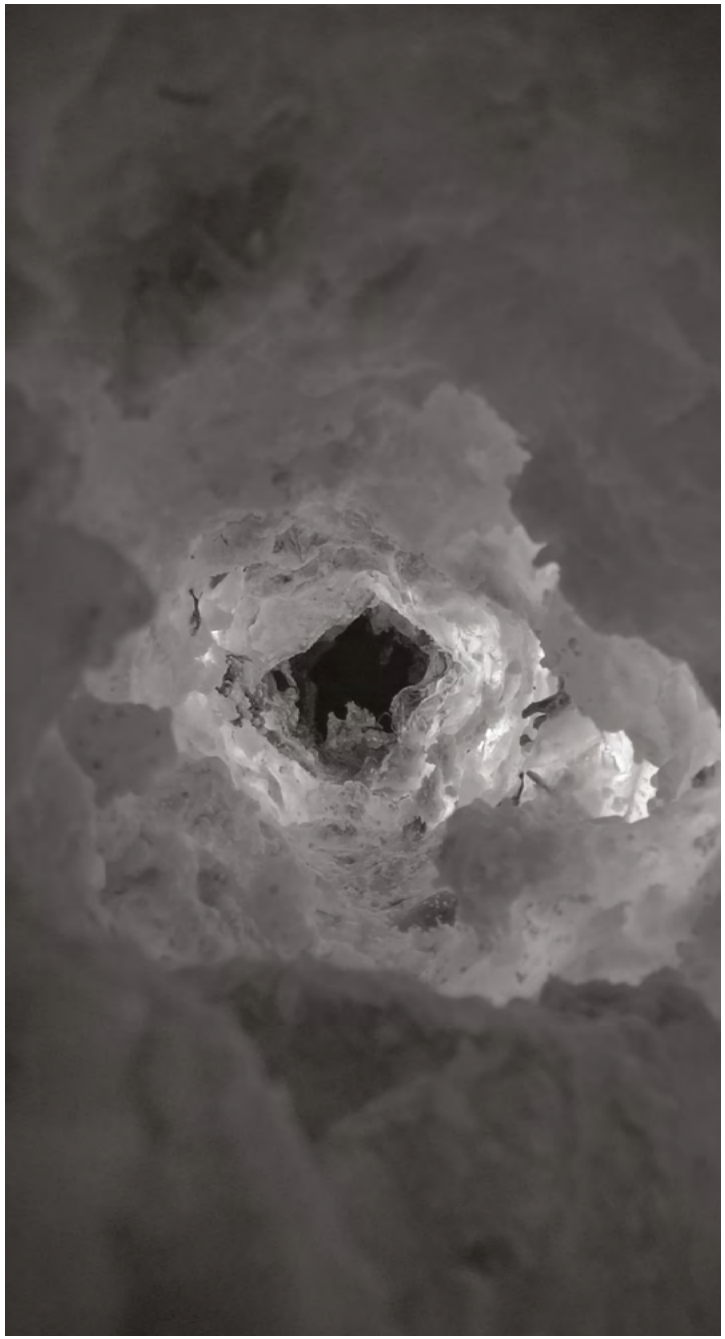
Natália Trejbalová
(Slovakia)

Under the Never Ground is a film that explores the limits of the colonisation of our planet and the relation to the Earth as a physical and celestial body. The film is meant to be presented also as an expanded video installation, an environment that can potentially comprehend different objects, sculptures that were developed as set for the shooting of different scenes. Using science fiction as a possible tool for futurological investigation, this film looks into our perception of the Earth and on what could still be hidden under its surface. The film is dedicated to the Earth's underground spaces and its connection to the space exploration.

The surface of our planet has been entirely explored, but we haven't explored the places hidden under. It's possible that we've only discovered a fragment of all the cave systems that exist on our planet. Therefore it is possible to consider these underground places and networks as a possible salvation and resource, an ultimate frontier of life on Earth. We generally perceive only the visible surface of our planet almost as if we were living on a plane. More likely we're living on a sphere filled with holes, cavities, connections and networks that entwint the surface with the underground, connecting the visible with the hidden.

Under the Never Ground is a journey into the parallel world of underground networks, a figment of our imagination where fantastic stories mix with scientific truths.

The film is divided into several parts that traces a possible space-time journey between Earth and subterranean passages of another planet. *Under the Never Ground* presents itself as a perfect video loop, in a descent and the ascent physical movement, almost as if we were travelling through the bowels of a celestial body.



18:17:02
From v for 5 :
My fav sound today has been this trilling/ rotating/trigger type sound in Solange's song Almeda

18:17:36
From Mad Bycroft :
i love hard g's sounds, as in ghost, good, gurgle. Also gurgling sounds or kind of watery bubbling. Also, i love hearing the chatter of fish eating underwater.

18:18:00
From Lin :
Ocean yesss always

18:18:03
From Adriana Gallo :
I like cooking sound, bubbling is nice, or clattering

18:18:07
From Davide Marcianesi :
for me the sound of plastic gloves washing dishes

18:18:07
From Felix Bell :
Reacted to "Ocean yesss always" with <3

18:18:21
From raju rage :
cooking sounds for me too

18:18:22
From Kosmas Dinh :
Reacted to "i love hard g's soun..." with <3

18:18:23
From Ania Mokrzycka :
Gravel under bicycle wheels

18:18:36
From Ama Josephine (she/her) :
Replying to "for me the sound of ..."
Ahhh really?! So interesting! That's like nails on a chalk board to me..

18:18:40
From Ama Josephine (she/her) :
Reacted to "Gravel under bicycle..." with <3

18:18:48
From Mad Bycroft :
Reacted to "Ocean yesss always" with <3

18:18:57
From Andrea Lumplecker :
It'S definitely the birds very early morning these spring days, blackbirds and many others

18:19:00
From Caroline Ward :
As a child, I really liked the sound of the opening credits of a movie (the movie house sound, like the Lion roar). Indicated the beginning of the movie.

18:19:06
From SoL :
Reacted to "Gravel under bicycle..." with <3

18:19:26
From Lin :
I also really like the sound in a theatre/ performance space right before the audience comes in

18:19:48
From raju rage :
Reacted to "As a child, I really..." with <3

18:19:55
From SoL :
Replying to "It'S definitely the ..."
Yes, definitely the sound of spring coming back

18:20:07
From Caroline Ward :
Reacted to "I also really like t..." with <3

18:20:13
From Caroline Ward : Reacted to "Gravel under bicycle..." with :)

18:20:55
From lissy willberg (they/them) :
Reacted to "As a child, I really..." with <3

18:21:21
From raju rage :
Replying to "cooking sounds for m..."
sizzling food sounds when its brought to the table

18:22:29
From Adriana Gallo :
Replying to "cooking sounds for m..."
food settling is good too - bread crackles!

18:23:00
From Lin :
Replying to "Laughter"
Especially the laughter of friends

18:26:22
From Clara Benito :
Replying to "Laughter"
This is what I said when Yuri asked me

18:27:21
From Felix Bell :
When someone is having a really personal conversation loudly on a phone on the train

18:27:32
From Sara Bonaventura :
Replying to "Laughter"
For me of children I have nothing to relate to as well… feels like it's coming from a different world. I also have a couple of recordings of my friends laughing too though

18:27:56
From Ama Josephine (she/her) :
Replying to "When someone is havi..."
OMG yes

18:28:36
From Adriana Gallo :
Replying to "When someone is havi..."
or in a foreign country with a language you don't speak when you hear someone speaking a language you know

18:29:33
From Felix Bell :
Replying to "When someone is havi..."
Yes and also the oppersite. Living abroad I got used to not understanding people on public transport. When I come home I get very exhausted being able to understand everyone again

18:30:10
From Clara Benito :
Replying to "When someone is havi..."
To me is the opposite: I LOVED when I was living abroad and heard conversations I could not understand. And whenever I visited Spain again I was so devastated by possible communication LOL

18:30:14
From raju rage :
I feel I hear or am forced to listen to annoucenments especially around surveillance, policing and security in London and I guess being away made me realise how invasive it is in my psyche that I may not be aware of. I need to wear nocie cancelling headphones often but then this is different to listening for me, or active listening which ive practiced in mediation settings

18:45:06
From raju rage :
Replying to "What does deep mean ..."
The Indigenous concept of Deep Listening describes a way of learning, working, and togetherness that is informed by the concepts of community and reciprocity. Leadership underpinned by Deep Listening involves listening respectfully, which can help build community. It draws on every sense and every part of our being.
Deep Listening in community leadership involves taking the time to develop relationships and to listen respectfully and responsibly.
It also means listening to and observing oneself (Atkinson 2001).

18:45:20
From Noa Jansma (She/Her) :
I have a friend who is half-deaf and since she can do lip-read she can actually 'listen' to people that i can not listen to sometimes (if they are behind a window or in a muted video or something)

what is human?
who is we?

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Johnstone
Ana Roman
Ana Rosela del Bosque
Andrea Lumpleker
Ania Mokrzycka
Caroline Ward
Caterina Gobbi
Davide Marcianesi
Diogo da Cruz
Dominika Wasilewska
Felix Bell
Hannah Hallam-Eames
Ishita Jain
Korallia Stergides
Kosmas Phan Dinh
Lindertje Mans
Lisa Mazenauer
Lissy Willberg
Madison Bycroft
Maite Rodríguez
Matheline Marmy
Natália Trejbalová
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Sol Archer
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The Institute for Postnatural Studies is a center for artistic experimentation from which to explore and problematize the postnatural as a framework for contemporary creation. Founded in 2020, the IPS is a platform for critical thinking, a network that brings together artists and researchers concerned about the issues of the global ecological crisis through experimental formats, sharing, and producing open knowledge. It is structured around a physical space where workshops, conferences, and exhibitions take place, as well as the production of theoretical material and academic programs.

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Institute for
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